Relive

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Mature

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Graphic Depictions Of Violence, Major Character Death

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by Certified_Lover

Summary

Adora and Catra never thought they'd cross each other's paths before witnessing the death of a close friend, that brings them closer.

The sky was a mix of orange, red, and black as if the sun were setting. A community neighborhood, the road was long and took a turn to the left. Catra didn't recognize the place, she didn't feel safe at all.

"C--atra?" She struggled to breathe, her face turning red. Catra loosened her grip then removed her hands from Adora's neck.

Adora breathed in heavily, she gently held her neck and rubbed it. "Damn, you have a grip." She said breathlessly.

"Shit-- Are you alright? Actually are you even real? This is a goddamn dream, why am I even worried about you?" Catra scoffed and facepalmed.
Adora slowed her breathing then looked at their position. "I should be asking you the same thing..." She looked back up at Catra, who was still sitting on her.

"I'm just dreaming." She mumbled.

"This is my dream, what are you talking about?"

"No, it's mine." Catra stared down at her.

"..The hell?"

Chapter 1

"How do you even do that?" Lonnie asked her magicat friend as they sat on a grassy hill in the field of BrightMoon High. The two had cigarettes between their fingers, smoking their past pains away.

If you asked them, they'd say they didn't smoke often, unless they were together, which was all the time. The two were like family. They did everything together.

Catra was a carmel furred magicat with mismatched golden and teal blue eyes, her hair was dark hazelnut and put into a small rattail since it was short. She had a sharp scar on her right cheek that came from her jaw and some scars on her hands from sharp cuts and bruises.

Lonnie was brown skinned with light brown eyes, she had hazelnut dreads that went back into a ponytail. She had a few scars as well but they weren't as visible as Catra's. One was on her left eyebrow while some were also in her hands.

"Its so easy." Catra scoffed, rolling her eyes. "Do it again for me, pleasseee." Lonnie pleaded. Catra inhaled the smoke then blew it out as a circle. Lonnie grinned. "I'm gonna learn how to do that, just watch."

"Sure." Catra smirked.

Lonnie's attention suddenly wavered as she spotted someone ahead of them on the field. A certain blonde that doesn't get along with Catra.

"Hey, Catra, look, your best friend." Lonnie teased, gesturing at the beautiful blonde on the field playing tackle football with her teammates.

Catra looked up, her gaze immediately locked on Adora. She scoffed for the 5th time today, in annoyance. "She's such a jock."

"You like her though." Lonnie smirked.

"No I don't, fuck Adora." Catra blew out some smoke.

"Of course you'd want to."

"Lonniee." Catra dragged her name out a bit, annoyed. "Don't mind me, I'm just talking." Lonnie shrugged at her friend.

"Yeah, I know. You never like to stop yapping that mouth."

Lonnie chuckled, causing Catra to smile.

Suddenly Huntara and some other girl that Catra knew to be named Jamie popped up. The two sat next to her and Lonnie, with mischievous looks.

"Guess whatt~" Jamie said. He was dirty blonde with curls and emerald eyes. He wore a green shirt with black sweats.

"What?" Lonnie tilted her head.

"Remember that abandoned building we heard about? The one that had hidden money in it?"

"Yeah??" Catra stared, hoping they're not saying what she thinks they're saying. "Well, we checked it for people and there was no one, but we were too chicken and decided to turn around. You two are brave, could you come with us?" Jamie said.

"I didn't chicken out, that was you whining." Huntara scoffed.

"Right, okay." Jamie rolled his eyes.

"This sounds like the set up of a horror movie, no, we're not going." Catra said firmly.

"Aww but I kind of want to go. we can bring others, so we're not just four people." Lonnie frowned. "Hell no, Lonnie are you crazy?"

"I'm broke, Catra. We can all split the money, remember, that building used to belong to that really rich old guy that took the water away from our academy."

"Sounds like a load of bs."

"Pleaseeeeee?" Lonnie pleaded.

Catra stared at her for a good moment, contemplating. "..Fine. If you go, I'll go." She gave up. "Ride or die."

"Ride or die." Lonnie repeated, smiling.

"I'll get some others to come with us. Leave it all to me." Jamie smirked. "I guess I'll bring the drinks." Huntara huffed.

"We got the weed." Lonnie nudged Catra, Catra nodded. "Sure, stacks."

"Catraa!"

"Whattt." Young Catra asked, putting down her crayon.

"I got a cut on my handd. Jeremy did it! But he got in trouble."

"What?" Catra growled, staring at the wound. She stopped and stayed silent for a second before pulling out a pocket knife she stole. "What are you gonna do with that?" Young Lonnie raised an eyebrow.

Catra hesitantly cut her hand in the same spot Lonnie had her wound. "See, now we're both cut. We match." She smiled. Lonnie frowned. "No Catra, you can't hurt yourself. Remember what we talked about?"

"I'll be fine." Catra grinned. "When we catch Jeremy, I'm gonna punch him."

"You'll get in trouble"

"Any more trouble than I was after spilling my milk on Shadow Weaver?"

"...Maybe not." Lonnie shrugged.

"Exactly. Remember what you said when you first saved me?"

"That we look out for each other."

"And after that, we said we'd survive together, escape together, lie together, kill together, eat together, and die together." Catra hopped off her top bunk. Lonnie hopped off as well.

"Right, you're right!" Lonnie grinned.

--------- Later that day

"Everyone's here!" Jamie said, loudly. Catra shushed him. "Are you trying to screw us over, we don't want to draw anyone over here."

"Oh, right." He frowned.

"Who'd you bring anyways?" Lonnie asked. Jamie pointed behind him to Huntara getting out her car with Entrapta, Adora, Mermista, Glimmer and another guy named Tobi.

As Adora got out the car, she met gaze with Catra. Catra groaned, loudly. "Yeah, fuck you too." Adora scoffed. "Adora." Tobi smacked her arm. "What? She started it." Adora furrowed her eyebrows.

"Alrightt, let's go." Huntara gestured to the worn out building. Lonnie excitedly smiled. "Yep"

They all walked inside, careful to where they stepped. They went up many stairs, looking through every floor before eventually taking a break on the 5th floor.

"Hey, Lonnie, come here." Jamie called her over to a large hole in the wall. The floor had a lot of holes from the large shattered windows and the floor being hit by the wrecking ball the most. It was pretty windy too.

Catra lit a cigarette, she watched Lonnie and Jamie talk before looking at the fire Entrapta started for them because it was getting cold. "So how long were we even going to stay here for?" Glimmer asked.

"Dunno, we might stay the night. Best horror experience ever." Huntara smirked.

"What? Are you insane??" Adora flinched.

"It's getting dark, might as well stay, right?"

"No? I'd rather drive in the dark." Catra said. "For once I actually agree with Catra." Adora frowned. "Borringg." Tobi said, he had orange hair with yellow eyes.

"I'm gonna go downstairs and check for dead bodies again." Mermista stood up. "I'll come with." Glimmer said. "Don't die." Catra slowly blew out smoke.

After a few minutes more of sitting down, Catra noticed how nervous Adora was, tapping her foot rapidly and fidgeting with her hands. It annoyed Catra, making her a bit nervous as well. Catra took out a cigarette and passed it over to Adora. "If you need something to do with your hands, pick up smoking."

Adora stared at the cigarette. "Smoking is disgusting."

"Right, then stay there fidgeting." Catra rolled her eyes. Adora continued being nervous, it started to piss Catra off. "Just try the goddamn cigarette, Carrero."

"Fuck you." Adora scoffed. "....Fine, give it." She put her hand out. Catra smirked then handed her the cigarette. Adora hesitantly

started putting the cigarette to her mouth. "Wrong way, princess." Catra said, amused.

Adora turned it around then put it to her mouth. Catra raised her lighter to the cigarette then lit it for her. "Now calm your dumbass down. Breath it in slowly, blow it out. You're making *me* nervous."

"Right." Adora said, though a bit thankful. She inhaled then abruptly coughed. "I hate it." She said while coughing. Catra laughed at her pain. "You're so fucking annoying." Adora retorted. Catra smirked, a chuckle escaping her.

"Welcome to the team." Huntara commented, causing Catra to snicker.

They all started talking amongst each other before suddenly, Adora started smacking Catra's arm repeatedly. Catra immediately became pissed, turning her head towards her, glaring. Her glare softened though once she noticed that Adora's gaze was somewhere else, she looked concerned. "What?" Catra said with a bit of a growl. She traced Adora's gaze to Jamie and Lonnie.

"What the hell?" She mumbled. Jamie had held Lonnie over the open edge of the building. He said something before dropping her off the building. "Jamie, what the *fuck!?*" Catra stood up and dashed over, followed by Adora.

Catra got on her knees, looking over the edge, seeing a limp Lonnie with several broken bones bleeding out on the collapsed rubble. She was lifeless, anyone from that fall would die, no matter how strong they were. Catra could see blood streaming down the rocks.

Her blood ran cold, her body had chills all over as well as it was numb. Eyes widened, her heart seemed to have stopped, as did time. Catra couldn't even fully process this, so many thoughts raced through her mind that it became overwhelmed quickly.

She couldn't help but just stare at the lifeless body below.

Lonnie. Lonnie D. Davis was dead. Catra's first friend. Her closest friend. The one that was always there for her. The one that dealt with her *bullshit*.

She's dead.

Adora hesitantly punched him. "What the actual fuck, Jamie?! What is wrong with you?!"

Jamie strugglingly stood up, not a word spilled from his mouth. Adora pushed him to the wall. "Answer me!"

Catra stood up, clenching her fist. Adora noticed how quiet Catra was and stepped back. Catra slowly walked up to him before punching him. She watched him drop to the floor again.

"You killed her." She said, her hands shaking back into a fist. Catra started punching him repeatedly. His face was getting bloodied by his own blood. "Catra--" Adora tried. Catra grabbed him by his collar then slammed him against the wall, her arm pressing onto his neck. "What the fuck man?! Why?!"

"Whatt are you guys doing?" Glimmer came upstairs, Mermista following behind. "Yeah." They heard Jamie add.

Adora and Catra whipped their heads towards the sound. "Jamie?" Adora flinched. Catra's blood started to boil. "*What?*" Catra said, breathlessly.

They watched as Jamie and Lonnie walked in behind Glimmer and Mermista. "Yeah?" Jamie asked. "You guys okay?" Lonnie asked, concerned. The two came over, so did Glimmer and Mermista.

"Were you having a tussle with the wall?" Lonnie raised an eyebrow. "What? No--How are you.." Catra removed her arm off the wall where Jamie was supposedly before.

Adora glanced down at Catra, they both met each other's gaze.

"You guys are awfully close. Are you two finally getting along?" Jamie smirked.

Catra backed up slowly, Adora grabbed her shoulder before she could back up too far and accidentally over the edge.

"*fffuck* this." She dragged out the F.

"What happened?" Lonnie asked.

"You just died, I just watched you *fucking die*, Lonnie." Catra held her head and ran her fingers through her hair. "I swear it happened."

"But I'm right here?" Lonnie raised an eyebrow. She went up to her. "Hey, hey, look at me."

Catra looked at her. "I'm not dead. Are you high?"

"Maybe? ...shit..I know what I saw."

"Me too. Jamie pushed you off the edge." Adora eyebrows furrowed in confusion.

"Have you both been smoking something?" Glimmer asked.

The two glanced at each other again. "Yeah, yeah, we're just high. I got the hard pack." Catra shook her head. "You sure you're good?" Lonnie crossed her arms.

"Yeah, I'm just tripping." Catra shrugged then took out another cigarette and put it in her mouth. "...I guess me too."

They both then walked back to their spot near each other on the ground. "We're not really tripping, are we?" Adora said lowly to her. "Who knows maybe we were." Catra answered, confliction filled in her voice.

"I know what I saw and what I felt. He was real."

"But they're both right there." Catra lit her cigarette. "...It'd be something if just one of us saw it happen, but we both saw it fucking happen."

"Right." Adora exhaled then pulled out her phone.

"Still didn't find anything." Mermista sighed.

"Did you guys look upstairs?" Huntara stood.

"Nopee." Jamie said.

"Let's go up there before we leave, money might be in the old shit's office."

Catra jumped tiredly onto her bed. "Maybe I should stop smoking Crecent Premiums, huh Melog?" She said to her feline companion. Melog meowed and purred, he then curled up next to her.

Melog was a burgundy furred cat with light blue eyes and highlights on his face and tail. Catra purred as well. "Yeah, definitely" She dozed off.

The sky was a mix of orange, red, and black as if the sun were setting. A community neighborhood, the road was long and took a turn to the left. Catra didn't recognize the place, she didn't feel safe at all.

She took a step, the sound muffled. 'I'm in a dream. I'm dreaming.' Catra thought. She found the setting disturbing.

"I'm not a pussy." Catra scoffed and started walking down the road. She kept her nails sharp and unsheathed.

"What the hell is this? A lucid dream?" She decides to go into a house that's litten. Catra searched through the cabinets and went upstairs to one of the many rooms. She opened the door to the master bedroom and walked in, her senses heightened. The

Queen sized bed was in the middle, a walk in closet was across from it on the right and a few nightstands.

Catra went to the nightstand on the left nearest to the window and bathroom. After looking through it, she stared at the walk in closet, feeling as if someone was in the room with her. She stood still, waiting quietly.

Suddenly someone tackled her from the bathroom door behind her, They both fell onto the Queen sized bed, trying to get the upper hand.

Catra punched the person in the stomach then tossed them over and immediately grabbed their neck and slammed them down on the bed, sitting on them. Catra suddenly flinched. "--Adora?"

"C--atra?" She struggled to breathe, her face turning red. Catra loosened her grip then removed her hands from Adora's neck.

Adora breathed in heavily, she gently held her neck and rubbed it. "Damn, you have a grip." She said breathlessly.

"Shit-- Are you alright? Actually are you even real? This is a goddamn dream, why am I even worried about you?" Catra scoffed and facepalmed.

Adora slowed her breathing then looked at their position. "I should be asking you the same thing..." She looked back up at Catra, who was still sitting on her.

"I'm just dreaming." She mumbled.

"This is my dream, what are you talking about?"

"No, it's mine." Catra stared down at her.

"..The hell?"

"Are we sharing a dream?"

"Maybe, but how do I know I'm not just dreaming you say this?" Adora raised an eyebrow. "Though I have no idea why I would be dreaming about you in the first place."

Catra scoffed then got off of her. "Me either. We'll see when we wake up tomorrow morning."

"Yeah..." Adora sat up.

"Do you know what this place is?" Catra asked.

"No, I got here some time ago, fell asleep on my couch pretty quickly. I don't know where we are but I saw this map in another house."

"You grabbed it?"

"Yeah, I did." Adora pulled out the map and handed it to her. "This.. this is map is of Manhattan." Catra commented.

"What??"

"Look, dumbass. We learned this in 9th grade. BrightMoon is down Southwest."

"You want to go down to BrightMoon?"

"...We have nothing else to do here and I'd rather be in somewhere familiar instead of somewhere I've never been."

"True...so truce for the time being?"

Catra stared at her then scoffed. "Yeah whatever." The two exited the house and started looking for the exit out of the neighborhood. "What is it?" Catra asked, seeing that Adora was seemingly paranoid. "You don't feel like something is watching us?"

"...Of course I do. But we can't let it bullshit us, keep moving or I'll leave you behind." Catra said.

Adora huffed but still followed beside her.

"That sky hasn't gotten any darker or lighter."

Catra scoffed. "No, it hasn't, thanks for pointing out the obvious."

She huffed. "Fuck this, man, this is a nightmare."

"Sure is, especially if you're in it." Adora retorted.

"Hey, fuck you, that's my line."

Adora rolled her eyes. "Atleast you know how much of an ass you are."

"Still waiting for you to realise how much of a piece of rich shit fucker you are."

"Fuck you."

Catra smirked.

Once they found the exit and went into the city, they realised how even more strange this was. "Hey, you ever been to Manhattan?" Adora asked.

"I have, but I haven't seen a whole bunch of it. Not enough to remember the whole city."

"So where is this even taking from, because I've never been here before. And there is no one else here but us. No cars, no people, animals, nothing."

"It's unnerving. Life must be getting revenge on me especially if I'm stuck alone on an entire world with only you."

"You can say that again...we should have fun. You know dream usually last like hours until you wake up."

"..Let's find a gun store." Catra suggested.

"Not what I had in mind but okay."

"What, you were thinking about grabbing board games or some shit?"

"Maybe?"

Catra chuckled. "Cute, but no. Real fun is doing dangerous things."

"Risking your life is better than go fish or uno?" Adora raised an eyebrow.

"..maybe we can grab a domino's or uno."

"Right."

They continued moving, until they found a huge store, Walmart. "It looks terrifying in there. No lights are on." Adora commented.

"We could find a whole bunch of stuff in there. But yeah, it is pretty terrifying. We find a flashlight or find the light switches which probably need a key."

Catra glanced behind them then suddenly stopped in her tracks. "What the-- Adora." She reached out to tap her.

"What?" Adora asked turned around as well. Her blood ran cold once she saw what was down the road.

A lanky black figure, it didn't have anything special, nothing too freaky like spikes or anything it was just a dark human figure. That was probably the most unnerving thing about it. The unknown. The uncertainty

"It's someone. Hello?" Adora called. "Who's there?!" Catra hesitantly yelled.

It looked human from afar but if you were experienced enough, you'd rely on your instincts, when the hairs on your neck raise,

and your sweat becomes cold while your adrenaline kicks in.

It's *when*

That's not human

Suddenly gears into your brain.

" It's getting closer." Adora stepped back, noticing how the figure seemed to be getting closer and faster.

"Catra, hey, snap out of it!" Adora shook her back into dream-ality.

"Fuck-- what is that?!"

"I don't know but we need to run!"

Catra nodded, they both started running as fast as they could. The footsteps of the black figure became louder and closer by the second.

"Fuck! Fuck--! Keep running   don't even think about looking back!"

"Already ahead of you!" Adora was desperately controlling her breathing. Why did it feel like they were actually in danger when they know it's just a dream? Why can't they just dream the nightmare away? What is this? Will they actually die? This all went through Adora's brain as they continued to run.

They both heard the figure's footsteps even closer.

It was faster than them.

Adora glanced behind her. "It's getting closer and I'm getting tired! We need to think of something fast!"

"Shit-- It's so close! Juke it or something! I thought we agreed not to look back!"

"Fuck that, we're getting chased! And I doubt we could try that!"

Catra bit her thumb, trying to think as they ran for their lives. Suddenly the steps behind them started to fade. Catra and Adora both looked back this time to see what happened--

"*SHIT*" Catra jolted up from her bed, she pushed herself back with her feet, scrambling in fright. She hit her head on the frame of her bed with a loud thump. Catra breathed heavily, out of breath. *'What the hell was that? Was any of that..real? Adora, was she really--?'* She held the back of her head, the pain finally settling in.

Her feline companion, Melog sauntered up to her, carefully. He meowed in question then rubbed his head against her and started making biscuits. "That had to be the weirdest nightmare/ nightmare fuel ever. I don't feel rested at all." She brought her knees up and wrapped her arms around them.

Adora jolted awake as well, she fell off her couch, hitting her glass table, after startling and scrambling off. Her heart was beating like crazy. *'What..the **fuck**?'*

She sighed, realizing she was in her room. Adora lightly touched the right of her forehead. She winced, feeling a cut. *'I hit my head on the table, It's bleeding.'*

She stood up in a bit of a struggle, feeling weak and shocked. *'Well that was a nightmare, I wonder if Catra and I really shared a dream. I doubt it, why would we share one? We hate each other.'* Adora sighed again then went into her bathroom to clean up.

2

Adora walked into her school feeling light-headed, her head hurt, it was as if she had no sleep.

Glimmer and Bow waited by her locker. "Hey, you're a bit late for our breakfast day starter." Glimmer said, wearing sweatpants with a purple hoodie.

"You look tired, what happened last night?" Bow asked, he wore a white crop top with slightly baggy jeans.

"Just a bad dream. A really weird one at that." Adora answered. She wore a white shirt and dark grey sweatpants with a dark red jacket.

"Wanna talk about it on the way?" Bow put his phone in his pocket.

"Not much to say about it..well.." Adora wondered if she should tell her friends about Catra.

"There was someone in it." The two perked up "Who? You got a crush?" Glimmer smirked.

Adora flinched. "No--! Hell no, not her."

"Who?" Bow asked.

"Her?"

"*Catra* was in it."

"Then that wasn't just a dream, that was a cry for help, a nightmare." Glimmer huffed.

"That's what I was saying. But it was really weird, it was like we were sharing a 'nightmare'."

Her two friends listened to her then stared at her, confused. "Did you smoke something, Adora?" Glimmer asked. Bow smacked her arm. "Glimmer-! What she means to say is, are you sure and are you alright?" He frowned.

"Of course I am..I think."

Glimmer exhaled. "You're fine, Adora. You just need some coffee, I mean, shared dreams aren't even real." She grabbed her wrist and they all started walking towards the cafeteria. "Unless Catra's your soulmate or something?"

Adora expression immediately shifted into a disgustful fluster as if the thought of her and Catra liking each other were distasteful. "Exactly. And even if you did, it's not happening. You'd have to be delusional."

"Glimmer." Bow frowned again. "Whatt?" Glimmer looked at him, letting go of Adora. They continued walking. "It's the truth." She scoffed.

----- Later, Lunch break.

A headache had been torturing Adora for two hours already and it seems to get worse with everything she does. This always happened when she was unable to get enough rest. *'I need to either take a nap, or take pain killers, because no way this headache is legal.'* She clenched her teeth.

Adora thought about finding out whether what happened last night was real by checking with Catra, but with all honesty, she didn't want to interact with Catra at all. The only reason they spoke the other day was because there was nothing better to do, though usually even that would keep them from talking.

Every sound was heightened, making the pain heighten as well. Adora heard the double doors leading to the cafeteria open, she glanced at it, seeing Catra and Lonnie enter the cafeteria. Catra's demeanor looked grumpy and very tired. Lonnie, however, looked normal, like she hadn't died the other day.

Catra's gaze landed on Adora. They both stared at each other, eyes immediately narrowing. *'That must have been real. Hopefully I don't have a dream like that ever again.'* Adora sighed lightly, once they both averted gazes.

"Adora--!"

Adora flinched then looked up at her friends. "You okay?" Perfuma asked. "Yeah..just a horrible headache." Adora nervously smiled. "You should go home early." Bow suggested.

"No, I'm okay."

---- Home, after school.

Adora groaned in gradually increasing agony on her bed. She clenched her bed sheets, her head panging. "Godddd." She whined. "I want to get laid...soo bad." She said randomly, feeling her body tingle. Her big white fluffy dog, Swift Wind, grunted then stared at her as he laid down.

"I know, big mood change. It's the headache talking." Adora closed her eyes. He barked, the sound echoing in her slightly empty room. She had moved in not too long ago, away from her annoying parents. "Yeah I know, I can't fall asleep without some painkillers, I'll get some from the gas store. Maybe even something to snack on." She mumbled before getting off her bed, holding her head.

Adora got into a simple white hoodie and black sweatpants then got into her car, annoyed. She turned it on then went to the nearest gas station store. Adora crossed her arms, entering the store and going to the back to grab a drink.

She grabbed a cold sweet lemonade then noticed someone next to her with a familiar scent. It was the faint sweet scent of slight shea butter and nature, then the grimacing faint scent of smoke. Surprisingly, the scents went together in a weird combination, the smoke giving a glint/ spice to it. Adora glanced at the person next to her. "Catra?" She perked up.

Catra flinched then looked at her. She stared with mixed emotion of confusion and annoyance. "Adora? The hell do you want? Are you stalking me or something??"

Adora flinched as well. She didn't expect to make conversation, nor did she particularly need anything from her. "Uh..nothing, just surprised to see you here. Actually...no, I'm not." She answered.

"Then don't bother me, yeah?" Catra raised an eyebrow as she was sliding something into the inside of her flannel pockets. She wore a red and black flannel, black tank top, and black jeans. "Are you..stealing?" Adora noticed.

"Mind your own business, blondie." Catra growled. Adora grabbed her wrist and held them tightly. "I can let everything else pass, but you can't just steal." She said, firmly, furrowing her eyebrows. Catra winced a bit, clenching her teeth as she tried to escape her grip.

"Is everything all right there, girls?" The employee asked from behind the counter. He seemed to be suspicious of them. Catra's heart beated rapidly, scared Adora would tell. Adora stared at her, contemplating. "..Yeah, everything's okay, sir."

"What are you doing? I hope you know I don't condone stealing." He glared. "Me and my friend here were just deciding on what drink to bring for our friend." Adora lied. The man stared at them as he crossed his arms. "Hmm...Okay." He went back to whatever he was doing. "..I'll pay for it. But atleast grab something healthier than that, like a juice or something." Adora let go of her. "Sorry." She apologized as Catra whipped her hand away then rubbed her wrist.

Adora noticed the faint cut marks seemingly lining down Catra's entire wrist. She immediately felt bad. "How are you going to do that? We don't necessarily have ID."

"He looks easily bribed." Adora shrugged.

Catra stared at her for a moment then chuckled. "Good luck, if it gets rough, I'm leaving you for the cops."

"Only if I don't do it first."

"I'm faster than you."

"You're lying to yourself."

Catra scoffed then obliged to grab a juice. They both went up and put the drinks on the counter. The employee scanned the drinks. "Oh and, painkillers-- please." Adora's realization of her, what felt like, life threatening headache came back after she felt a sharp stab through her head.

"Which ones?" He asked, turning around to open the plastic casing behind him.

Adora opened her mouth to speak, but the pain was so strong, she held her head. "Tylenol and Waning Cells" Catra answered suddenly. Adora glanced at her. "Y-yeah, those."

"Alright...28.74"

'He's not gonna ask about the beer? Well this must be Catra's lucky day.' Adora pulled out her wallet then slid her card through the card reader. Once the man put the stuff in a bag, she grabbed it then walked out, followed by Catra.

"Hey, wait."

Adora stopped then looked back at her. "My drinks." Catra said. "Oh, right. Take it." She took out her stuff and gave Catra the bag.

Catra frowned a bit. She felt oddly concerned. "Headache?" She asked. Adora nodded, hesitantly. "I need to sleep."

"If you take the two of those at the same time the pain will go away faster."

Adora perked up. "Right, okay, I'll try that."

"Wait." Catra caught up to her.

"What." Adora glanced at her, annoyed. "We need to talk." Catra scoffed.

"About what?...The dream?"

"So it was real then?"

"I guess so, if we both know about it. Let's just hope that nightmare doesn't happen again and go our merry way. I'm not trying to be tethered to you or whatever demonic shit that was."

"..Right, if it does happen though, I'm punching you."

"What? Why?"

"Just to make sure it's really you."

Adora scoffed. "Whatever. Goodnight, Catra." Catra's ear twitched before she spoke back. "Night."

Catra rode her motorcycle home and once she got home, she immediately took to her room. Melog, her feline companion slept soundly on her bed. Catra opened her beer bottle then took out the one she hid in her flannel. She used to hide them in her hair when it was longer and wilder but ever since she cut it, she's had to resort to different tactics. "It was..sweet, I guess, of her to buy it. But come on, did she really think I still wouldn't steal the goddamn beer bottle?" Catra spoke before chuckling. She took her flannel off then her jeans and put on black sweatpants. "Of course I was gonna."

Catra got into her bed and started drinking while scrolling on her phone. She soon dozed off.

Catra jolted awake. She glanced frantically around before frowning. 'This again.' She thought. Catra looked to her side and saw Adora sleeping. She wondered if that meant Adora wasn't sleeping in the real world yet. Though with a headache such as hers, you would think she'd be asleep before Catra.

'Can I..wake her up? What would that do?' Catra got into a squat position and stared at Adora peacefully sleeping on the ground. Her ears suddenly twitched and searched for a sound of anything. nothing came up. 'That thing is around somewhere. We need to hurry up and try and make this walmart run. Maybe I should leave her here..or wait till she wakes up. Or maybe just carry her.'

'Ill wake her up.' She decided and started to shake Adora. "Hey, princess, wakey wakey...or sleepy sleepy. Come on, get up." She shook more before standing up and kicking her legs.

Adora shot up and abruptly grabbed her head. "What--" She breathed heavily before looking around. Her eyes set on Catra and her mood shifted drastically. "It was the cigarette , you roped me into some demonic shit--!" She stood up and grabbed Catra by her collar. "Calm yourself princess . It was just a cigarette. Why don't you take a second and realise that I just woke you up in a dream. What happened in the real world when I did that?"

"....I don't know, one second I was reading a book, the next I blacked out." Adora let go of her with a scoff. Catra rolled her eyes and glanced at the floor. "That book?" Adora perked up and looked at the floor as well. "Y-yeah, that's it." She picked it up. "Right on my bookmark too."

"You had your book before you fell asleep..I had my phone." Catra took a moment before searching her pockets. "Do you have it?" Adora asked.

Catra pulled her phone out of her pocket and turned it on. A sigh of relief left her as she realized it was charged. "We can bring outside objects if we have them on us." Adora took a mental note.

"Might have been useful to bring a flashlight." Catra said, staring at the dark unlit walmart.

"I see things in there , it doesn't seem empty. But the fact that it's dark, and that thing is somewhere out there..." Adora frowned.

"We don't know what it is , we don't know what it's scared of, easy to manage in, or what it works best in." Catra added. Adora grunted. "So it'd be really risky." The two stared at each other.

"Are we gonna go in?" She asked. Catra crossed her arms and shrugged. "Hell, I don't want to encounter whatever that thing was again." Adora searched her pockets after second of silence. "Found it." She gave a small smile, showing a quarter in her hand.

"Tails. We go in." Catra said.

"Of course you are, bottom feeder" Adora commented.

"The hell is that supposed to mean?" Catra cocked an eyebrow.

"Nothing." Adora rolled her eyes and flipped the coin. She laid her left hand on it, keeping it down once it fell back. She slowly removed her hand then looked unsurprised. "Tails." Catra huffed. "Awesome." Adora scoffed. "You chose it , do n't back down now."

"I'm not."

Adora noticed Catra's clothing then looked at hers. "So we wake up here in the same clothes we went to sleep in?" She mumbled.

"I guess."

They both started to walk towards the walmart entrance. "Great, mental note, don't sleep in the nude." She said, which caused Catra to snort. "Definitely not hooking up no time soon." Adora chuckled.

Catra turned on her phone flash and went up to the doors. "Come on, pull." Catra went on the right side of the sliding door while Adora went on the left. "What about the alarm system?"

"It's a dream , there shouldn't be an alarm system." Catra reasoned.

"...Can't argue with that..Well, actually--" Adora started but was cut off by Catra giving her a quick annoyed look. "--Don't even." Adora rolled her eyes. "Whatever pleases you, lord bitchy."

"What was that?"

"Nothing."

The two pulled on the doors. The doors opened pretty easily, surprisingly. They were both in slight shock to how it didn't take much. "Either we're crazy strong, or the doors just don't work." Adora let go of the door, as did Catra. "No electricity. Frozen food and cold food won't be good." Catra turned on her flash.

"Do we even need to eat? What of we throw up or pee here? Will we piss the bed?" They walked in, Adora following next to Catra.

"Why are you asking me? I don't know, dumbass. Find out for yourself."

"What if we die, are we stuck here forever?" Adora started to ramble. Catra flicked her on her head. "Hey, calm yourself. With that big ass forehead of yours I would think you'd be smarter than that. Dying isn't the same as dream land." Adora stared at her for a moment. "First my forehead isn't big--"

"--hah, tell that to the one that pushed you out, not me." Catra smirked. Adora gave a slightly irritated look at Catra's remark. "--Secondd! What if it is the same. Nobody has come back alive from the dead and told us what it's like. And yeah, I believe in god, but it doesn't stop me from wondering if it's true." She said. Catra hummed and put her hand to her neck, touching around for her

black thin cross necklace. "Same here." She looked at it for a moment before looking back ahead of her.

"The bakery." Adora mumbled before walking over. "Catra." She called. Catra tilted and turned her head to her then followed like a cat on a leash, which Adora inadvertently giggled a bit to.

Catra raised an eyebrow. "What."

"Nothing, nothing at all." Adora grabbed a croissant box and opened it. She took one out and smelt it. "Doesn't smell stale."

"It smells?"

"Uhh..." Adora smelt it again. "Yeah." She tossed one to Catra. Catra caught it and smelt it as well. "Should that be possible?" Adora shrugged. "The hell would I know?" Catra stared with an uncertain gaze. "Eat it."

"You eat it first."

"No you're the one that opened it."

"So what if I die?"

"Even better." Catra smirked. Adora stuck her middle finger at her. "Yeah? Fuck you." She bit into the croissant. "Nah, fuck you." Catra pointed at her.

"No, fuck you." Adora pointed at her.

"Fuck me?" Catra pointed at herself

"No, fuck me, wait-- No, fuck you." Adora furrowed her eyebrows, trying to understand exactly what she's saying.

"Fuck you, fuck me." Catra crossed her arms with a smirk. "Yes." Adora said, proudfully. "Wait--no, damn it, what kind of brain twister do you have me in?"

Catra laughed at Adora's stupidity, her tail swaying in the air in a swift motion. "Dumbass."

"Shut up." Adora finished the croissant. "It's not that bad. And I feel..full? Well not exactly, it's like I'm still hungry." Catra bit into hers as well. "There, happy, we'll die together."

"Not really, then you'll be bothering me in hell." Adora scoffed. "You think you're going to hell?" Catra asked. "I hope not, but it is a possibility." Adora shrugged.

Catra chuckled weakly, which Adora noticed the slight pain in. "Yeah well you'll probably be in upper rings, I'll be in the lowest."

"Yeah, I can see it. You are a delinquent after all, loving the thrill of violence." Adora smirked and threw a baguette at her from the shelves before grabbing one herself as well. Catra caught the baguette then saw how Adora was challenging her. "..Cute, but you can't beat me at a bread fight, Adora." She smirked and set her phone down on a shelf to keep it lit atleast.

"What makes you think that?"

"Cause, the only thing you have going for you is your big forehead blocking the blows." Catra ran up and bonked her with the bread, Adora pushed her off lightly, careful not to throw her and hit her back. The two fought, exchanging violent but relatively friendly blows until Adora was on top of Catra, sitting and holding the bread next to her neck. "Boom, told you I was better." She smirked.

"Yeah? Well you just got lucky, princess, I let my guard down. Now, enough fun time and get off my lap." Adora flinched, suddenly flustered. "I know it's comfy, but we really should be looking for the lights." Catra smirked and hit her on the head with the bread once more. Adora got off immediately, which Catra got up and dusted herself off. She chuckled. "Aww, are you blushing?" Adora huffed. "Shut up." She averted her gaze.

Catra grabbed her phone. "Come on, lights and shit should be in the back offices this way." She started to walk to an employee's only section.

Adora stared, thoughtful. "How would you know that?"

"I'm a delinquent, Adorka."

Adora groaned. "Don't bri ng that back." Catra laughed a bit. "What? Adorka? I was so clever back then, still am now."

"Yeah whatever." Adora realized, again, how much Catra really annoyed her, getting rid of that flustered feeling she had in her stomach. 'There's something charming about Catra that shows charisma, surprisingly, but it also the same thing that pisses me off. Her lack of care really is something, and how insulting she is when she doesn't. Her attitude is rude, she's violent, smokes, works out, she's just a delinquent...but she's also really good looking especially for a jackass. Sexy? Hot? Alluring? what's the word for it?'

"Daydreaming in the dream world? And I've thought I've seen everything." Catra commented. Adora perked up and stared at Catra, she rolled her eyes. "..Provocative, that's the word.." She mumbled. Catra looked behind her again. "What? And catch up." Adora caught up to her. "I wonder how BrightMoon will look."

"There's probably a map we can find here. Come on, or I'll leave you behind."

"You wouldn't, I'm the only thing keeping you sane."

Catra rolled her eyes. "I'm insane enough without you around." Adora scoffed.

Catra opened the door to the main office and went towards the key power switches. "We're gonna be here for hours when you think about it, we got here around the same time, so maybe 6 hours of sleep?"

"Are we technically getting any sleep? I woke up this morning, tired."

"..Same here, but I always wake up tired."

"Are you a heavy sleeper?" Adora asked, not sure what it had to do with anything. Catra sighed. "I have insomnia so I guess you could say I'm a pretty light sleeper." Adora perked up. "Insomnia? That's..wait let me remember."

"Take your time." Catra picked at the power switches.

"You have trouble sleeping, staying asleep and falling asleep." Adora said. "Correct." Catra nodded. "It could be the slight change of sound in my air conditioner that wakes me up, so I'm kind of surprised that I'm still sleeping right now."

"Isn't that good then?"

"I guess, I don't know." Catra grunted and managed to switch the power on after playing with them for a while. "Lights baby!" She smirked toothily. "They don't make em like me no more." Catra said proudly. Adora huffed. "Stop being a hater of the player, Carrero."

"I'm not."

"Yuh huh. Sure you aren't." Catra flexed her muscles that showed very clearly because of her only wearing a tanktop. "Fuck yeah, I knew messing with electrical shit when I was younger was gonna get me somewhere." She walked out of the main office and they started to make their way down aisles after grabbing a cart.

"We should get the bikes or four wheelers. That would make all of this so easier."

"Yeah, but you know what would be easy?"

"What?" Catra asked before watching Adora get into the cart. "Mush mush." She demanded. Catra stared before snickering and

pushing the cart. She first turned into the candy and chip aisle before going to the bike aisle. "Goddamn, fatass." Catra said, having to turn the cart.

Adora scoffed, biting into a twix bar. "Shut up, you like right twix."

"And you like fucking left twix. You're such a weirdo."

"How do you like right??"

"Bitch, right is right! Right twix is the right answer!"

"No it's not, left is so much better."

"Choke on my left testicle, left twix is so bad. It's crunchy cookie, and drizzled caramel. Right is cascaded in caramel and crispy cookie, you can't argue against that."

"But I can and I will, damn it." She threw a left twix at Catra which hit her. Catra threw a chip bag at her. "Get your fat ass out the cart and choose a bike." Catra choose a dark red and black bike while Adora chose a white black and gold one. They managed to get them down and put it in the cart.

As they went around the section, searching for add ons to put on the bikes. Catra suddenly gasped. "Wait, holy shit, don't they have guns here?"

"I don't know? Aren't they BBs?"

"Anything is better than nothing." Catra pulled the end of the cart while Adora pushed it. They went to a firearm section and searched around. "Ooo~ Rifle, my favorite." Catra pulled it out from behind the counter. "It's real?"

Catra opened it then read the box. "Yeah. But there's BB bullets." Adora tossed her a small box of rifle bullets. Catra caught it. "Thanks, love." Adora cocked an eyebrow. "Ew, don't call me that."

"Not until I find my favorite nickname, Carrero." Catra loaded the rifle then aimed it at an open section and stared through the scope. "Don't shoot that."

"Obviously. I'm not a dumbass, unlike you."

Adora opened her mouth to say something but closed it. "Yeah, get humbled." Catra smirked, causing Adora to roll her eyes. "I don't have enough energy to deal with you right now."

"When do you ever?"

"True."

Catra hummed and lowered her gun. "What if there's other people in this world? All of us sharing a dream." She wondered to herself. Adora glanced at her, pondering whether to say anything. "We need to get moving, we got jumped here last night. No reason to not think that thing is still around."

"Backpacks." Adora said.

"Hm?" Catra looked back at her. "Backpacks." She repeated. "We can use them. One of us packs food the other packs liquids and we both add medicine things inside.Think of it as a zombie appocolypse."

"Smart idea, suprisingly. Alright, come on, back to the cart. And watch the surroundings."

"Yeah."

These bikes are pretty good." Catra messed with the settings as they rode. "You got your map right?" Adora asked. "Uhuh." Catra answered. "BrightMoon is so far to be biking. We're gonna be at this for days."

"It's worth it being in somewhere recognizable. Plus, now we have a faster way of getting away from that demon."

"Yeah I'm not trying to experience that again."

"We've never died, so the brain knows nothing about it, that's why we woke up instantly, I'm guessing."

"It felt like my heart was missing and I was sweating cold bullets." Adora said. "Mhm." Catra agreed. They rode next to each other, riding down the road, on their way to BrightMoon.

"So, you and Robbie." Adora tried to start conversation.

"What about me and him?" Catra asked, wondering what Adora was getting at. "You know he likes you, right?"

Catra sucked her teeth in annoyance. "It's obvious, he brings me food every class I have him in and he always looks for ways to talk to me." Adora noticed how she spoke about him. "Soo you don't like him? What will you do when he confesses?"

"I'll tell him off, then go after his sister."

"That's a dick move, Catra."

"I am a dick move...but nah, I'm kidding. Poor kid has suffered enough." Catra responded. "And I'm gay, pretty sure he knows that. I've told him atleast, maybe it didn't get through his thick skull. Or he thought he could change me." She suddenly laughed. "My mom tried that, now that I look back on it, it's kind of funny."

"My mom was convinced me being bisexual was a phase and didn't care. She just pushed a lot of men in my face and that was that." Adora sighed. "We haven't talked in a long while."

"I talked to mine a few weeks ago, but, you know, she couldn't really talk back."

"Why not?"

"The 6 feet of dirt pretty much blocks anything she want to say, that and the fact her lungs are decomposed." Catra smiled in relief. "Uh..sorry to hear that?" Adora said in confusion. "Don't worry about it, I hated her anyways. Hearing her voice would probably send me down a grave too."

"I'm guessing she wasn't the best."

"You guess correct...What happened with you and Caleb?"

"Caleb?"

"Yeah, you two looked perfect for each other. But he broke up with you." Catra said. Adora scoffed. "Did he tell you he broke up with me? I broke up with him. That jackass was cheating on me and he only wanted me to sleep with him. Kept pushing me to get with him at his house and I kept refusing."

"I'm glad you did, he had a thing for getting girls pregnant and not doing anything for them. You having a baby with that jackass probably would have pissed me off more than seeing you now."

Adora perked then smirked. "Caring kind of suits you, Catra." Catra rolled her eyes and huffed. "That's the first and last time I will." Adora let out a chuckle.

Later down the different roads they started to get tired.

"Shit, isn't it weird to get tired during a dream?" Adora stopped her bike with her foot to the ground.

"You're telling me." Catra exhaled before looking around. "Lets find a house and settle for the night, I don't know if it's just me but the sky looks like it's getting darker."

"When is it never?" Adora glanced at her.

"True."

Adora brought her bike over to her and stared as Catra pulled out the map. "There's a neighborhood over there, come on. We'll find a room, lock the doors just in case then go to sleep."

"We have to share a room?" Adora complained. "Use your thick ass brain, Adora. That way we'll be safer and we'll stick together."

"Would have never guessed us, Catra and Adora, sticking together." Adora crossed her arms. Catra shook her head. "Believe me when I say, me either."

The two rode again, finding a well safe enough looking house and brought their bikes inside before going up the stairs to the master bedroom.

Adora locked the doors while Catra checked the room for anything. After wards, they closed blinds and sat on the Queen bed. Adora groaned. "I don't wanna sleep on a bed with you. That's probably the worst torture method ever."

Catra scoffed. "When I wake up, you better not be next to me in real life." She said as she laid down, ruffling her hair up with her hand. "Same to you. It'd be like living two nightmares." Adora laid down as well, the two sleeping opposite sides and looking away from each other.

Catra grunted with a amused smile upon her face. "Uhuh, night."

"Night...Or morning I guess."

"..Shut up."

Adora huffed and closed her eyes.

Catra woke up in her bed, she sat up and looked at her phone. It was around the same percentage she slept with it on however a little lower.

6 am. And it still feels like she didn't get a wink of sleep. Catra groaned and stretched before standing. She scratched her stomach, lifting her tank top just a bit. "Melog." Catra called. Her feline friend immediately trilled to her voice and stretched on her bed. "Sorry for keeping the door closed on you, bud." She opened the door and kept it open for him to go eat or use the bathroom as he so pleases.

Melog meowed and jumped off the bed. Catra went into her bathroom and took a long cold shower to freshen up then changed into a dark green hoodie and black cargo pants. She dried her hair then pulled her phone up and looked through her contacts. She then went through her instagram. "There you are." Catra said before tapping Adora's profile. She went to messages.

Catra: Bitch unblock me on regular messages 👺🤬

Adora: You bother me in my dreams now you want to bother me irl, what is it?

Catra: Can't talk, government is watching

Adora: 😔 This is why I blocked you.

Catra: Y u block 🥺

Adora: I don't like you, I had your number and I didn't want to recieve any messages from you after you airdropped me fucking PORN.

Catra: ☠️ Okay but that was hilarious, click bait is amazing

Adora: No it wasn't, my volume was on and those two were screaming.

Catra: Bet you saved it

Adora: As a matter of fact, I *didn't*.

Catra: Sure you didn't

Adora: And actually, how do you know my insta?

Catra: Don't worry about it

After a few moments, Adora started typing.

Adora: Wait a minute, are you following me? Now isn't that cute.

Catra: 😳

Catra: It wasn't me, was Lonnie. Also, you're following me too

Adora: ...Just, get off my phone, don't you have school to get to?

Catra: You're the fucking nerd, I skip classes

Adora: Oh that's right, forgot you were a low life.

Catra: Hardy har, bitch ass

Adora: 😔 Hoodlum

Catra: Teacher dick rider

Adora: I don't have time for you right now

Catra: Well, you'll have time for me tonight

Adora: 😳

Catra: You know what I meant

Adora: Yeah whatever you say

Adora scoffed and put her phone back in her pocket. *'So annoying.'* She grabbed her backpack

3

"Wait, Catra!"

Catra stopped walking towards the football field, her tail swaying close to the floor as she glanced back at Robby. A guy that hanged close to her since her Freshman year. She considered him a friend, *kind of*. It was more she used him for what he offered instead, but it was cool to have him around sometimes. He had curly dirty blonde hair with light green eyes, he was also slim and athletic.

She knew he liked her, it was painfully obvious, and he didn't seem to mind that Catra was basically using him and slightly leading him on.

"Whatttt." She put a pocky stick in her mouth. "I got my soccer ball today, wanna play?"

"Football players are on the field." Catra made an exscuse. "When have you ever cared about that?" He asked. "...You're right."

"Exactly, come on, you're not getting out of this." He walked further onto the field, followed by Catra who dragged behind. She wore a white shirt, black cargo pants, with her dark green hoodie wrapped around her waist. She also had her thin black cross necklace, a black ring, and her tattoos showing.

While Robby wore a green shirt, a letterman jacket and jeans. Catra groaned and scratched behind her neck. Her eyes grazed around the field, noticing Lonnie walking over.

They did their secret handshake then stopped once Robby did. He put his soccer ball on the floor then kicked it up and passed it to Catra.

Catra passed it to Lonnie, who did a couple tricks with it before headbutting it back to Robby. "You look like you haven't had a

wink of any sleep." Lonnie commented, putting her hands on her waist. She wore an orange hoodie with black sweatpants. "Should I add '*as usual*' ?"

"Ha. Ha. *Very funny*. Is it that noticable?" Catra huffed, finishing the pocky stick she had in her mouth and replacing it for another. "To me at least." Lonnie smiled.

Robby kicked it over again but weakly, which the two started to notice. "Come onn Robert, put your goddamn spine into the kick." Lonnie crossed her arms. Robby scoffed and backed up from the ball to a tremendous amount. "Yeah, you're catching that." Lonnie backed away from Catra.

"What?? Hell no--! This is your fault, you should catch it." Catra elbowed her. "No idea what you're talking about. He likes you, not me."

"What does that have to do with me?" Catra cocked an eyebrow. "He's doing it to impress you."

"That ball is going to take my head off--!" Suddenly Robby kicked the ball and nearly, nick of time, Catra ducked her head and her ears. The ball hit something with a very loud thud.

Catra whipped her head behind her to check what it hit and that's when her heart immediately sank. "Hey...Isn't that Adora and her friends? You're lucky you dodged on time." Lonnie came over to her.

"You think?" Catra gave an annoyed look. "I think it hit someone."

She could see Adora's friends, Glimmer, Bow, Perfuma, Mermista, all of them surrounding someone on the ground, checking on them. "Uh oh, did I hit someone?" Robby came running over

"Did you hit someone? *Did you hit someone??* Yes, you *fucking* hit someone, Robby!" Catra retorted. Robby frowned before perking up. "Oh it's just Adora. She'll be fine."

'Adora--? Wait..no, fuck, is she alright?' Her tail thrashed around in conflicted anger and worry. Catra clenched her fist. She noticed how Glimmer was stomping over their way.

She grabbed Catra by her collar. "Listen I don't know what your fucking deal is, but now you've gone too far! Adora is unconcious because of your fucking ball."

Catra flinched. "--She's unconcious? Robby you fucking knocked her out?? What the fuck man?!"

"Hey, I didn't mean too! And what are you getting mad at me for?! I thought you hated her!"

"Robby, you dumbass! Nobody told you to kick the ball that hard!" Lonnie said.

"I don't care who's fault it is! You hurt Adora, now you're fucked!" Glimmer clenched Catra's collar. Catra noticed Caleb, Adora's ex picking her up. "What is that jackass doing?" Catra growled and smacked Glimmer's hands off of her. Glimmer glanced behind them. "He's the only one strong enough to easily bring Adora to the clinic." She glared.

Catra scoffed and pushed her aside. Caleb was nearly there to the double doors before Catra stopped him.

"Catra, what the hell do you want. Just so you know, I'm not afraid to fight you right now."

"I don't care about you or anyone else right now, give me Adora." Catra glared. Caleb flinched then glared back at her. "The fuck do you mean give her to you? After you knocked her out??!"

"That wasn't me! Now give her over."

"No! I'm her boyfriend, I'll bring her to the clinic, so fuck off Michalka!"

"Exactly what I thought, you fucking delusional piece of shit. You're her ex and you're a goddamn sexual assaulter, why would I leave her with you?"

"Why do you even care?!"

"Caleb, let go of Adora. ***Right now***." Catra's tone changed to a more deathly feel. She was serious, more serious than she ever has been. Her teal eye dulled while the other shone with a predatory gaze.

Her tail hung low. Caleb's pupils dilated in a realization of fear. He froze, his heart racing but his face forcibly regular. Caleb slowly gave Adora to Catra in hesitation. "Good choice." Catra said.

Catra held Adora in bridal style as did Caleb when he held her. "Open the door" She demanded. Caleb did as said and Catra walked into the hallway, holding Adora.

'What was that? That feeling of..power I just had. Caleb was scared....Damn it, I was just so pissed, all for this dumb fucking blonde.' Catra looked down at her. Adora looked peaceful, being unconcious and all. Cute even.

As she brought Adora to the clinic, recieving stares from others that walked down the hallways as well, it suddenly occurred to Catra, that Adora is in a type of sleeping state. *'Shit--Is Adora in that hell by herself? And she won't wake up for a while, damn it!--Why do I care??'*

"We'll understand this thing soon enough." She mumbled.

Catra eventually made it to the clinic and laid Adora down on one of the bed cots. The nurse rushed over and checked her. "Oh my--how did this happen?!"

"She was hit by a ball." Catra averted her gaze.

"Complete utter bullcrap, Michalka, there's no way a ball knocked her out like this" The nurse checked her vitals. "Now, I knew you

two didn't always get along but did you seriously have to damage her goods like this?"

"Mrs. Whitman, I'm telling you, it wasn't me. I can swear on my life." Catra said with honesty. "So why'd you of all people bring her? That doesn't seem likely of you to volunteer yourself."

"I know, it's weird isn't it." Catra crossed her arms. Mrs. Whitman was a professional nurse with healing powers, she was a brown skinned woman with light caramel eyes and a beautiful dark afro.

"Sit down, you aren't hurt either are you?"

"...Actually, I'm really tired." She frowned. Mrs. Whitman stared at her for a moment, analyzing her from afar. "Alright, take a nap right there."

"Thanks, and..can you wake me up when she does?"

"Sure, did you two become friends or something?"

"Nope." Catra got on the other cot before dozing off.

--

Catra opened her eyes slowly, waking up in the same room she fell asleep in the other night. She shot up, frantically searching around until her eyes landed on Adora, who laid next to her in a calm state. She was staring at her. "Rise and shine, Catra."

"--Adora!" Catra sighed in relief. She then turned and grabbed her face and inspected it. "What are you-- let me go" Adora grabbed her wrist. Catra, repositioned herself on top of her, pushing through Adora's grip and moved some of her hair to inspect her head. "The hell is wrong with you!?"

"So, either injuries aren't transferred here or you didn't get and visible injuries from the hit." Catra mumbled.

"So you do know something about it? All I remember was that I was eating during my peaceful lunch break and suddenly I was hit by some fucking brick or something and everything was blurry. Last I saw was Caleb, don't tell me they let him touch me."

"Well, you were hit by something alright. A soccer ball."

"You hit me--?!"

"No-! I didn't, It was Robby. He tried showing off and kicked the ball at me, I moved and it hit you."

"Kind of wishing it hit you instead of me being alone here. Figured I shouldn't have woken you up or you'd probably faint in the middle of whatever you were doing."

Catra snorted. "Then we both would've been unconcious on the floor. If it hit me, would you have brought me to the clinic too?" Adora perked up. "You brought me to the clinic? When I last saw the face of that jackass, Caleb, I thought he brought me to where ever."

"No...I stopped him and carried you instead."

Adora smirked. "Aw."

Catra rolled her eyes and moved her hands away from her before getting off. Adora felt a little..dissapointed in some way when Catra removed herself.

"So you came to be my knight in shining casual clothes." Adora hummed. "I'll be here for a while then? What will you do? There's still school."

"I'll knock myself out too?"

That earned a chuckle out of Adora. "Seriously?" Catra laid down in bed. "I could, but what could I get out of that?"

"More time with me, give me piss worthy company. Something to keep me sane and less nervous here." Adora glanced at her. "Tempting, love, but no." Catra smirked.

"Love?" Adora ignored the leap her heart took. "Didn't I tell you not to call me that?"

"When's the last time I cared what you tell me to call you?"

Adora scoffed *"You just never rest with the nicknames, do you?"*

"Nope."

Silence engulfed the two for a short time before Adora spoke up.

"You know...getting hit by that ball wasn't so bad. Call me a masochist but that feeling of pain and slowly losing concious felt..free. Like I was just going to sleep forever."

'The acceptance of death. I wished it too many times to count.' Catra listened. "I-I know what you mean." Adora glanced at her. "..I'm surprised you cared, that's very unlike you."

"It's because I realized you'd be in this hell, alone. And I didn't trust Caleb to bring you."

"Uhuh, or you're getting soft."

"I'm not getting soft just cause I carried your jock fatass to the clinic. Consider it a truce cause we're in this shitty place together."

Adora perked up then sat up and stared down at Catra. "..Sure, why not. We can go back to not caring after we get out of this hell." She said, averting her gaze. "What are we gonna call this place anyways?"

"Let's call it hell."

"Not good enough." Adora huffed. Catra turned on her side as Adora laid right back down, watching the ceiling. "Well, it's a

liminal space."

Adora hummed, thinking. "Oh! I got it, let's call it the Limbo."

Catra cocked an eyebrow. "Limbo?"

"Limbo is basically the place where spirits go to either go to heaven or hell, stuck in a liminal space." Adora explained, gaining a snort and a remark out of Catra. "Fucking nerd." The other gave her an annoyed gaze. "That's one way to say I'm smarter than you, Catra."

"Whatever, blondie."

"You know, I was gonna continue our journey but, we came here on two bikes with supplies and I'd have to carry you."

"True. Wouldn't want to put yourself in danger. We have a few hours right?" Catra reasoned. Adora nodded. "Hey, we haven't seen a single vehicle since we got here, have we?" She noticed. Catra sat up and went to the window. "No, we haven't. Either it's a limbo thing, or we're on the wrong side of town."

"What if there's other people here?"

"Could that be possible? I mean, I doubt it." Catra took the jacket off of her waist and threw it behind her on the bed. "That could explain the missing cars and shit. Let's think of it as a zombie appocolypse."

"Always with the games, Carrero. This is real..well, you know what I mean. Sharing a dream isn't normal but it doesn't mean we should treat it like a game."

"Well, I wasn't saying that, Michalka." Adora got off the bed with a gruff. "An appocolypse could happen in real life but just take the time to realise our situation here. Everytime we enter R.E.M we just pop up here into the same resting bodies we left here. Meaning this world never stops even after we're done dreaming, and when we do go back to the real world, we're as tired as we

were when dreaming. We also learned that we could wake up a person here, however that would put the same person to sleep in the real world."

"And we legitamently got killed by a fucking demon a two days ago. But we immediately woke up, because the brain cannot process death, are you understanding me?"

"I'm not a dumbass, Adora. Don't fucking treat me like one." Catra growled, crossing her arms. "Likewise." Adora furrowed her eyebrows as she proved her point. "Also, lest we forget, the night this all happened, Lonnie was pushed off a damn building. We saw her die, but she was suddenly back like it was nothing, right after we took that smoke. There's a connection somewhere and we're mixed in it." Adora huffed. "Have you noticed anything off with Lonnie recently?"

"Not really, I haven't seen her that much since that day."

"Try keeping an eye on her."

"What am I, her goddamn stalker? I don't need you bossing me around and Lonnie is just fine."

"Catra, I'm not trying to boss you around, I'm just suggesting for our own benefit. If you keep an eye on her to see if anything's changed, maybe we can learn a bit more about this." Adora sighed, not feeling in the mood to argue with her. Catra put her hand to her face, hiding her expression, which made Adora slightly nervous.

Catra groaned after a moment of thinking. "Maybe I've been disillusioned." She mumbled. "No, anything's better than ***them*** *."*

"What?"

"...Maybe it was something in those cigarettes." She digged in her pockets. "You still have the same pack?" Adora asked. "Of course, I'm not a druggie, I don't go through one in a whole day." Catra gave her an accusitory look.

"Would have never guessed." Adora said lowly to herself. "What-fucking-ever." Catra pulled her hand out, finding nothing then picked up her shirt. Adora's heart skipped a beat. 'Shit, I shouldn't be surprised, I knew she'd have abs.' She glanced away then looked back at what Catra had been grabbing. '..And scars. They don't look that old.' Adora stopped herself from engaging in her intrusive thoughts to touch the scars.

The cigarettes were slightly hidden in her pants waist as the other half were above them. Catra took the small box and opened it. She then grabbed one and took her lighter out of her shoe. "Seriously?" Adora questioned.

"What? Gotta be extra cautious, princess."

"What if you accidently burn your foot?"

"Pretty sure that's impossible"

"Okay then, what if it breaks?"

Catra frowned. "Then I'll have lighter fluid smelling shoes and socks?" Adora rolled her eyes. "I really do hope you get caught."

"Never." She smirked then lit her cigarette.

Adora flinched then snatched it out of Catra's mouth. "Are you actually kidding me?" She stubbed it out onto the small wooden window counter. "Oh come on--! W hat now?"

"This shit is what got us here in the first place."

"How would we know that? Maybe the building was fucking haunted or something."

"Still, we don't know what this will do? Try getting a different brand or stop smoking, which is way better."

"Who are you, my goddamn mom? If I'm gonna stay in this life, I might as well go out how I want."

Adora frowned, however snatched the box of cigarettes. "Hey!" Catra tried grabbing them back. "Don't make me fucking hurt you, Carrero, I don't care if you're in a concussion right now." She snarled. Adora scoffed. "Oh boo hoo, you're a soccer player, don't ruin your lungs so soon."

"Princess, this body was already ruined before I started smoking." Catra rolled her eyes. Adora huffed then opened the window and threw the cigarettes out.

"What the actual shit Adora?!"

Adora closed the window and locked it again. "..Smoking is bad for you, especially once you get addicted, Catra."

"You fucking bitch!" Catra grabbed her by her collar and pulled her close. "Hit me. Do it. But do remember, for the rest of the time we're in the situation, we've made a truce. I've seen that shit ruin people, my own family. Don't go down that route." She said, firmly.

Catra's expression hesitantly softened, she let go of Adora and sighed. "Yeah? Well, still, fuck you. I'm already ruined." Her tail swayed low.

"Also Catra, we don't know what those will do after they put us here, it's a bad idea."

"Yeah yeah, I hear you, damn it."

"Sorry, I...I mean it."

"Doesn't matter, just-- don't do that shit again." Catra grumbled, staring out the window. "I know, it's just--" Adora suddenly fell to the ground. Catra jumped a bit. "Hey--! Adora?" She got on her knees and inspected her.

"She must have woken up. Damn--" Catra paused, suddenly feeling a pressence in front of her.

It wasn't Adora.

Catra raised her head and stared above her.

A shadow figure of her 'mother' stared down at her. The figure didn't speak, it just stared, its blank but also deathly gaze shattering Catra's senses and instincts. She was paralyzed seeing even the figure of Shadow Weaver, it shook her body to it's core.

"No." *Her blood ran cold once she heard the figure speak along with her. As if it were mocking her.* ***"No no no, get away."*** *Catra's hands began to shake. She stared to back away, kicking her feet back .*

The figure abruptly smiled. It's smiling going beyond it's cheek though it had the body of a human. Catra's ear lowered. She's never felt this much fear in what felt like a long time.

Adora choked on her own breath as she shot up from the cot bed. "Fuck--" She cursed quietly as she coughed.

"My--! Adora, are you alright?" Mrs. Whitman rushed over to her. "Y-yes ma'am..just had a bad dream? My head hurts."

"Well you were just hit in the head with a ball, I'm glad you're alright. But you shouldn't even be awake right now after being hit that hard."

Adora groaned a bit. "Yep, me too...Where's Catra?"

"Catra, she's right there? Did I miss an interaction, didn't know you two become buddy buddy."

"Don't worry, we're not." Adora huffed and held her head. "Here I'll go get you some water and ice then I'll wake up Catra."

Adora frowned. "Could you..wake her up first?"

Mrs. Whitman cocked an eyebrow before obliging. "Okay." She walked over to Catra and went to tap her however Catra woke up abruptly before she could even tap her.

Catra scrambled, falling off of the cot and backing to a corner. She breathed heavily, sweating, her pupils dilated. Her nails were unscheathed, her hairs raised.

Adora and Mrs. Whitman stared at her in concern. "Catra, hun, whats up? Nightmare?"

Catra didn't speak, she became quiet immediately, hearing her voice. She stayed in her shaken state for a moment. Mrs. Whitman tried to help, however, was almost injured by Catra.

"Maybe it's best she's left alone?" Adora drank the small cup of water. "...Catra." Mrs. Whitman called.

Catra took a good second before answering. "I'm fine.." She stood, fixing her hair, her breathing seemed normal. Adora could tell she wasn't fine at all. Her nails were still unscheathed and her hands were still shaking. *'What happened after I woke up?'* She wondered. Catra exhaled then looked at Adora. "You're not dead."

"Nope, I'm not dead yet, gonna take more than a ball to kill me." Adora winked. Catra smirked and rolled her eyes. "Yeah, your big fat ass head probably took the shock for you."

"Oh fuck you" Adora scoffed with a slight smirked.

"Profanity, girls." Mrs. Whitman shook her head with a smile. "Sorry" "My bad." They both said simultaniously before gazing at each other. "I'll leave you two alone for now, Adora you should get home. Want me to call your parents?"

"No--!" Adora flinched then winced. "Don't call them, I'll get home on my own."

"I'm not letting you drive home, girl."

"Then..I'll get one of my friends to."

"Do you really not want to deal with your parents?"

"I want them to continue to leave me alone." Adora huffed. "Get an uber." Catra shrugged. "Hell no. You want me to get kidnapped?"

"Wouldn't be so bad for me, would it?"

"Jackass."

"Blonde bitch."

"Girls, language, again--!" Mrs. Whitman said from her desk.

"Sorry." "My bad." They said again before glancing at each other again. "You want me to take you home then?" Catra suggested. Adora perked. "You? Aw~"

"Shut up, either take the offer or no."

Adora chuckled. "It might seem weird if the others hear about you bringing me home. I'll be fine, just tell..Bow, that I need a ride home. I'm sure Glimmer's too pissed."

"Maybe she'll knock some kind of sense into your thick skull."

"What did I do? And I'm sure the ball knocked enough sense into me."

"Nothing, I'm just saying."

Adora scoffed and drank more water. Catra took out her phone and snapped a picture of Adora. "Hey, what the hell was that for?"

"Gotta have proof that you got your shit rocked." She took a selfie of them both. Adora rolled her eyes and stuck her middle finger up. Catra smirked. "*Que linda*" (How cute) She mumbled.

"I'll go get Arrowboy but if Sparkles gives me shit, I can't promise you anything."

Adora rolled her eyes. "Just tell her I'm fine and just need to stay at her house."

"..hmmm..Okay, we'll talk about payment later."

"Payment?"

"I'm not a civilized person for free, you know." Catra huffed and left the clinic.

"Adora, your friends had actually came to visit you not too long ago, I would tell them that it was all a misunderstanding, Glimmer seems to be very angry."

Adora sighed. "I could imagine she is. May I have my computer, please?"

"Work after a concussion? You really are different."

"I'm not sure whether that's an insult or a compliment."

"Don't worry about it."

"Hey, Catra, you alright?" Lonnie popped up as Catra was as her locker. "Uh, yeah?" Catra shrugged. "Why?" Lonnie cocked an eyebrow and crossed her arms. "I saw you storm over to Caleb and take Adora, you seemed pissed."

Catra huffed. "I *was* pissed. But it's alright now, have you seen ArrowBoy?"

"hmmm, nope. Actually, yeah, he's over there." Lonnie pointed beside her. Catra glanced to her left, seeing Bow speaking to Perfuma at his locker. "Thanks."

"What do you need him for?"

Catra groaned a bit. "Mrs. Whitman told me to get one of Adora's friends to bring her home." Lonnie hummed. "Well, my mom is having a cook out later today, she invited you and some others."

"Sure, I'll be there, tell me when to come."

"Alright, see you later then?"

"Yep." Catra smiled, as did Lonnie. Catra walked over to Bow once Lonnie was gone and stuffed her hands in her pocket.

"ArrowBoy, you have a minute?"

Bow perked, Perfuma and him stared at her. "Uh..What's up, Catra?" Catra averted her gaze for a moment. "Just came back from the clinic, Adora was wondering if you could bring her to you or Sparkles's house." She scratched the back of her neck.

"Oh, sure. Is she feeling okay?"

"For the most part, yeah." Catra shrugged. Bow frowned. "Say, Catra, I'm sorry for how Glimmer acted back there. I know it wasn't your fault." Catra stared at him for a moment. "We were just worried-"

"--Yeah, I get it. Just go bring her, I don't need an apology."

Perfuma and Bow glanced at each other again. "Then..how about a thank you for bringing her?" Perfuma smiled a bit. "We didn't exactly trust either you or Caleb to bring her, but we trusted you more than him." Catra's ear twitched. "..No problem." She then turned around and went her seperate way.

-

Stop, Please!" Catra cried, struggling to get out of the grip of Shadow Weaver's new boyfriend.

"Is this your little shit, Shawna? I thought you said no one lived with you, that we wouldn't be disturbed." He said, stomping

downstairs halfway before pausing while dragging Catra by her hair.

Shadow Weaver glanced uninterested at Catra. She sat on the dirty and sweaty dark brown couch, wearing a black lingerie.

"Unfortunetely. We won't be bothered though, she behaves in her room as long as you beat it into her. Do you want the honors, Jacob?"

"Do I? She looks like she hasn't had a proper beating at all today. I'm all well with putting a child in their place." The man, Jacob threw Catra down the rest of the stairs. He then smirked before zipping up his pants and taking off his belt. "You inturrupted the grown ups with your loud ass nightmares. What's your name kid?"

Catra said nothing in fear. She glanced at Shadow Weaver, hoping for some type of protection from the strange man, even if she was similary afraid of her.

Shadow Weaver stared at her with what seemed like concern but mostly no care. Catra could tell she didn't really like doing this kind of stuff to her so why? 'Why does she just let it happen?' "Answer him." She said. 'Why?!' Catra franticly looked around for anything, anything that could help her.

"I--I'm sorry. I'm sorry! I didn't mean to make noise while I was asleep. I won't ever do it again, please don't hit me!" Catra begged. The man didn't listen to her cries, he instead bended his belt in half, holding the leather part and whirlled it around as if he was holding a bat.

"Batterr up!" He swung the belt, hitting Catra in the face with the metal buckle. Her right canine tooth fell out of her mouth as well as blood. Catra put her shaking hand to her cheek then felt for her tooth. She cried, her tail whipping in response to her stress and pain.

He laughed. "Woah, that was exhilerant! You know, I got a few friends." The man walked over to Shadow Weaver and started to

make a move on her on the couch. The two kissed, Shadow Weaver moaning a questioning grunt to his suggestion. "They'd pay real good money to play with a kid like her during the weekends. Or during the week if that's what you want."

"Good money, hm? How much are we talking?" The man zipped his pants down. "a couple hundreds, depending on which one likes her best, could be a thousands."

The two stopped kissing. "Catra. Go to your room."

Catra's ears and tail stayed down as she picked her tooth up and went upstairs to her room. "Make sure you clean up that damn mess before I get up tommorow!" She yelled. Catra felt her knees go weak once she reached her door. She fell to the floor but still tried to go into her room.

As soon as she got into her room, she fell to her knees once more and cried quietly. Melog came from under her bed to comfort her. Catra let him before managing to stand up again. "Outside." She mumbled, walking over to her window. She only wore a dark grey, now semi bloody, shirt and dark grey pants.

Catra carefully opened her window and crawled out onto the freezing snow. She ran left into the woods, followed by Melog. As soon as she reached her favorite tree, she fell purposely face first into the snow, letting her cheek heal in the freezing temperatures. Catra used her hands to make a snow ball while laying down and put it in her mouth where her tooth got knocked out.

Melog curled and laid in her hair , he purred, keeping his body heat and sharing with Catra.

"What did I do wrong, Melog? I've only been obedient. Why do they keep hurting me?"

Melog responded in a meow, his beautiful maroon fur swayed to the left, as did Catra's hair as a breath of wind passed them. "I wish I could see the world..see BrightMoon. Maybe go to the moon, what about you?"

"Meow." He trilled, speaking about the chase of mice and birds and napping. "Well that isn't much exciting, but the cat part of me can agree." Catra giggled a bit.

"..I don't think I can sleep anymore, this is the second time I got in trouble because of it. It should be easy to stay up, that way no nightmares." She pet Melog then scratched underneath his chin. Melog purred in content and trilled once more.

4

It's getting cooler. Winter is coming soon again, it's Catra's favorite season, so of course she was slightly excited. Her attention, currently, was focused on her ceiling. She didn't get any sleep at all, just like when she was younger, every sounds, every shift in the air woke her. She was instinctively scared, feeling as if Shadow Weaver will secretly and quietly call her, *whisper her name just to beat her.*

Catra began to hum a soft song she remembered hearing from a guitarist at a resturant when she was younger. Shadow Weaver had brought her to this fancy resturant to meet some client with a child as well, though a toddler. The man's soft voice had filled the room along with the smooth strumming of his guitar strings. Catra realized that she hasn't touched her guitar in years, nor her piano. It had been a while since she was happy, even with Lonnie, she can't escape everything.

The very emotional damaged magicat picked up her phone from it's wireless charger and went to Lonnie's contact. A friend that's been with her through a lot of her turmoil and asshole era. She rang her to which Lonnie answered in only a few rings. "Yess?"

"Hey." Catra said with a tired voice.

"What's up? No motivation again?" She asked.

"Well...Yeah."

"Want me to come over? We can grilll~ And get in the pool!" Lonnie said with a happy encouraging tone. Catra groaned. "But it's the morning."

"Uhm, It's noon, were you in your bed all morning? Or did you just wake up?"

Catra glanced at the time. 12:14 pm. "I guess I've been here all morning, seems like only a few minutes of thinking."

"Yeah, I'm coming over. We're gonna go to the mall, eat, pool, then watch movies." Lonnie huffed.

"But I don't wannaa" Catra groaned again.

"Too bad, we'll invite Kiyana, and who elseee..."

"I don't know."

"Let's invite Adora, you're getting mushy with her, aren't you?"

"--*Hell* no. Not happening, that'd be the best way to ruin my day completely."

Lonnie chuckled. "Sorry sorry, just saying my observations."

"Well shut it." Catra rolled her eyes. "Either way, I'm coming over with Kiyana's car. Get readyy." Lonnie said, happily. "Sure." Catra replied, simply.

They soon got off the phone with each other.

Catra went to her shower and stripped her clothes off so she could take a cool shower. She washed her hair then stayed in for a while more before getting out and changing into a cream colored hoodie and tan cargo pants with a thin black cross necklace and a gold multi-named necklace with Kyle, Rogelio, Lonnie and her name in black.

Catra slid on her black fingerless gloves then reached for a pack of cigarettes laying on her drawer. She paused before touching it, remembering yesterday. *'Hit me. Do it. But do remember, for the rest of the time we're in the situation, we've made a truce. I've seen that shit ruin people, my own family. Don't go down that route.'* Catra clenched her teeth for a second in confliction. "Fuck." She said breahlessly before hesitantly grabbing it. "Stupid jock

blonde making me second guess myself." Catra slid it halfway into the waist of her pants.

'One cool thing about the Hormercury's, they are match box cigarettes with a pocket full of matches.' Catra nodded in content. She slid some black and white jordans on then went downstairs to feed Melog.

"Meoww" He whined. "Yeah yeah, I got you." Catra hummed while grabbing the big bag full of cat food. "Turn on the news for me, I feel like an Etherian citizen."

Melog trilled and walked over to the couch before jumping on it and clicking the remote. He changed the channels, eventually landing on a news channel.

"Hurricane Jason strikes the coast of Sealeanies now, their president has agreed, along with their forces, to execute the hurricane that had hit Thaymor horribly this past week." The news anchor began to speak. Catra grunted. "That would be best, they know how to handle water better than everyone. Hey, Melog, turn on some music." Melog meowed and obliged.

"Ding Dong, Michalkaaa!" She heard Kiyana at her door. Catra cringed in unwanted expectance. "Go awayyy!" She yelled back. "Escuse me? Don't make me pull out my keys!"

Catra groaned loudly before dragging herself over to her door and opening it, revealing Kiyana and Lonnie. Kiyana was a slim brown skinned girl with light brown gold-ish eyes and an curly mullet and black glasses. She wore a yellow turtleneck with black tights while Lonnie wore a white shirt and black jeans.

"Heyy! I heard you're being a bed potato, can't have that happening." Kiyana smirked, ruffling with Catra's hair since she was taller than her. Catra averted her gaze and swatted her hand away. "Let's just get this day over with so I can get to work later and then sleep."

"Boringgg." Lonnie scoffed. They walked in, putting their things down and sitting on the couch. "You ready?"

"Yeah..just, let's go." Catra nodded.

"Catra-- look" Lonnie shook her.

"What?" Catra perked up. She trailed Lonnie's gaze to a new candy shop. "Holy shit-- Lonnie!"

"Forget the pretzels, come on! Kiyana!" Lonnie took Catra's wrist and pulled her over to a sweets store filled with many different kinds of candy all over Etheria. Kiyana perked up as she was waiting in a line to get pretzels for her and them. She left the line and jogged over to Catra and Lonnie.

"You two are like having a couple of toddlers."

"Oh don't lie, you know you want the candy." Lonnie waved a bag of rock candy in front of her. Kiyana crossed her arms in protest before eventually giving in. "Fine" She snatched the rock candy. Catra and Lonnie chuckled.

The three grabbed hand fulls of candy and had Kiyana pay for it, since it was her turn. They then went to a restaurant, ate, then afterwards went to watch a horror movie.

Catra arrived home, tired. She ran her fingers through her hair as she went upstairs. "Sorry Melog, can't stay for long. I got called in for work, apparently some got sick and I gotta fill in." She dragged herself upstairs and went into her closet.

She changed into a burgundy button up, black pants, black tie, and black vest. Catra then put her name pin on and laid on her bed. "9:24, Melog wake me in two hours." She soon dozed off. Melog meowed in agreement.

Catra slowly opened her eyes before groaning very loudly as she turned over onto her back, remembering that sleeping leads her to the 'Limbo'. "Fuckkkk" She put her hands to her face, before feeling warm air on her neck. She glanced beside her, suddenly flinching as she noticed how close Adora was to her.

Adora was on her side facing Catra, sleeping peacefully and breathing softly. That was then when she realised that Adora had her by her waist, that's why she was so close to her neck, practically nuzzling it.

Usually, after one night stands, Catra would be the one doing that, so it felt...different to be on the other end of the stick, even if the two hadn't engaged in anything. 'Why is she so..close to me?' Catra felt the urge to immediately back away but her face slowly got warm. 'Maybe I can just separate and not say a word about this, ever.'

That's what Catra thought before she felt Adora mumble something then pull her closer. Catra huffed, trying to contemplate what to do. First, she tried removing Adora's hands off of her waist but was unsuccessful because Adora's grip was surprisingly firm even as she was sleeping. "..Fine then, more sleep for me." Catra grumbled, turning back on her side. 'At least I won't be that tired when I wake up in an hour.'

Many minutes later Catra's ear twitched, hearing Adora breath hitch as she woke up. "...Catra." Adora said lowly, trying to see if the other was up, her grip loosened significantly. Catra stayed quiet for a moment, not wanting to engage in whatever kind of conversation about the situation. "..W-what?" She stuttered.

Adora startled, immediately separating herself, falling off the bed. Catra sat up, ruffling with her hair. Adora had hit her head so she rubbed the back of it. "What the hell happened??"

Catra shrugged. "How would I know, I woke up to you cuddling me, Carrero. You getting soft on me or something?" She stared, cocking an eyebrow. Adora flinched, feeling her heart race. "Hey--

I have no idea what happened, I was asleep in Limbo the whole day. It's not my fault I move in my sleep."

She suddenly noticed what Catra was wearing. Catra smirked. "Right." She stood and fixed her tie. "..You look fancy." Adora stood then sat on the bed. "Taking a nap before going to work. Didn't expect you to wake up."

Adora hummed. "I was beyond tired so I went to sleep early. Since you're going to work, we won't really get anything done in here until you're off. When are you going?"

"2 am."

"Really? Where do you work at?"

"That new restaurant that opened recently, its really fancy and shit. I got two hours of time though, let's get some distance from this place."

"Fine, if you say so." Adora stood up, fixing her sleeves, she wore a white turtleneck, light jeans, and a few golden jewelry. Catra scoffed. "Where'd you go?"

"What do you mean?"

"You look well dressed too, kind of like you're going out somewhere."

Adora perked. "Oh, yeah, Glimmer took me to a club with the others."

Catra smirked, bringing their stuff together. "You wouldn't be wearing that turtleneck to hide hickeys, would you?" Adora flinched then quickly became flustered. "What--! No! I didn't get into anything like that."

"Boring, what an unlucky blonde, looking like that and not getting laid."

"I wasn't at the club to get laid."

"Right, then why? That's the whole point of the club."

"I was there because my mom was being a bitch and spam called and texted me while I was at Glimmer's. Thanks by the way, for telling them, forgot to tell you that."

"Yes, do praise me."

Adora rolled her eyes causing Catra to laugh. "I'm kidding, don't mention it, yeah?"

"Sure."

"Either way, getting laid is the best way to relieve stress. Try it, virgin." Catra smirked.

"I'm more focused on football and my education, I don't need to get laid."

"Uhuh~" Catra tossed Adora backpack towards her, to which she caught and slid onto her back. Adora blushed, she realised as her cheeks were heating rapidly. She averted her gaze before looking back at Catra.

'I wonder if pictures from here go onto our phone in real life.' Adora pulled her phone out and snapped a picture of Catra searching through her backpack. The button up and vest fit and snug on Catra.

She then started to record. "Hungry?" Catra asked, glancing back at her before noticing Adora's phone. "Are you..recording?"

"Yeah, we should record our experiences here, whether notebook or video." Adora made an excuse. Catra's ears twitched. "Good idea, surprisingly coming from you."

"I know, I'm full of them. And yeah, I'm hungry."

Catra threw back a granola bar. Adora caught it then huffed. "I'm a growing woman, Catra. I'm gonna need more." Catra suddenly chuckled in a tone Adora found oddly seductive. "I'm surprised, after you didn't want to get laid at a club, you would've already had a full meal to last you till next morning, virgin. I would know." She smirked, her gaze seemingly lustful.

Adora felt her cheeks flush and her heart beat irregularly. She immediately ripped her gaze away from Catra's to calm down. 'What the hell??'

"Hey, what if we need to show this info to the FBI, we don't need them knowing I'm a virgin."

Catra zipped her backpack up and slid it onto her back. "Maybe you can fuck the cops, princess."

"What--?! What is wrong with you???"

"Everything, now come on before my two hours are over."

"I hope your house gets blown up while you're sleeping."

"Oh, yeah? Well I hope you parents crash their private jet into your house."

"Yeah? Well, I hope so too." Adora crossed her arms as they began to leave the house. "You know, I would say that's pretty upsetting, but I felt the same way when my mom was around."

Adora grunted in response.

The two got back onto their bikes and started to ride north. "We need music" Adora complained. "No we don't, no need to attract any attention from that demon or anybody else." Catra huffed.

"Anybody else..you think other people are going through this?"

"It's possible if we both are."

"...Yeah, that's logical." Adora started to think. "Let's pick up the pace a little." Catra suggested to which Adora nodded. "Alright."

The two decided to stop at a gas station once Catra's two hours were about to go off and camp inside an secure office. They brought the bikes in, hid them so you it'd take a lot of work to see them, then went into the office.

It had two desk, one long table and a few items laying around. "Thank god we have those sleeping bags." Catra exhaled. "And covers from the last house." Adora added.

"Those too."

The two set up their sleeping bags then laid down. "Fuck." Catra said breathlessly. Adora glanced at her. "What?" Catra's tail thrashed as she put her hands to her face. "Nothing."

"No no, obviously there's something and I'm too bored not to care." Adora turned on her stomach and laid her head in her arms as she stared at Catra. Catra's gaze shifted between her fingers to Adora. "Something doesn't feel right and I don't want to go to work."

Adora hummed. "You should always trust your instincts. What doesn't feel right?"

"...I don't know, but I have a bad feeling. You got a job?"

"Uh..no, I'm a Carrero, remember? No need to get one."

Catra scoffed. "Oh right, forgot about your rich privilege."

"But I do want to get one, I..don't tell anyone but..." Adora started, Catra removed her hands from her face. "I'm going to quit football. It used to be fun but now I want to join the medical field. My team is gonna be pissed, my parents they're still going to be mad because they want me to take over the company instead."

"Medical field huh?"

"Yeah, it seems fulfilling to save someone's life. I used to love helping my siblings whenever they got hurt." Adora smiled warmly, reminiscing. Catra stared before cracking a small smile. "I don't really have any plans for the future."

"You seem like...the law type."

"Law? You think I'd be a lawyer?" Catra suddenly chuckled. "I mean, maybe. Doesn't seem like a bad job, I love lying. I'm a master deceiver." Adora scoffed into a chuckled as well. "Don't forget delinquent. You could go around as a gangster."

"Sounds fun." Catra smirked before closing her eyes. "Melog's gonna wake me up soon." She mumbled. "Melog?" Adora asked.

"My cat."

"You have a cat?...Well that's ironic and expected." Adora grunted, amused. "I can handle dogs, you know, and other animals. It's just that I can interact with cats better."

"I could never imagine." Adora smirked, her sarcastic tone causing Catra to roll her eyes. "You know what I wonder?" Adora asked.

"Do I want to?" Catra huffed.

"If I texted you in here would you get it in real life?"

"Test it out once I fall asleep."

Adora groaned. "I don't want to be alone in here, I'm gonna be drawn to insanity."

"Aw, you're gonna miss me~?" Catra teased. "Better you than nothing at this point." Adora scoffed.

"How cute." Catra slowly dozed off.

Melog repeatedly tapped on Catra's face, waking her up. "Melog." Catra said tiredly. "Thanks." She sat up and went to the bathroom. She fixed her hair to look atleast a bit professional then grabbed her phone off it's charger.

She stuffed it in her pocket then went to work.

The restaurant was pretty fancy. A glossy wooden and red carpeted place. Many people filled the seats, wearing suits and dresses. They all ate their respective food.

"Catraa, nice to see you." Her manager greeted her nervously from a corner when she entered. He was a timid man, Raul was his name, long dark brown hair in a mini ponytail, purple eyes. He wore a white button up with a black tie and black pants.

Catra crossed her arms and leaned on one leg. "I'm sure it is." She said sarcastically with a bitter look. "I'm sorry-- A lot of us are sick from some food poisoning, and you're the only one I can count on right now. Emy and Dick are here covering as well so you won't be alone at least."

"Right." She sighed and began to walk past Raul. "You'll be covering tables 8,16, 24 and 3." He frowned. "You got it." Catra nodded.

Catra started working, trying to get the most done of the shift she had to cover. She passed Dick on her way to table 16.

"Mamacita Catra, didn't expect you to be taken out of break too." Dick smirked, with two plates of food. "Go do your job, Dick." Catra ignored him. Dick was tall, a football player from Catra's school. He could be strangely manipulative but also trustworthy when it came to defending his friend. Dick's hair was short and black, like a mullet, his eyes were burgandy while he wore the same uniform Catra did.

"Ouch, Catra, why won't you accept my advances? Can't you see were meant to be?" He smirked. "Yeah, fuck off. I'm a woman lover just like you." Catra walked off, with the few drinks in her

hand. Emy passed her as well, she had long brown hair in a ponytail and green eyes. "He's so annoying."

"You're telling me." Catra scoffed, causing Emy to laugh. "Those customers are becoming jackasses, I'm telling you, be careful for the karens." She warned.

"Yeah, I can see that."

Catra let down the drinks then as she went to the back to grab an order of food, her phone buzzed. She checked her watch and saw that she got a message from a glitched number. The numbers glitched into different ones rapidly before becoming completely blank.

: Hey, dickhead

Catra: Lemme guess what bitch is behind the phone

: I *d*a**re** y**o**u

Catra: Okay, but how the hell are you texting me, Adora?"

: Noo Idea but this *s**h**it* is mad glitChy

Catra: You're telling me, your number is blank. You are using your phone right?

:Yep, b***u***t it works, nicE t*o* know.

Catra: Sure is, but now you're interrupting my job, blondie.

:***S****o**r**r*y brokie

Catra rolled her eyes then got the plates of food before bringing them to the table. *'What is going on? If I wasn't so..me, I would be totally freaking out, which I should be. How the hell is Adora texting me from a dream world? What is the dream world, and what does it have to do with us specifically? Is Adora growing on*

me? How long is this going to go on for?' She furrowed her eyebrows as she went to bring back a refill.

'And that demon thing, I saw it again but it looked like Shadow Weaver..What could that mean?' Catra groaned inwardly. *'We need to get closer to BrightMoon, tonight. We can't continue stalling down in Manhattan. Not with that thing running around so easily. I thought we'd be safe in the house.'*

'BrightMoon is more..southwest of Manhattan? Yeah. We might need to find a new map soon. Or maybe our phones could work for the map, surprised we didn't think of that yet.'

"--Catraa" Dick said.

Catra flinched. "Huh?"

"You flew to the clouds, come back." He huffed, crossing his arms. Catra shrugged. "My bad, was just thinking about something."

"Was it about me~?" He smirked. Catra gave a quick fake chuckle before going back to her scowl. "Yeah, no. I'm way more interested in it than you."

"So it's not even a person?"

"Maybe they are, maybe it isn't." Catra smirked. "Quit playing with my mind, girl." He scoffed and walked off. Catra brought the drink to the last table then soon, after she finished serving, she took a break in the back.

Hours later, once Catra got off of work and went back home from her cleaning shift, she got home, loosened her tie, her belt then burrowed into her bed without a second thought about changing her clothes.

--

Catra sat up in her sleeping bag and looked to her side. Adora wasn't there. "Adora?" She called, standing, looking around.

"Adora?" She called a little louder. Catra opened the office door and looked around. "Sh--!" She was suddenly pulled to the ground behind the counter, a hand covering her mouth.

Catra struggled a bit, trying to wiggle out of their grip. "Hey-- Catra, it's just me, be quiet." Adora whispered. Catra turned her head and looked behind her once Adora slowly let her go. "What the hell was that for?" She said lowly. "I've been waiting for you to get back and I decided to walk around." She started to explain.

"So why are we being quiet?"

"Because there's more of those demon things out there. I saw an animal shaped one and there's two outside right now" Adora pointed over the counter. Catra rised, looking over the counter slightly. She saw two lanky skeletal black demons, they had spiraling white eyes that went straight through their skulls. Their skin looked rough and glistened, and they walked with a drag of their arms.

"Whatt the fuckkk..?" Catra's instincts suddenly kicked as the demons suddenly merged into one with two heads. The left head slowly turned towards Catra. She immediately ducked, her hairs raising. "We need to get out of here. ***Now*** *. We could bring the bikes around the back then ride once we're far enough. Is that the only one you saw?" Catra told Adora.*

"I know, And yeah, I ran into a hiding spot and snuck back here. They're not really tricked by small sounds like throwing a rock at a wall to gain their attention." She said, staring at Catra. She noticed how her tie was loosened.

Catra made an annoyed exhale as she buckled her belt back up. "Come on." She walked with a crouch back over to the office, her tail grazing Adora as she followed. They packed their things then snuck back out, grabbing their bikes from the corner they hid them in.

Adora pointed at the back door, Catra nodded. The two exited. Adora glanced at Catra, who started sign languaging. 'You understand sign language?'

Adora cocked an eyebrow before signing back. 'Yeah, surprised you do'

"Hardy. Har." Catra whispered. Adora snickered a bit, silently. "What else would I expect from a delinquent?"

Catra rolled her eyes.

They slowly pulled their bikes farther away from the store and once they deemed that they were far enough, they rode the bikes back in the direction of BrightMoon. "That was close."

"There's more than one around. We need to be way more careful." Catra frowned. "Indeed." Adora glanced around. "We must remain on thy toes."

"This is why you're a fucking nerd, Adora."

"How mean spirited of you, dear Catra. You speak of my intelligence as such it is a horrible thing. However my intelligence, adding onto your delinquent activities and instincts are what has made us arrive this far."

"Ohhh myy god, shut upp." Catra groaned.

Adora laughed. "My apologies good madam, I wholeheartedly got on your nerves, purposely."

"I'm going to remove you from life, purposely." Catra growled in annoyance.

"I would enjoy your attempt at it, you donkey anus."

Catra scoffed into a uncontrolled laugh. "Did you just intellectually call me a jackass."

"Perhaps."

"You--That's actually fucking respectable." She laughed more. Adora smiled a bit, enjoying Catra's company for once.

An hour and a half passed once they took a break in a nearby small store. "Are we sure there's not any cars?" Adora sighed, sliding down onto the floor as she leaned on the wall. "I haven't seen any. We haven't passed a car dealership, maybe we can get a good one for a good price of free." Catra smirked.

Adora scoffed. "Good price my ass. We just need to find where they hold the keys then we're set."

"Yeah, it would be best to find a motor vehicle."

"Let's set our goal on a car or motorcycle first, maybe even a four wheeler before we bike all the way to BrightMoon. It'd take like, days, maybe a month." Adora wiped sweat off of her forehead. "Isn't it weird how we still get tired and sweaty in dreamland?"

"How can we even count this as a dream any more?" Catra ran her fingers through her hair before slowly unbuttoning her vest and button up, revealing her tank top.

Adora glanced up at her. "True, what did we call it again? Limbo? Yeah."

They both sat on the cold different tiled floors of the small shop. "It's..." Catra checked her phone. "Goddamn these stupid glitchy numbers, it's 4 am."

"So rest here?" Adora asked.

"Might as well. I'm gonna get up and go to the station. Get something to snack on." Catra sighed. "Maybe we can catch each other there." Adora hummed. "If you feel like being out at that time. It's going to be cold as hell outside."

"I won't have anything else to do." Adora averted her gaze.

The two set up their sleeping bags in the storage room of the shop because the office was too small for them. They then dozes off shortly after having small conversation.

5

Adora parked in the parking lot of the gas station. She groaned over the slow music that played through the speakers of her car. She crossed her arms, watching the windows of the station store.

"....Catra?" She perked up, seeing Catra's back profile from the window. "That's her alright. Guess she didn't lie that she was actually going to get some snacks." Adora left her car and entered the store. She walked around and spotted Catra searching a fridge.

Adora went up behind Catra and stood there. She watched as Catra paused grabbing a drink out the fridge, her ear twitching. She whipped her head around, her elbow also whipping towards Adora. Adora stepped back, startled, because she was not expecting Catra to elbow her.

Catra halted before reaching her, startling. "ffuck me-- Adora? You blonde *pendeja*, why are you just standing right behind me?" She shook her chills away.

"I was gonna scare you, but your instincts got the better of me?" Adora nervously chuckled. Catra huffed. "Just don't sneak up on me anymore or I'll kick you right in your eggs." Adora flinched. "..What?"

"You heard me, Carrero."

"Uh..--"

"Now move aside so I can get my stuff." Catra flicked her forehead then walked up to the counter. Adora stood, stunned a bit before following her, grabbing a snack off the candy counter and chips then went up to the counter as well.

She put her stuff on the counter as well. Catra stared at her with a wildly concerned and confused look. Adora pulled her card out

of her wallet. "13.23" The cashier said before Adora put her card in the machine.

Catra scoffed. "I was about to say, this isn't charity." Adora chuckled. "Course not, you're too broke to pay for my things too."

"Oh shut your pipe, football fucker."

"As you wish, madam."

Catra groaned.

Adora chuckled again. The cashier put their things in seperate bags, noticing their interaction. He then passed the bag to them. "Have a good day."

"You too." Adora smiled before exiting with Catra. "It's 5 o clock. School starts in an hour." She said. "Good job, you know your time." Catra sighed. "I brought my backpack, maybe I shouldn't have left it on my motorcycle." She mumbled. "Obviously, especially if you have anything valuble in there. It's a motorcycle." Adora responded.

"Yeah, I know. I'm just a little slow from waking up ealier."

"I can tell."

Catra rolled her eyes. "Stop fucking with me already, what do you want?"

Adora shrugged. "No idea, just felt like bothering you."

"...It's always the blondes."

"What does that even mean?"

"Does it *have* to mean anything?"

The two were quiet for a moment before sitting next to each other on the curb of the sidewalk of the store. They both ate their snacks without saying a word, sitting in an odd silence. Adora

decided to do something about the silence and pulled up her phone. She went to Catra's message and sent her an 8ball game.

They both heard Catra's phone buzz, to which Catra had ignored it for a moment before taking it out of her pocket. Once she saw the text, she sighed and looked at Adora. Her eyebrow cocked as she gave Adora a look that she could only define as 'Seriously?'.

"We're sitting right next to each other."

"So? We're not talking."

Catra stared at her before looking back at her phone. "Whatever, you're on."

"If I win, I want a left twix everyday this week."

"Right, and if I win..." Catra and Adora's gaze landed on each other. Catra smirked. "I want a kiss on the cheek and a bag of twizlers."

Adora froze. "Twizlers? You're a weirdo."

"Says the one that likes left twix."

"Left twix are good."

"The lies of the delusioned." Catra huffed, which Adora responded with a scoff. "And did you say a kiss on the cheek? You flirty--bastard. How about I punch you instead?"

Catra laughed into a smirk. "I'm a master at this game, Carrero. Watch. And sure, I'm a masochist too."

Adora scoffed. "So that's why you love getting into fights?"

"Maybe."

The two played digital 8ball against each other for at least 2 games, eating their snacks. "Hah--" Catra suddenly choked on her sour skittles, barely having a grip on her phone. "Get fucked in the

ass." She coughed harshly, feeling it deep into her chest. "I wonnn~"

"Fuck you, I want a third game."

"And I want my twizzlers."

Catra's phone buzzed, the slit notification of an email showing. Her tail flicked, her hairs raising as she saw the notification. "I...I have to get home."

"Already?"

"Y-yeah, I just..I just need to go."

Adora felt conflicted, she shouldn't care about Catra's personal life, it's not her business, but she was interested in what changed Catra's mood so quickly. She wanted to ask what the problem was, but stayed quiet.

Catra stood up, her eyes glued onto her phone. Adora watched the other walk off with the most stressed look she's ever seen. She saw her put her helmet on then drive off with urgent speed.

Adora sighed after a moment. *'Now what do I do? It's kind of been...fun?; hanging out with Catra. Even thought she really knows how to piss me off. I guess I'll go home and nap it off. Ughh but I don't want to be back in the limbo'*

While Adora had found a solution on what to do at the moment, Catra had come across a problem to her solutions, a problem that could incite many more.

She sped home on her motorcycle, barely skimming the eyes of cops so she wouldn't be chased. Her heart pounding harshly in her chest like the bass of a drum, her lungs felt like they were collapsing, while her eyes dilated, she began to sweat, and her body felt shaky.

Her hands firmly gripped the handle of her motorcycle before she parked and went up to the mail box. She took the several mails out and went inside to sit on a stool in her kitchen. "*Fuck*..***Fuck***..I had a feeling this would stab me in the goddamn back! You can't just kill the bitch and get away with it easily--!" She clenched onto the mail which started to wrinkle it.

Melog meowed at her feet in worry.

Catra frowned. "Don't worry, Melog. I'm an intellectual, *I'll find my way out of this*..." She checked the mail and kept the two that were actually important. One from child protective services and another from the foster care agency that used to have Catra until Shawna adopted her.

The adoption home, and protective services was checking up on Catra, making sure that Shawna wasn't mistreating her or missing. While the other had reason to believe, Shawna isn't staying at her house and are starting to catch wift of Catra owning the home under SW's name.

"I didn't leave a trail, I always make sure I'm careful. So what could have happened?" She mumbled before noticing a sentence in her email. One she skipped over, stupidly.

It stated that they have someone that claims to be a relative in her family. That will be notified if their claim turns out to be real.

"There's no one else, I especially never had family. Shadow Weaver, she had only friends, so who could that be?" Catra began to overthink and stress over it. Melog jumped up and curled in her lap.

Melog uncurled, sensing Catra was going to get up soon and got on the table, he laid in a loaf and stared at Catra.

Catra's leg was restless. She abruptly stood up and poured her shot of strong alcohol. She drank it with complete ease, as her adoptive mother would have as well. "Damn it. I need to miss today, take my mind off of this."

Melog meowed.

"No, but me not arriving at school just proves that they're right." Catra groaned very loudly. "Okay, I'll go. But no bullshit, no nothing." She grabbed her a bottle of alcohol and drank a swig of it. Her phone had suddenly buzzed.

It was a screenshot of a delivery order from..Adora.

Catra: The hell is that? You sending me the 15 packs of dildos Lonnie threatened she'd send me?

Adora: Whatt?? No. It's the twizzlers

Catra perked up. '*Really, I didn't expect her to do it. A deals a deal, I guess.*'

Catra: Oh, you didn't have to.

Adora: We made a deal, and I lost, only fair.

Catra: Well, if you insist

It was nearly at Catra's door. Catra had stared through a different window waiting for the delivery person to drop off her bag.

Adora: Should be there in a couple of seconds.

Catra: Thanks blondie

Adora: Whatever floats your boat, always mention it.

Catra broke into a short laugh before noticing a car pull up into her driveway. The person dropped off the bag then went off. Catra opened her door once they were gone and brung the bag in. She opened it and noticed a big bag of twizzlers and a huge kiss chocolate.

Catra stared at it for a moment in utter confusion before realising and laughing.

Catra: Seriously, a kiss?

Adora: Put it on your cheek, you're the one that asked for it.

Catra: Oh my god, you are *so* fucking corny

Adora: Partially runs in the Carrero family.

Catra felt her cheeks burning once she stopped laughing, a smile was still upon her face.

"Goddamn you, Carrero. That's so stupid." She picked up the big kiss chocolate and put it to her cheek.

She then took a picture and sent it to Adora.

Catra: Happy?

Adora: Indeed I am

Catra put the kiss in the fridge then opened her bag of twizzler. "I need to get to school as normal as I should be going." She went upstairs to her room and took a good cold shower.

Afterwards, she got ready, putting on a black shirt, tan hoodie, black fingerless gloves, and black sweatpants, then grabbed her backpack before chilling on her couch.

Adora had took a nap and woke up later. She took her warm shower then got ready in a white collared light blue sweater with jeans.

Catra scrolled through the pictures on her phone while listening to music. She supposed she should tell Lonnie just in case. "I can't go back." Her hand began to shake. "*I don't want to go back to that--*"

She closed her eyes tightly.

"You stupid bitch-- What did I tell you about making noise while I'm on call? All you had to do was mop the fucking floor, how hard

is that??" The man whipped his large hand across Catra's face. His ring bruised her face. "You almost just costed me a deal because of your screaming." He yelled at her. Catra was on the floor with a twisted ankle from tripping on the wet floor.

"Wait no, please Mr. Kethers. Please don't tell Ms. Weaver." She pleaded, tears running down her face. "Finish mopping the floor and we'll see." He grumbled, clenching onto his phone.

Catra struggled to breathe as she tried to stand, it was as if she had lost the ability to. She used the mop as a cane to stand and mopped. She tripped multiple times, which pissed off the man even more.

"Goddamn you! You're useless! Get out my house, and get in the back of the truck."

"Y-yes sir." Catra hiccuped, still crying.

Catra went to his truck and climbed into the trunk. She laid, knowing the man wouldn't bring her back until the morning. Catra held her ankle carefully then looked around the trunk for anything she could use.

Nothing. Only sharp objects.

Catra sighed and opened her eyes. It's been a while since she was able to cry. The ability to cry kind of faded away after nobody answered to them. She then took a look at her tail which had few scars on it. Her back had the most.

Catra screamed in pain, the sound of fire, the cackles of the chains she were held by, and the cracking up Shawna's whip behind her. "You think you're special, Catra?! Huh!? There's nothing special about you, you're a puppet, a scapegoat, a useless piece of shit that ruins everything and everyone around her! Why do you think your mother abandoned you before you even gained concious?!" Shadow Weaver whipped the heated whip against her back once more. She had heated it over a fire, making sure that Cata would suffer.

Catra struggled in her chains. Two chains hanged her from the ceiling by her wrist and longer chains held her by her ankles from the floor. "Everyone has abandoned you, I'm the only one you have and the only one you'll ever have!" Catra yelped loudly, tears streaming down her face, her heart pounding faster than it's normally supposed to, her body was burning like utter hell, her eyes dilating violently.

"You're not getting food tonight." Shadow Weaver put the whip onto the wooden table that was put into her basement years ago. She went upstairs and locked Catra down stairs.

Catra's head drooped, she felt blood slipping down her back. "What did I ever do..to deserve any of this?" She spoke, faltering, some of the words coming out as a whisper.

She slowly lost conscious, some of her blood pooling at the cold floor below her.

Catra shook her head. "No, I'm not going to go back to that, ever. I can't." She stood up and headed out to her motorcycle. She drove to a place in the whispering woods.

She stopped at a pretty big stick in the ground. This was where she buried Shadow Weaver. Catra scoffed and spat on her grave. "...Fucking bitch. Even from the grave, you're fucking with my life."

She sat on the grave and took a cigarette out.

Catra lit the cigarette and put it to her mouth. "I knew you were going to die before me. I was hoping it, hoping I could be the one. And after being the one, nothing feels different. The only relief I had was no more injuries. Other than that, all the PTSD you left me with still isn't gone. I couldn't go to therapy, in fear that they'd find out."

Catra suddenly laughed. "The look on your face was pretty funny, sure I might be fucked up for saying it. But that was the first time I had smiled in a long while." She blew smoke out. "You never

deserved a proper funeral, I'm glad I got to be the one to bury you. No job, the only reason you got money to pay the taxes and shit was because you made me do all the dirty work. As far as everyone knows, you fell off the fucking radar and you're broke."

"...Even talking to your corpse is making me feel nervous..." She stood up and stomped her cigarette out on Shadow Weaver's grave. "I should go.." She mumbled before getting on her motorcycle and driving to school.

Once she walked in and went to her locker she got pounced on by Lonnie. "Catra, where have you been?? You're late" She ruffled with her hair. "It's almost lunch time."

"Are you skipping?" Catra cocked an eyebrow.

"Maybe, I've been waiting for you."

"What if your mom finds out again?"

"She won't come on, let's just head to class and make an excuse like we always do." She grabbed Catra's wrist once she finished putting her stuff away. Lonnie dragged her down the hallway then stopped and turned back at her. "You alright?"

"...Yeah." Catra hid behind a smile.

Lonnie furrowed her eyebrows and let go of her wrist. "No you're not, what's up?"

"I--" Catra's energy faltered, she put her hand to her face and sighed. "I'll tell you later."

Lonnie frowned then walked beside her. "We have all the time in the world right now, Catra."

"No we don't" Catra uttered.

"What do you mean?"

"Nothing, let's just get to class."

"Alright." Lonnie said with a visably upset face. Catra had glanced at her then averted her gaze. She suddenly froze then stared at her. Lonnie stopped walking then looked back at her. "What?"

Lonnie's face had distored for a split second, turning into the dark figure from the limbo. In that same second, Catra blinked and Lonnie turned back, her eyes shifting colors from golden to white to it's orginal brown hue. "Are you on something right now?"

"You.." Catra started but then stopped herself. "Maybe I am." She shrugged and walked with Lonnie once more.

'What the hell was that?' Catra's mind immediately raced to Adora.

'*"I'm not a dumbass, Adora. Don't fucking treat me like one."*

"Likewise." Adora furrowed her eyebrows as she proved her point. "Also, lest we forget, the night this all happened, Lonnie was pushed off a damn building. We saw her die, but she was suddenly back like it was nothing, right after we took that smoke. There's a connection somewhere and we're mixed in it." Adora huffed. "Have you noticed anything off with Lonnie recently?"

"Not really, I haven't seen her that much since that day."

"Try keeping an eye on her."

"What am I, her goddamn stalker? I don't need you bossing me around and Lonnie is just fine."

"Catra, I'm not trying to boss you around, I'm just suggesting for our own benefit. If you keep an eye on her to see if anything's changed, maybe we can learn a bit more about this." '

Catra averted her gaze. *'...keep an eye on her. Maybe I shouldn't had been so quick to lash out at her. I should keep an eye on Lonnie, it's reasonable, especially after that.'*

"Lonnie, have you been feeling alright since that night at the abandoned building?"

Lonnie glanced at her as they walked. "Uhh..Yeah, kind of. I've been feeling more...empty, I guess. Unreal, maybe?"

"Empty?"

"Yeah. Something feels wrong inside myself, like..my soul was sapped out or something."

Catra furrowed her eyebrows.

"But I still feel the same, it's..so *weird*."

"Hey, it's alright. Maybe the feeling will go away later."

"Mhm."

--

Lunch break came around pretty soon. Catra was playing soccer with Lonnie while Robby sat to the side, watching and also watching a video on his phone.

"Alright so how do you do it?" Catra put her foot on the soccer ball. Robby stared at his phone for a second.

Lonnie put her hands on her hips. "You're still trying to learn the elastico?"

"Duh. I've been going up the easiest to hardest soccer skill for a while, come on." Catra smiled. Robby showed the video to her then nodded. "You got this." He grinned.

Some time after practicing, the three chilled and talked about a different discussion. Catra hadn't really been paying attention. She instead was thinking about Lonnie.

She pulled out her phone, her gaze landed on Adora who sat on the bleachers with her friends. They ate and spoke with one

another.

Catra: Hey, I think you were right about keeping an eye on Lonnie

She saw how Adora stopped what she was doing and looked at her watch. She stared at it before pulling her phone out.

Adora: When am I not right, what happened?

Catra: We were talking earlier, Lonnie said she didn't feel as normal as she did since that night

Catra: Said she felt souless, empty

Adora: Could be cause we saw her die, maybe she really did and the one we're seeing is some kind of replacement?

Catra: How the hell would that eve be possible?

Adora: Theres a lot of things we've seen and done that shouldn't be possible

Catra: Yeah but Lonnie being a replacement for the one that died?? Isn't that a bit of a stretch?

Adora: Well, yeah but it's not a bad stretch

Adora: I know you don't want to believe it cause she's your best friend, but we should consider it, right?

Catra: I don't know, this is so tiring

Adora: You're telling me.

Adora: What did you do to Glimmer, she seems more pissed at you than usual? I didn't know it was possible for her to hate you more.

Catra: She blames me for you getting knocked the fuck out when it was all Robby's fault.

Adora: Ohh, well, that sucks.

Robby kicked the soccer ball from where he sat, it aimed for Catra's head to which Catra slapped it downwards while on her phone. "You need to stop aiming at the head." She said before glancing at him. Robby chuckled nervously. "My bad." He then smirked. "Maybe it's cause I love getting head."

Catra snickered. "If you ever got any."

Robby scoffed. "I've gotten head before."

"What is this conversation??" Lonnie commented.

"Sure you have buddy. Do you know what it's like when it's so good you rock your head back, your eyes roll back and your toes curl?"

"Yeah, I have." He huffed.

"Liar, swear on your sexy mom."

"What?"

"You heard me."

"Okay, I swear on my mom."

Lonnie and Catra glanced at each other with doubtful looks. Robby suddenly laughed. "What you two don't believe me? When's the last time you got sexually active, Catra?"

Catra put her finger to her chin. "Well, I got a call two weeks ago from the barista girl. That was..fun." She smirked. "Anytime you talk about hookups it's always some chick you've met from somewhere. Have you ever had one with a guy?"

'..When I was younger..way too young.' Catra furrowed her eyebrows. "Yeah, sucked ass cause I wasn't into the guy at all. And the other one tried to literally breed me even though I

objected." Catra scoffed. "So not only did I not like guys, sex sucked as well."

"Maybe you just haven't found the right one to get with." He said, slickly.

"What, are you suggesting yourself?"

"No--! I'm just saying."

Catra and Lonnie glanced at each other again. The two suddenly burst into laughter. Her phone buzzed again.

Adora: Guess who likes Robby.

Catra flinched.

Catra: Oh god, don't tell me it's you

Adora: HELL no.

Catra chuckled.

Adora: But just found out Rebbeca has a crush on him.

Catra: Rebbeca as in sexy short cheerleader Rebbeca?

Adora: Well, I don't know about sexy, but yeah, she's thinking about heading over there to you guys.

Catra: Tell her to come ahead, Robby is getting desperate, he just asked me if I've fucked a man before

Adora: Oh my, I'm sending her over

Catra glanced at Adora who also looked at her. Adora gave her a pitying look before turning to Rebecca. She was a girl around Catra's height but shorter, she was slim with burgandy eyes and wavy black hair.

She wore a burgandy sweater and jean shorts.

She spoke with Adora then breathed in deeply.

Adora: She said to not tell you that she called you a hot and sexy jackass.

Catra: Hah, I knew she had a thing for me, just hope it goes away when she meets Robby

Adora: I'm sure it will.

Catra: You seem so sure, you think it's easy to get over me?

Adora: How would I know, I never like you.

Catra: Music to my ears, princess~

Adora: Godd, you're so annoying.

Catra: And you seem to never get bored of it

"Oh hey Rebbeca." Lonnie greeted with a smile. Rebbeca came up from behind Catra with a smile. "Hey, what's up you guys?"

"Nothing much." Robby hummed.

"Very much, I got some other things to practice and do, which may or not be your mom, Robby. So I'll talk to you guys later." Catra decided to leave the conversation early. "I'll stay to keep the peace. See you, Catra." Lonnie chuckled.

"Uhuh." Catra smirked before walking.

Catra: Now we see if they're compatible

Adora: I'm not too sure about it, but it wouldn't be a terrible relationship.

Catra: Yeah would be interesting for him to finally hop off my dick cause he'll be with her

Adora: Do you..actually have a dick?

Catra paused before smirking. Adora's heart froze as she saw the three dots, signalling that Catra was typing

Catra: Is that something you'd like to find out?

Adora: Uh no, I'm okay

Catra: Alrighttt, offer is there though

Catra: Hate fucks are normal

Adora: Catra, *Please*, SHUT UP.

Catra: Hey, I was just saying

Catra put her phone away then went started playing with her soccer ball, practicing the elastico move. Her gaze landed on Adora again, who watched her, blankly. She winked at Adora to which Adora replied with a flustered, visibly disatisfied look. Catra laughed at her.

Adora sighed.

"Adora, you listening?" Glimmer asked.

"Huh? Yeah." She put her phone down on the seat.

"No you weren't, what's up?"

"Nothing." Adora glanced at Catra again then at her friends. "Just thinking."

"Well try thinking about what you're going to say to your mom when she picks you up today."

Adora abruptly groaned. "Noooo, I have no idea why she's coming to get me. She won't *fucking* explain."

"I bet you it's another party she wants me to go to today, damn it." She held her head which still hurt from the other day. "I hope Jean will be there."

"I heard he came down, is it true?" Bow asked.

"Same here, if he is, tell him that I would like to go with him and Kervens to the new botanic garden." Perfuma smiled. "You got it, and yeah, he came down but I haven't seen him because he's been busy." Adora frowned. "What kind of older brother doesn't see his favorite sibling when he's in the area?"

"I couldn't relate." Glimmer chuckled.

"I don't think most of us can." Bow scratched behind his neck. "I'm glad that Jean can be a sibling for you guys though, he loves you all." Adora smiled.

Adora's mom came faster than she wished for. She dreaded the ring of the school phone, sitting conflicted in her seat.

The unfortunete ringtone rang, causing Adora's heart to drop. She put her hands on her head and laid her head on the desk.

"That for you, isn't it? I can go for you, for a price of course~" She heard Double Trouble speak from beside her. "No I'm good, DT." She sighed.

"Bring me back a scone." They smirked.

"Yeah yeah, I know." Adora huffed.

"Adora, you're going home." The teacher called out.

She groaned and dragged herself out of the classroom, grabbing her bag then walking down the hall.

"Aw, leaving so soon?" Catra said, leaning at the corner of a wall. Adora startled. "What the hell-- Why are you everywhere???"

"Well, I'm supposed to be at the bathroom, but I'm just taking a good break from the hell we call a classroom."

"Sure."

"Where ya goin?"

"My mom came to get me." Adora frowned. "So *tiring*."

"You can always run away, I did it once and look at me living the life."

"Run away?" Adora snorted. "They'd threaten to nuke BrightMoon if I did. Cya."

"Uhuh."

Adora left the school, noticing the white stretch limo waiting for her to enter. The driver in a white and black suit waited at the backseat door for her. Adora exhaled and walked up to it.

The driver opened the door for her. Adora climbed into the car to which the driver closed the door then went into the driver seat.

"Adora, I haven't heard from you in weeks, you haven't been home." Her mother sat, her legs and arms crossed. She had long and wavy light blonde hair with silver blue eyes, and wore a slightly revealing white dress with a high cut, along with many golden jewelry.

Adora ignored her mother and turned away from her. She stared out the window.

"Adora, I am speaking to you, look at me" Her mother said, firmly. Adora scoffed quietly and turned to her mother. Elle, her mother, grabbed Adora by her face and inspected it.

"My god, look at you and your clothes. Can't you atleast try to look presentable at school? We bought you clothes to wear."

"Yeah, croptops and shit. Stuff I don't like." Adora replied, venom seeping into her tone. Elle glared. "Don't you dare use that vulgar

language with me, now put your hair down and try to look more..girly. We're going to a meeting with the Matthews."

Adora groaned and swatted her mother's hand away from her. "Awesome."

"You need to lose that attitude, one day you're going to marry Damien Matthews and take over the company. Then you'll have a child and that child will take oer the company. Your brother already ruined our chances, you're our last hope. We can't make anymore children, you know."

Adora gave a disgusted look and averted her gaze. She did as she was told however and removed her hair band. Adora took her phone out and crossed her legs.

Adora: Help, Mom's bringing me to a Matthews meeting.

Jean: :(I'm going too

Jean: Atleast we'll be able to see each other :D

Adora: True :((I miss you bro.

Jean: Miss you too, hun.

Adora then went out of the message, her eyes landed on Catra's contact. She then clicked it. *'Should I text her?...she makes things interesting though, so..'*

Adora: Imma kms.

Catra: Don't hesitate <3

Adora: 😔

Catra: What is it?

Adora: My mom's making me go to a Matthews meeting.

Catra: L

Catra: I hate the Matthews, pussy ass bitches

Adora: Same.

Catra: Fought two once, Damien and Logan

Adora: Think I could pay you to kill Damien?

Catra: Sure, how much

Adora: 5 grand

Catra: Hah, you're funny, princess

Catra: What'd he do?

Adora: What hasn't he done? And my parents are making me marry him.

Catra: No way

Catra: You're in deep shit for real

Adora: Exxactly.

Adora sighed and put her headphone in before playing music. Her phone buzzed suddenly.

Catra: Just distract him with a mirror, it's shiny and reflective, once he sees himself, I'm sure he'll leave you alone

To this Adora let out a small and short giggle. Her mother glanced over at her then huffed and looked away.

Adora: That's actually not a bad idea.

Catra: Trust me, it's effective

She smiled a bit before catching herself. *'I'm warming up to her a little too quickly. She's so annoying, but she has funny sarcastic humor, I'll give her that.'*

It felt like only minutes while Adora stared at the cars and areas zooming past her. They arrived quicker than Adora could handle. The driver had opened the door for Elle first, however when he went to open Adora's door, he was cut off by Adora opening it herself.

"Stop treating me like my mom, I can open a door by myself." Adora remarked. The driver nodded. "Yes, master Adora." He said even though she knows he'll do some other time either way.

As Adora and her mother walked towards the entrance of the light sky blue mansion Adora spotted Kervens walking towards the door as well.

Kervens was the carribean husband of her older brother, Jean.

Jean was 20 with light curly blonde hair and deep blue ocean eyes similar to his father's while Kervens was 21, brown skinned and tall, with long black dreads in a ponytail and golden eyes. He wasn't totally slim, but you could tell he worked out, he was also a good cook as said by Jean.

Kervens wore a white suit with golden jewelry. He looked good. "Oh, good afternoon, ladies." He greeted with a sweet smile. Elle ignored her son in law with a disappointed look. She always didn't like the fact that Jean had pursued other things, and also the fact that he was gay.

"Afternoon, Kervens. What's up?" Adora greeted him with the same amount of energy. "Nothing much, I didn't expect to see you here, usually Jean would be jumping with joy."

The two chuckled. Kervens opened one of the double doors, letting Adora and her mother walk in first before him. He then caught up to Adora.

"How have you both been?"

"Good, really good. We brought Kenith and Henry down with us so you finally get to meet your nephews in person." He grinned.

Adora perked up. "Awww! Bring them over during the weekend, I'll take them off your hands."

"You sure? They can be a handful, you know, being 9 and 13 and all."

"Yeah I'm sure. I'll be free."

"Alright, I'll talk about it with Jean. Now come, I'm sure he's waiting." Kervens walked with them to the meeting room, he opened it, letting the two through.

Jean perked up, his curls slightly bouncing and his ears perking as well with his smile. "Adora!" He said and gestured for her to sit next to him. Adora smiled brightly and sat next to him on his left while Kervens sat next to him on his right.

Kervens kissed him on the cheek before sitting, Jean giggled a bit. "Hey."

"My love." Kervens smiled.

"Jean you look amazing" Adora gave him praise. "Well yeah, I always slay when around the anti-gays." He chuckled. Jean wore an all white suit with a white vest and golden jewelry that hanged from the vest, golden earrings, a ring along with his engagement ring, and his necklaces.

His hair also looked soft and beautiful. "Glad to seem mom is as bitter as ever. Hey mama!" He smiled, crossing his legs and resting his head on top of his interlocked fingers.

Elle glared a bit before huffing. "*Mondesir* Carrero." The venom of her feeling seeped into her voice. Jean loved to piss off their mother, he found it hilarious.

"Woah, that one had a little more hatred in it." He smirked. "How have you been, lil sis?"

"Good, not bad at all. I've been having these weird dreams, but other than that, nothing."

"Well, atleast that's the only thing. School alright?"

"Yep, not terrible."

"And what about quitting you know and going into you know?" He asked. "I'm still in the process. I'm trying to switch into more medical electives, I'm also going to see if I can get some lessons from our nurse."

"Sounds like a great idea." Kervens hummed.

"Definitely, did Kervens tell you that Kenith and Henry came down with us?" Jean leaned onto the long table. Adora nodded. Keverns spoke up. "She said she could take them off our hands for the weekend. Meaning we can have the days alone we've been wanting." He game a slight smirk.

Jean blushed, his gaze longing with Kervens' before landing back on Adora. "Are you sure? They're a lot for a couple of kids."

"Yeah I'm sure, have your couples day." Adora chuckled.

"Alright" Jean gestured his hands into a heart. "I love you soo much!" He started kissing Adora on the cheek. Adora scoffed, laughing, she pushed him off of her. "Quit it."

"Jeez, someone's getting older."

"You're finally noticing?" Adora chuckled.

"Oh, har har."

6

The limbo was starting to grow on Catra, she would admit. The thought of being alone in an liminal space, with limits unknown. She actually kind of wished this would have happened to her when she was younger.

Catra glanced to her left. Adora was quiet, seemingly very thoughtful. Her hair was down while she wore a white button up, white pants and tie with some gold jewelry. Even though Catra didn't w ant to admit it, Adora looked really pretty , she could barely keep her eyes off of her. Catra decided not to bother her and continue looking ahead. The two were pretty far on their trip, compared to where they started.

They were out of Manhattan, finally, managing to sneak around most of the "Gengars". Adora had made the joke nights ago, comparing the demons to a shadow pokemon and they've just stuck with it since.

Other nights they weren't as lucky, escaping in nicks of time. The sky was different..to a degree at least. It was still in a sunset orange but the farther they went, they noticed the sky slowly..very slowly changing to a light blue.

Catra exhaled, her gaze landed on Adora again. Adora's hair waved around in the wind, her gaze shifted to Catra. Catra flinched. "What?" Adora tilted her head a bit.

"Nothing." Catra said.

Adora sighed. "Where are we even?"

Catra looked at their surroundings , it seemed they were in a city with tall brick buildings. She glanced down at her map. "You're smart, guess."

"Catra." Adora's gaze snapped at her, in increasing annoyance.

Catra rolled her eyes. "Boston. We keep going this way, we'll end up in jacksonville. We should go west from there. Then we'll end up in BrightMoon...we really should find a car." She stopped pedaling, to which Adora did as well.

"Yeah.." Adora frowned.

"Lets do that then, come on. There's a dealership...15 minutes away." Catra showed her phone to Adora and pointed at the map.

Adora bitterly exhaled. "Great, let's just get this over with."

Catra furrowed her eyebrows a bit in slight concern. "Alright, what the fucks' up? You've been bitchy and pissy since the night started." Adora averted her gaze before looking back at her. "It's nothing."

"No, it's not nothing . Let me guess, your parents verbally shitted on you or something? Do you rich spoon fed donkeys have to deal with that?" Catra scoffed with a glare. Adora was quiet for a moment. "Yeah, actually." Catra's glare and frown softened slightly as she looked away. "...I get it..from personal experience, don't let it get to you. They only try to get in your head so they can control you." She advised.

Adora perked then turned away. "Yeah, I know. Didn't peg you as the therapist type, Catra."

"Well that's because you haven't pegged me, Adora." Catra smirked. Adora flinched with a flustered look upon her face. Her cheeks reddened as she groaned. "You. are. so. fucking. annoying."

"I know, and I'm proud of it. Now, come on." Catra chuckled and continued pedalling down the rocky street road with many hills, cuts and corners.

The two made it to the nearest car dealership, the street lights were on, it seemed the closer they got to BrightMoon, the more they saw.

Electricity, gas cans, food wrappers and bottles, it was like it was inhabited some time ago.

They got off their bikes and dragged the bikes along with them as they walked. "Holyyy shit" Catra suddenly grinned. "There are cars here!" Adora smiled. They ran, dragging their bikes with them. "There's fucking sports cars." Catra's tail wagged.

"Let's think about quantity than immediately going for sports cars." Adora said. Catra glanced at her. "Seriously? Grab a goddamn mercedes benz or something, come on!" Adora rolled her eyes and followed Catra.

They soon found a car that they both enjoyed. It had a comfortable backseat and a big enough trunk, the color was a dark royal blue. Adora put their bikes in the trunk then got in the passenger since Catra demanded to drive.

"It has gas, we're gonna stop by a mechanic shop so I can mess with this bad baby." Catra smirked. "What? You work on cars?" Adora raised an eyebrow.

"Yeah, I've worked on a lot of cars, it's one way to use up my time."

Adora hummed, interested that she learned something new about Catra. "Well, my car needs fixing, my mom hired someone to mess it up." She scoffed.

Catra was quiet for a moment. "...What's wrong with it?"

Adora looked over at her then slouched a bit more in her seat. "The oil needs to be changed, a few things are loose in the hood, the engine cuts out a lot, and pretty sure some things are disconnected in there."

"Damn, bitchy move, a lot of money to repair that."

"I know." Adora closed her eyes and reclined her chair. Catra decided to mess with the controls and the controls of the radio.

The radio came on with a light click. Adora and Catra sat in silence for a good moment listening intently, but the only thing that could be heard was low static.

Catra played with it a bit, switching through each presetted channel and others but all were static. "Expected." She sighed. "..Maybe you can do bluetooth?" Adora suggested.

"Yeah, but I have an even better idea. Maybe we can do bluetooth." Catra pulled her phone out to which Adora snatched once she unlocked it. "Hey--!"

"Keep your eyes on the road, make sure we don't hit one of those gengars."

Catra scoffed. "I'd enjoy running over one." She fixed her shirt to feel more comfortable sitting. Catra also reclined her chair just a bit.

She wore a dark grey tanktop and black pants. 'Luckily I put pants back on. Glad I wasn't completely drunk.' Catra chuckled lowly. 'That girl can take a beating..damn. And I don't think I've run out of juice yet, I can go on.' She peaked at Adora, who was messing around with her phone.

Catra stared, seeing how Adora's button up was tight at her arms, showing how toned she was, her hands looked rough, her jaw was clenched a bit, while her eyes were beautiful on their own. Catra knew but never wanted to admit it to herself how hot Adora was, even when they met, though they were never on the best terms because Adora didn't like Catra's attitude or the way she treated others and Catra didn't like how outgoing, friendly, popular, and mentally slow she was.

It annoyed her how loud everyone would be when others were around her, how everyone talked about her and how Shadow Weaver compared Catra to people like her.

To hear Shadow Weaver speak about others highly and contrast them to her, how useless she was, how she could never amount

to anything like this person. It made Catra resent anyone who had it like that, who had what she hadn't.

Adora's soft gaze shifted onto Catra. To which Catra quickly looked away, back to the road. She was silent for a second.
"What's the bluetooth name of this car?"

"Shouldn't there only be one on there? Look through the scan."
Catra cleared her throat, avoiding eye contact, nervous of the fact that she was nearly caught staring. Adora grunted softly and went down to the scans. She successfully connected to the car. "Hey, it connected."

"Uh..cool." Catra replied. "Put something on..it's getting awkward."

"Uhuh, you're telling me." Adora put some r&b on then stare d at Catra, analyzing her body language. Especially her tail. She remembers reading about magicat tails, they were really similar to regular cat tails and Adora loved learning about animals, especially how to treat them.

Adora stared at Catra's arms. 'For such a short person, she must really pack a punch.' She thought before she noticed Catra's scars, they're slightly darker than her skin and pretty noticable. But they went along with her birthmarks, they're birthmarks that were sharp and were lined in rows, only known for being Magicat's.

Catra had them on her arms, those were the only birthmarks that Adora could see, but she guessed that she had more. Catra also had a scar on her jaw that went up to her cheek. Her hair looked soft while her eyebrows were pretty defined. She also had faint freckles. Adora stared longer, basking in her looks. Her sharp teeth, her warm laugh, her raspy and deep-ish voice, but also her high giggles.

Ever since they met, Adora didn't deem Catra as bad looking, she never thought that. Actually, Adora could see why so many people

were aroused by her. Even with her attitude and how much of a jackass she was, Adora saw how hot she was.

Sometimes when she heard other's talking about their experiences with Catra, she kind of wished it were her. The thought had disappeared after a while, as Adora was busy with other things.

One thing Adora did like about Catra was her eyes, she did find them very pretty despite the personality of the one that owned them. One teal, one golden, she was very observant and sharp when it came to her surroundings. You don't find that kind of attentiveness in a lot of people. She also had a good memory and was very smart even though she didn't act like it.

Adora has seen her scores, she knows how smart she is, however it seemed Catra wasn't so proud of her scores, or really, didn't care. Like she had no kind of enjoyment in it.

Catra's sharp eyes took a quick glance at Adora. Adora's heart felt like it skipped a large beat as she stared away. "...Catra..could I ask you a question?" She said after a second, feeling awkward.

Catra grunted. "Can I stop you?"

"Well..yeah?" Adora shrugged.

Catra snorted a bit. "What do you want?"

"I was just wondering, what else do you know how to do?"

"What do you mean?"

"Like you said you know how to fix cars."

Catra hummed. "Well, I know how to deal with pipes and stuff for stuff like sinks. Cabinets, machines, and other things. I'm just a handy person." She answered. "When my mom would have workers come over..for her benefit..I'd watch the guy fix whatever she broke. And I got the hang of it pretty quickly."

"That's..cool." Adora said. "It's decent. Atleast I don't have to pay for someone to come and fix my stuff, you know?" Catra changed the song. "Yeah, it's pretty useful."

"..You can nap you know, I'll still be here."

"It's like, 6 am. I'm fine, let's just get to BrightMoon. I would say step on it but we don't wanna lose gas."

Catra nodded and went a little faster.

Now they were making distance, eventually they parked in a secluded and shaded area before putting the backseats down and resting in the back.

It was Friday, today was a national holiday so Catra would be off from school. She wasn't working today so she had nothing to do except maybe clean or stay home.

Catra sat up, covering her face then running her fingers through her hair. She looked to her right after remembering that she wasn't in her home. The silky grey sheets were undone and messy, of course because she and the other had intercourse but it also looked like the other was up.

She stood up and went over to the door before she could even grab the handle, the door opened. Catra stopped it then stepped back a bit and let it open all the way.

"Catra--! You're up."

Catra grunted. "Rebecca." She addressed. Rebecca was a popular cheerleader at their school, one that people looked up to and some hated for her relations with the football team. She was short, a bit tan, dark brown hair, and brown eyes.

"Hey, hangover? I have water."

"Nah not really much of a hangover. I gotta get somewhere today."

"Oh, alright. Then I'll um..see you later?"

"You can see me tonight. But I'm feeling generous." Catra smirked before picking up Rebecca by her thighs. "Let me leave you with a parting gift."

The two kissed as Catra walked her back to the bedroom.
--

Catra had went home some time after and after relaxing,
Catra took a shower and remembered how Scorpia had invited her for a light little party at Perfuma's house. She also remembered how Scorpia invited her over for morning hangout.

Catra had figured she owed Scorpia one..or two so she agreed. She trudged back into her room and changed into a black tanktop and baggy dark worker jeans. Catra then grabbed her phone.

Catra: Do I really have to come over?

Scorpia: Good morning to you too, Catra! And yes, you pink promised.

Catra groaned and went downstairs to her garage. She took out everything she needed and put it into the pockets of her motorcycle pack. She then grabbed her keys and her denim jacket before leaving.

She arrived pretty quickly, as Perfuma lived relatively close to her. Scorpia stood outside with a bright smile, Catra dreaded the hug that awaited her as she pulled into the driveway.

Scorpia squealed and ran up to Catra. To which Catra put her hand in front of her and huffed. "Breakfast first, then we'll hug."

"Don't worry, Perfuma made waffles. Just the way you like them." To this, Catra perked up, her tail wagging.

"Come on and leave your cigarettes in your pockets."

Catra rolled her eyes. "She's a plant lady anyways, what's a smoked and rolled plant gonna do to her?"

Scorpia frowned. "She says it upsets her garden and the plants. So please just keep them away." Catra sighed. "Fine."
The two walked inside, the refreshing smell of plants made Catra feel pure. She was glad Perfuma had given her seeds to plant her own plants, her room was her sanctuary after all. So was her office.

They sat at the barstools that were at the kitchen counter. Perfuma had came from the outside, holding vegetables in her gloved hand. "Oh--! Catra, hello!" She smiled.

"Hey, question, what's up with that car in the front?"

Perfuma and Scorpia glanced at each other, silently having their own conversation before smiling again. "A friend had came over once and the car just broke down. If you're not doing anything today, could you fix it? I would appreciate it a lot." Perfuma asked.

Catra grunted. "Maybe, what's wrong with it?"

Scorpia shrugged. "I don't know car stuff." To this Catra shook her head. "Right, maybe after I'm done eating." They all ate breakfast before Perfuma asked Catra to help her out in the garden.

Perfuma insisted on her coming so Catra gave up and followed her to the back yard. The grass was low and green, she had tall white fences with different floral patterns, a tall and large tree in a corner and the garden bed to the left ouside of the patio.

Catra followed behind her with the drag of her feet, her hands were stuffed in her pockets. "What's wrong, Catra?" Perfuma asked as she handed Catra a metal bucket. "What do you mean?"

"Nature brings out the feeling of everyone, and I'm sensing confliction in you."

"...I've been conflicted all my life." Catra sighed.

"You know..I could tell there was something about you when I first met you. Though you were very rude, I could tell something was strangling your heart." Perfuma hummed. "I didn't like you but once Scorpia showed me the tiniest bit of humanity in you, I realized you were only troubled."

Catra scratched her head, not sure what to say. "Thanks? I guess?" She walked over to a water hose and turned it on. The water poured into the pail and once it filled, she turned it off.

"I know my friends hate you, but I don't completely mind you. You know how to care for nature, you take pictures, you actually have pretty calm hobbies for such a delinquent."

Catra brought the pail into the garden then placed it on the floor. "Yeah, well, I'm a normal person under all of my antics." Perfuma giggled a little. "Surprisingly."

"I know."

Perfuma dipped her water shower pail and let that water fill in before watering her plants. Catra helped her out, taking another one and watering the plants.

Soon afterwards, Catra went back inside. "I figured you would need me to fix something since every other time I'd come, you'd need something fixed" She pointed out.

Scorpia nervously chuckled. "Well we didn't have anything for you to fix, until you mentioned the car. Then instead of her spending money on fixing it, you could fix it."

"For free?" Catra scoffed then laughed with doubt laced in her voice. "You're lucky I owe you, Scorpia. Got the keys?" Scorpia grabbed the keys off the counter and tossed them over. Catra caught them before opening the garage with a button and going outside to the white jeep.

She took her tool box out, and grabbed the few jackhammers she had before sticking it under the car and raising it.

Catra then pulled out a long skateboard she left over a few months ago and took her flashlight out. Catra laid on the skateboard then got comfortable before pulling herself under the car.

She flashed under the car. Her eyes looking for anything wrong underneath. "God this shit is rusty...I kind of wanna give it a good fix. Haven't had this bad of a car in a while." She mumbled out loud, her tail wagging beneath her.

"Alright." She rolled out and got off the skate board before opening the hood. Catra stared at it in complete horror. "*Jesus christ*."

"Is it bad?" Scorpia popped up.

"I'm going to be here longer than I expected." Catra huffed before looking through the hood. "I'm going to take a shopping run after I fix the easier things. Like this goddamn loose pump." She grabbed a monkey wrench out of her tool box and started to fix it.

--

It was some time later, Catra had gotten far but still had some things to fix. Like the oil. It sprayed the hell out of her before she could grab the leak and close it as good as she could.

"Shit--!" Catra wiped her face with a rag, she spotted a kid riding his bike, he had been riding it for a while now. He passed Catra. "Hey, kid!" The boy turned to her and stopped her bike.

"Help me out here, you think you can keep this down for me?" Catra said. "Uhh sure." He parked his bike then cautiously came over. "Hold onto this real quick, push down on it." She told him.

The boy took over from where Catra held onto the leak. "Keep it down if you don't want to get sprayed." Catra grabbed a wrench

and tried tightening the leak. As she did, she decided to make some conversation.

The child was a boy with brown skin and dark brown cornrows. His eyes were purple, he also wore a slight oversized white shirt and black shorts. "So, kid. What's your name?" Catra continued trying to fix the leak.

"Keyrin." He grinned a bit. Keyrin was a magicat, he had a fluffy tail and ears and his nails were sharp and black. "What's yours?" Catra smiled. "Catra. You want to be my new helper?" Keyrin's tail wagged in play. "Yeah. I always liked helping my dad with cars, can I really help you?" He let go of the leak once Catra seperated from the hood, sighing.

"Sure, How old are you, kid?"

"10." Keyrin answered with ease. Catra chuckled. "Really? Well then I'll let you help me. Be careful though." The boy grinned. "Don't worry, I will."

"Alright, you know why this leak happened, right?"

"Uhh because it unloosened?"

"Right. So I had to tighten it. I would stay back from it a little just in case it burst." Catra used the wrench in other places of the hood before laying on the skateboard. "Your parents won't mind you being with a stranger will they? Or well, being gone for this long?"

"No, they said I could go out and do whatever in the neighborhood."

"Really? You and me same, kid. My mom didn't care where I went either."

Keyrin sat on the ground, watching the tail of Catra carefully. "How old are you?" He asked before tapping the tip of her tail. Catra's tail flicked away then came back. "How old do you think?"

"Uhhh 30? 50?"

Catra suddenly gagged at the high guess. She coughed. "Seriously? Do I really look that old?" Her voice had a sense of hurt pride.

Keyrin giggled. "No, but my parents are 30 and 50."

Catra perked. "Oh really?" 'That's a pretty big age gap. how old did this kid say he was again??'

"Waitt no, my mom's turning 30, my dad is 50 something."

To this, Catra furrowed her eyebrows in shock. 'Okay-- now that's a fucking case.' "Is your mom..happy? With your dad I mean?"

"Well, I live with my mom. I don't know how my dad feels."

"Uh, alright. As long as you're safe." Catra hummed. "Pass me the drill please, you know what that is, right?"

"Yah." He picked up the electric drill and slid it to Catra's hand.

"Thanks. Have any friends around the neighborhood?"

"Yes, I have 3 friends. two girls and one boy."

Catra smirked. "You like any of them?"

"Uh--" Keyrin was quiet for a good moment. Catra interrupted the silence. "It's alright if you don't want to tell me."

"Well, do you like any of your friends?"

This silenced Catra for a moment as well as she tried to think. "No not at the moment. A lot of people like me though." She smirked. Keyrin laughed.

The front door open and closed, Catra could hear footsteps coming over to the car. "Oh, hi Ms. Scorpia!" Keyrin smiled. "Hey, Keyrin, I see you've met my friend, Catra."

"Yeah, she's really fun to talk to."

"Aw, thanks squirt."

Scorpia place cold waters on the floor and a new rag. "I see you're helping her?"

"Yep. Is it okay if I'm your friend too, Ms. Catra?" He looked down at the car.

Catra laughed. "Sure kid, tail shake on it."

Keyrin let his tail wrap onto Catra's then they shook tails.

Time passed and Scorpia had come outside again, this time to greet a familiar friend. "Hey!"

"Hey, Scorpia."

Catra flinched at the voice, she became paralyzed. 'Did Scorpia set me up or something?'

"Where's the others?"

"They're coming over soon..Is that a kid working on my car?"

"Uhm, no. We had a mechanic work on it." Scorpia nervously chuckled. "Scorpiaa, I told you I'd pay for one, I don't want you wasting money on me. I'll pay you back."

"It's okay, I got her-- them to do it for free."

"Really?"

Keyrin stared up at Adora. "Hi." Adora waved with a smile. "Hi" He smiled back. "My name is Keyrin, what's yours?"

"Adora." She walked over. Catra quickly pulled herself more up so Adora couldn't see her. *'Fucking Scorpia, got me fixing Adora's car for free.'* She growled lowly.

"Have you met my new friend yet?"

"..Nope, who is it?" Adora squatted next to him.

Keyrin grinned then turned to the car where Catra was under. "Ms. Catra, come out. Meet my newest friend!"

Catra stayed quiet before groaning and letting herself slide from under the car. She let her feet stop her from going to far and stared up at Adora.

Adora froze. "Oh-- Catra??" She flinched. "Seriously?"

Catra huffed. "Trust me princess, I didn't know this was your car. Would have left it just like it was." *'I'm lying, this car is calling for me to fix it.'*

Adora scoffed. "Don't mess it up."

"*Please*, don't tease me." Catra smirked. Adora wore a white turtleneck with jeans, her hair in a ponytail while Catra was still in her tank top and worker pants, however she was more sweaty and dirty. Her hands were stained with oil and rust, so was her shirt. Her face also still had some oil she missed while her hair was ruffled and sweaty.

Adora's cheeks heated up slightly. "Whatever, fuzz you."

"You too, motherfuzzer."

The two substituted their curses because of the kid nearby, they stared at each other before breaking it off. "Thanks anyways."

"Yeah? Keep praising me. You're welcome, *hermosa*." (beautiful). Catra pulled herself back under the car. Adora rolled her eyes and stood up. "Sorry.." Scorpia frowned. "It's alright, I don't know why, but I don't really mind her fixing it...She's a handy person." Adora called back to last night.

"Really? Alright, come in for some snacks. I know walking here could be tiring." She rushed her inside.

Keyrin had passed Catra a drill head. "Do you not like Adora, Catra?"

"Well, we're not...friends, we just know each other. Two people that know and hate each other." Catra answered before a pipe fell and hit Catra on the face. Catra yelped in sudden pain. "Fuck-! I mean--Fuzz! Fuzzing manure!" She groaned, holding her nose.

"One quarter in the swear jar." Keyrin chuckled.

"Catch that pipe please." Catra said.

Keyrin caught the rolling pipe and laid it next to her toolbox. "Thanks." Catra huffed and rolled from under the car. She sat up then stood. Keyrin passed her a rag.

Catra grabbed it then wiped her face, then her hands. "I need to take a store run. You wanna watch over my stuff for me or come with?"

Keyrin perked up. "You mean on the motorcycle?"

"Yeah."

He grinned. "Obviously, I want to go to the store with you!"

Catra laughed then patted him on his head. "Alright, let me wash up. Bring those in the garage."

"Got it captain!" He saluted. Catra chuckled and tossed her rag over her shoulder. She then stuffed her hands in her pockets and walked to the front door.

As she went to open it, the door had already opened, showing Adora holding a clean wet rag. "Oh-- hey." She averted her gaze before looking back at her.

"Hey." Catra replied.

Adora stared at her, feeling oddly nervous. She saw how Catra's gaze trailed down to the cold rag Scorpia made her come out to bring.

"I'm guessing that's for me?" Catra tilted her head slightly. "Yeah..here." Adora hesitantly passed her the wet rag. Catra smirked a bit then wiped her face. "Good?" She asked.

Adora shook her head. "Missed a spot."

"Get it for me?" Catra gestured the rag to Adora. Adora stared at it before looking up at Catra and grabbing the rag. "Fine." She grabbed her chin, causing Catra's heart to take a leap, then wiped the spots Catra missed. Catra suddenly chuckled with a smirk.

Adora scoffed. "Shut up."

"What? I didn't say anything~"

"I'm going to leave this oil in your hair and on your face. Where are you going anyways?"

"To the store and maybe to the hardware store, why, you wanna join me on a motorcycle ride?" Catra's tone and her smirk shifted more seductively. Adora flinched, flustered. "No--"

"Yes! Ms. Adora, come with us please!" Keyrin pleaded. The two looked behind Catra, then looked back at each other.

Catra put her hand on the wall beside Adora. "The child has spoken." She smirked, getting closer to Adora. Adora was backed to the front door, she held her hands close to her. *'Why is she advancing on me like this?'* Adora could only think. *'She's so close, don't show weakness, don't show weakness.'* She breathed in and exhaled with a firm look, her eyebrow cocked.

Adora smirked back. "I suppose he has."

Catra and Adora stared, staying in their same position before Catra separated from her. She let Adora move before she opened the door and went through as Adora walked over to Catra'a motorcyle. She waited patiently with Keyrin.

Keyrin got on top of the motorcycle, almost falling before Adora grabbed ahold of it. "Woohooo! This thing is so bigg!"

Adora giggled a little. "You're the little boy that always rides that cool looking white tiger bike, I remember you now." His tail wagged around as he continued to mess around with the motorcycle.

Catra exited the house, her face clearer, her hair wet from water now, though her clothes still stained a bit. She put on a rough denim jacket and walked over to the two messing with her vehicle. "Having fun?" She shook her head, letting the water spray them, then crossed her arms. Keyrin covered his face, laughing. "Yeah! Now come on!"

"Get off real quick." She told him. Keyrin obliged, l and Catra stuffed a helmet on his head before taking another helmet out and passing it over to Adora. She then got on first. "Adora, get on, Keyrin will sit on your lap." Adora perked and put the helmet on. "Uh, okay." She got on as well before letting Keyrin hop on.

"Make sure both of you hold on."

Adora felt a bit nervous to be doing this. She looked down at Keyrin, who already had his arms wrapped around Catra. Adora smiled a bit and unwraveled his arms, she then hesitantly wrapped her hands around Catra's waist, Keyrin's hands under hers.

Catra was silent before starting the motorcyle and driving it carefully out the driveway. As they rode, Adora watched how carefree Catra looked. It was as if riding a motorcycle was a way Catra felt freedom, Adora could understand that. Her hair waved violently in the wind, she smiled contently.

They arrived shortly and all got off. "You sure you shouldn't have worn your helmet? You could take the one you gave me you know?" Adora said.

"Don't worry about it, need to make sure that smart brain of yours isn't damaged, so keep the helmet." Catra helped Keyrin off and took off his helmet. Adora frowned a bit. "...Suit yourself."

The three entered the hardware store, Keyrin and Adora followed Catra down different aisles. She picked up a variety of things, trying to find the right measurements for Adora's car. Catra walked past a long and hard metalic pipe. She paused and stared at it for a good moment, her eyes dulling.

Keyrin had been looking at other things while Adora had noticed how off Catra suddenly became. She glanced over at her. Catra had picked up the pipe and held it in both of her hands. *'Well doesn't this just hit right... **home**?'*

"No no..please.." Catra pleaded from her breathless lungs, her head dropped, less blood circulated to her body as she hanged from tight chains. "Don't beg, you stupid little bitch! This is your fault, do you know the amount of money I could have made from that!? Im returning you to Shawna as soon the the sun rises tommorow! " The man swung the metalic pipe at Catra, it hit her sides repeatedly as the man pulled back then swung again.

Catra was quiet, her cries were hushed long ago, not a scream could escape her anymore, her eyes burned immensely in emotion and pain but not a tear escaped her. She took the beating till the man became bored of her. He went away and locked her in the cold concrete room, not a glimpse of light in sight.

All Catra could do is close her eyes and wish for better. She started to become hopeless as the days went on.

As she dreamt she woke up in a different setting. A plain with a setting sun and wheat growing farther than she could see. A tree

towered over her, casting shade as she watched the beautiful sunset.

'Freedom. Why..why can't I have this?' She fell to her knees, staring at the sun. The dream felt so real, as did the wheat, the warmth of the sun, and the wind.

"Catra."

"Catra!" Catra was pulled back into reality, realizing she was not in the past anymore. And she was indeed free now.

***Free** .*

She was, wasn't she?

What disillusionment. To be away from the past but not escaping it.

Catra stared at Adora for a good moment. Adora had shook her out of her thoughts, her hands on her shoulders.

Something didn't feel right. Adora didn't seem real, nor did their location. It was as if Catra had just woken up.

"Catra, hey, are you listening to me?" Adora's eyebrows were furrowed in concern. Catra's eyes showed confusion and confliction. "...What is it?" She managed to say.

Adora frowned. "You completely zoned out while glaring at that pipe. Are you..okay?" *'Glaring wasn't really it. She stared at it like she was reliving something. There was so much pain and dullness in her eyes, I thought I lost her for a second.'*

Catra's gaze shifted to the pipe again. "Yeah. I'm fine." She nudged Adora's hands off her shoulders. "...Alright. Keyrin went down that way..let's not lose him."

"Yeah." Catra auto replied. Her mind wandered. *'That mail...please, no one else be out there. Please. Let me have this*

life a little longer.'

'This life I've made myself..don't take me away from it.'

Adora grabbed Catra's wrist suddenly. Catra flinched. "Come on, why're you walking slow? Don't start being moody and depressed now...we can talk about it later if you want."

"Keyrin come back here!"

The two stopped walking seeing as Keyrin was running back over. Catra stared at the blonde in front of her before smiling a bit. She chuckled. "You're an idiot, Adora."

"Tell me something I don't already know." Adora scoffed and glanced behind her. Catra smiled softly. "...You're starting to grow on me." She walked ahead, out the grasp of Adora.

Adora froze, staring as Catra petted Keyrin. "You little rascal. This is a hardware store, you could get hurt."

"Sorry, I'll stay close this time!"

Catra laughed a bit. "You better."

Catra got the rest of what she needed then took Keyrin to get icecream before heading back to Perfuma's.

They arrived and got off.

"My mom is going to want me to be home around this time, so I'll see you tommorow Catra!"

"Don't forget that I'll be online tonight." Catra smirked. "I'm totally gonna beat your butt, no one knows how to play call of duty better than me."

"Watch me!" Keyrin challenged before biking back home.

Now it was just Catra and Adora.

"You're staying for the party, right?" Catra asked. "Yep. But I guess I could help, you know, since I'm so helpful." Adora crossed her arms.

Catra scoffed. "I don't need your help."

"Sure you won't." Adora gave a sure look. "...before I go inside, do you want to talk about earlier?"

"..No. I'm fine. Now stop worrying about me already." Catra sat on the skateboard. "Go inside and have fun."

Adora stared down at her. "..Fine, if you say so." She went inside.

Catra sighed after hearing the front door close, her heart started to pick up, the speed making her feel like it was collapsing into her chest. She grabbed her chest, hyperventilating. Everything around her felt so distorted.

"M..Me-Melog-- Melog." She mumbled. *'Calm down, calm down, calm down. Melog's purring, focus on his purring.'* Catra thought about the purring of her cat from the last time she had a panic attack. She stayed still until her heart calmed and her breathing slowed. Catra then, after being sure she was alright, started fixing Adora's car again.

As the sun started to set and people started parking, near the house for Perfuma's party. It wasn't huge, just a get together with friends, drinks were included surprisingly.

Catra didn't plan to invite herself in, she only planned to finish what she was working on and go home. She put her headphones in to focus on her task at hand. She had fixed the oil pipe, now what was left was to clean the rust from the car, tighten pipes, and fix the engine. The engine, Catra figured she could leave to do for tommorow.

She heard music inside and laughter, before hearing the front door open and close, signaling to her that someone had exited the

house. Catra heard footsteps getting closer to her. Then the person sat criss cross on the floor.

Catra decided to ignore them, supposing it was a drunk, that was until they spoke.

"Catra. It's getting darker..and colder out here." Adora said. She noticed how Catra had paused what she was doing for a second. "Your observation skills are as obvious as ever, Adora." She said sarcastically before continuing to replace and tighten some parts. Adora rolled her eyes. "I'm just saying you should come inside and work on this tommorow."

"I'm fine." Catra replied immediately. "I prefer it outside."

Adora stared at her tail then exhaled. *'No you're not.'* "Okay, alright, I get it. Guess you don't want this wine cooler then? Or this beer?" She saw Catra pause again, this time she removed herself from under the car and sat up. "No one said that. Give me the beer."

To this, Adora smiled a bit and passed Catra the beer before opening the wine cooler for herself. "Knew you would want it."

Catra grunted. "When I leave I don't say goodbye, so don't be surprised if you come out and don't see me."

"I wouldn't be surprised." Adora hummed. "...I guess I'll see you in the Limbo then..?"

Catra perked slightly.

"Well, yeah."

The two had looked off, the topic of the Limbo seeming heavy. "If we were to tell a therpist, you think we'd be put into an asylum?" Adora asked. This earned a breathless chuckle out of Catra. "They'd definitely put me in one, you, they'd probably think I influenced you."

"Well, you did."

Catra glanced at her.

"I'm only in this Limbo because I took a hit of *your* cigarette." Adora gave her an accusitory look. Catra cocked an eyebrow then smirked. "I never thought you'd be so easily peer pressured, Carrero."

"I'm not."

"Really? Then why'd you take it?"

"I took it because...I don't know?? You said I should take it to ease the stress, but it really didn't, instead, I saw a fellow friend die."

"Again, so easily peer pressured." Catra slid a cigarette pack out from the waist of her pants.

Adora scoffed and pouted a bit. She noticed the pack Catra had took out and how Catra's shirt had lifted slightly. She gave Catra an annoyed glare. Catra stared straight at her as she lit the end of one cigarette and put it up to her mouth.

She was amused at how pissed Adora looked. Catra inhaled, then exhaled the smoke before smirking. "What about now? This isn't peer pressuring now, is it?" She gestured the cigarette towards her.

"Pretty sure it is." Adora crossed her arms.

Catra tilted her head slightly. "Well? You going to take it or no?"

"No, I'm fine." Adora averted her gaze. As Catra smoked, she remembered how concerned Adora was the last time she tried smoking in the Limbo. She sighed then took it out her mouth. "Listen, How about I give it a month?"

Adora looked back at her. "What?"

"What if I'm clean for a month? No weed. Would that keep you off my ass?" Catra asked her. Adora perked up. "You sure you could do that? I know addiction is hard to get over. You don't have to do it."

"Bullshit, I can see it on your fucking face. When you see me smoking it must remind you of your family, doesn't it?" Catra stubbed out the cigarette on the ground. Adora suddenly felt cornered. "....Yeah..it does remind me of friends and family. But it's your life, Catra. Not mine, I'm just tired of seeing so many people I know make the same mistake."

Catra sighed then grabbed her mini blowtorch and tossed her pack of cigarettes on the floor. Adora flinched once Catra turned on the blowtorch. "Whatt are you doing??" She furrowed her eyebrows in concern. Catra set the pack on fire then watched with a blank expression as it burned.

Adora was in complete confusion. "Why'd you do that for?"

"I challenge myself one month, starting the end of this month. If I can do it what do you think I should treat myself with?"

"No idea." Adora shrugged.

Catra suddenly perked. "I know what I want." She smirked softly, trying to detrmine whether she should say it or not. "What is it?"

"How about I up the stakes, 3 months without smoking and I get a kiss on the cheek." Catra's smirk became more playful. Adora froze for a second before blushing a bit. "What--? What kind of deal is that??"

Catra chuckled before standing up and stomping out the burnt cigarette pack. She put out her hand for Adora to take. "How about it, princess?"

Adora stared up at her, her heart racing faster than usual. She glanced away and took her hand before looking back at her once Catra helped her up. "Fine" Adora tapped on Catra's cheek where

her scar was present. "I'll kiss you right there, if you're clean for 3 months. And you better not cheat."

Catra felt like a proud kid, her tail wagged. "Don't worry I always stand by my word." She got close to Adora, leaning slightly into her touch. Adora blushed and scoffed. "I get it already, now fuck off before someone sees us."

"Aw, you're shy~ Don't want anyone to see us flirting?"

"I. am. not. And you're the one that's flirting, what happened to you literally hating me?"

Catra's expression dropped, she closed in near Adora's ear in seriousness. This sudden movement caused Adora's heart to jump and land flips in her stomach. "I do, but I'm not against hate fucking." She whispered. Adora's palms became sweaty, her body temperature became heated and her face reddened.

"You--!" She was going to say something to make it seem like she wasn't nervous. That was until they both heard the front door open. "Adora, Catra? What the hell are you two doing?" Glimmer said with a very confused and suspecting look.

The two seperated immediately, flustered.

"N-nothing. Justt nothing." Adora looked at her. Catra just stared at Glimmer. "That's not what it looked like." Glimmer crossed her arms. "What are you guys doing out here?"

"Carrero came to give me a beer from Scorpia, I accidentily got some oil in her eye and tried helping her get it out." Catra lied before looking at Adora. Adora averted her gaze, still blushing. "Right, Adora?"

Adora's gaze landed back on Catra. Catra winked at her, sending a strange stimulation through Adora's body that made her have chills that went down her spine and her arms. "Yeah." She answered.

Glimmer gave a curious look before going back inside.

"Close call?"

"..Mm-yeah it was." Adora exhaled.

"Go back inside, I'll see you tonight, we can get farther." Catra got back down to the floor and started collecting her things. "If you say so." Adora finished her wine cooler then went back inside.

'Hate fucking? God she's really..she's so annoying-- How could she just suggest something like that? But of course it's just like her, sex has been the only thing she was about even before I knew much about her.' Adora thought as she entered the house. '*Am I actually considering it? What in the world is wrong with me? I can't get into something like that with Catra, she'll just toss out my heart, we hate each other anyways.'*

Catra stared up at the stars before smirking. *'Live the life I've made to it's fullest I told myself the day I was free.'* She reminisce.

------- Extra, next day

Adora and Catra leaned on her car, holding ice pops. "Thanks..Catra." Adora looked over at Catra.

Catra glanced at her before smiling. "Sure, gotta make sure my favorite punching bag makes it to school comfortably."

Adora rolled her eyes. "I'll pay you, you did a good job." She smiled. Catra froze, her heart beating irregularly, seeing how genuine Adora's smile was. She smiled as well, before chuckling. Adora found it charming.

"You don't need to pay me, I've been saying this since this morning. You're welcome, princess.

Adora blushed, immediately facing away from Catra so she wouldn't please her with the fact that she made her blush. "No, I insist."

"Not happening, richy." Catra crossed her arms. "I don't want your money, I did it for free. Consider it a truce gift."

Adora pouted, which Catra found extremely cute. "*Que linda*" She mumbled with a smirk. "What?"

7

The wind blew silently, the temperature of the Limbo becoming colder and colder each night. It was as if seasons were actually present. Catra wouldn't put it past it , the Limbo was already known for it's realism . She looked at the drivers seat. Adora had one hand on the wheel while she relaxed in her seat, staring blankly at the clear road in front of her.

Well, maybe not a clear road. As they got closer, they began to see more greenery and rubble, cracked roads, streets and more lived in buildings. "128 minutes, the surgery shouldn't have taken that long. They should have taken part of the rib instead..." Adora mumbled to herself. Catra ignored her incessant rambling and turned down her ac side a little bit more. The blonde glanced at her before looking back at the road. "Aren't you cold?? It's like 40 something degrees outside and your ac is at 50."

"I like the cold?"

Adora's gaze shifted to her ac side, which was at 80 degrees, then back to the road. "Yeah but what if you get some kind of cold?"

"I enjoy the numbness." Catra admitted.

"Hmm..okay. " Adora gave up on going back and forth with her. After a moment of complete silence between the two, the only noise heard being the muffled sound of the car's engine, Catra decided to speak up.

"That abandoned car we saw some miles back, what did you think of it?"

"Could have just been the gengars' doing. We don't know their intelligence or exactly what they do , we just know to stay clear from them." Adora answered with an unsure tone. "Maybe, something just doesn't feel right." Catra stared out her window.

"Well if we do find anyone else, it'll be a good thing , we won't be alone. Other people means other personalities to be with and I'd take that over staying with a hot headed delinquent."

Catra gave a fake half suppressed laugh. "Whatever you're trying to say, let it the fuck out, princess."

"If I do you'll only prove me right, hot head. I'm just saving you the embarrassment." Adora retorted. Catra growled lowly at her but said nothing, figuring it wouldn't be the best idea to say what she wanted to.

The two continued driving until they reached a highway. They both loved the highways, especially because there's no cars, no damages, just road ahead, meaning they could speed all they wanted. Adora went at a fast speed but not too dangerous, keeping them around 80 mph. She slowed a bit, as they started to get near the exit.

The highway was surrounded by trees around it, all tall and thin trees. Catra was captivated by them. That was until she noticed one falling right in front of them. "Adora, tree! Hit the breaks!" She yelled suddenly. "What--?!" Adora flinched at the sight of the large and tall tree falling towards them, she tried speeding up, however the tree caught them.

The tree had fell directly on the hood, making incapable to move. "Fuck--! How did that even happen??" Catra took off her seat belt and ripped her legs from the crushed dash board, her heart rate spiked once she noticed the blood flowing from her leg. Adora took her seatbelt off as well. "Shit, my head." Adora moaned in pain, she held her head, clenching her teeth.

Their windows had shattered, the car was destroyed, the honk was going off like a siren, attracting anything nearby. Catra coughed, the smoke of the car getting to her. She put her hand on the handle and went to open the door before hearing the click of a shotgun.

Her head shot up, staring at the now, no smoke, perfectly clear, double barrel right at her eyes. "Get out the car, hands up!"

"Catra..?" Adora said, questioning the other on what to do next.

"...Just do as they say. I don't want two rounds between my eyes." Catra replied. "Me either." She stepped out the car, holding her hands away from her. Catra did the same. ***People*** *. Catra figured Adora's theory was pretty valid but now it only proves it.*

'5 people, A quadron. Soldiers? They're wearing soldier clothes or atleast what looks like bullet proof vest. Two are women, the other three maybe man or another.'

"Shit, Catra, your leg--!"

"Yeah, I know, it hurts like shit" She breathed unevenly , however her sharp eyes continued examining their situation. Her mind raced, looking for ways to get out of this.

"*Hey, we're survivors like you, there's no need for all this." Adora tried to reason with them but to no avail. two of them kicked behind both Catra and Adora's legs, making them fall to their knees. Catra yelped in pain. "This is what happens when you wish for other people's company. I would never swat you down like this no matter how tempting." Catra sneaked a retort at Adora. Adora rolled her eyes. "Shut up, how can you be joking when there's guns being pointed at you?"*

Catra smirked. "Because the thrill of it all is so funny to me. " She was suddenly hit on the head by the back of a shotgun. "Shut up!"

"V. Wait for orders." One said.

"Got it." The other answered. They spoke through a radio and once they finished, they signalled to another. "We're taking them."

Abruptly, Catra and Adora were hit in the back of the head with more force than the last.

--- Hour later.

Catra shot up from her bed in a cold sweat, she immediately ripped the covers from her body and checked her leg. It was just as it was when she slept. So injuries aren't transferred. All she could manage to say was "Did we just get fucking swatted?" She groaned. *'I slept longer than supposed. So if we're knocked out, we don't wake up straight up'.*

She snatched her phone off her night stand and went to Adora's contact.

Catra: Great, new chapter unlocked, pretty sure we just got kidnapped

Adora: Your sarcasm never fails to simultaneously amuse and piss me off.

Catra: Aw, thanks

Adora: If only you could see my eyeroll.

Adora: This is bad, they could be stealing our things.

Catra: Or bringing us to their woman slave camp where they'll rape us, make us bare their children and continue the cycle through inbreeding

Adora: Catra, what the fuck???????

Catra: What? It could happen you know. They're bringing us to their camp, we gotta be ready for that

Adora: What is wrong with you??

Catra: I wonder the same thing everyday

Adora: Anyways, we can't go back to sleep after waking up like that, our bodies couldn't do it even if we tried. We'll just have to wait till tonight.

Catra: Or waste all our energy right now then go back to sleep again

Adora: That's..a terrible idea.

Catra: Still an idea

Adora: Whatever, try to keep your mind somewhat off of it while we're at school today. Your mind needs to be free once we go back in.

Catra: What if they're boiling us alive, or staking us above a bonfire? 😌

Adora: I'd like to not think of that.

Catra: Okay, but what if it's happening right now?

Adora: I'm going to block you 😔

Catra: What? What did I even do

Adora: What haven't you done, Catra?

Catra: True

Catra: Hey, what if you have a baby in the Limbo? Is the baby real or is it just a dream baby? 😳🤔

Adora: Catra.

Catra: Yep? Wanna find out with me? We can test the theory. 😌

Adora: What! No! 😨

Adora: Listen, do me a favor?

Catra: What is it?

Adora: Shut up, *please*.

Catra: 😭

Adora: No, like, how am I supposed to know any of what you're saying?? I'm in as much confusion as you are! 😭

Catra laughed a full hearted laugh, smiling warmly once she finished. She put her phone down then sighed and glanced at her door. 'I guess I should get ready.' Catra got off her bed then took a shower.

-

Adora stepped out of her shower, wrapping a towel around her body. She walked up to her mirror and stared deeply at it. *'Mom and dad have had me trapped in here for weeks. My assignments are becoming even more confusing, this whole Limbo thing is messing with my sleep schedule.'* She rambled on in her head. Her mind was full of so many thoughts, they all raced around in a jumbled mess.

'And then there's Catra, what am I going to do about Catra? What are you talking about, what is there to do with her?' Adora dried her hair with a different towel then put on a white collared sweater with light blue jeans. She let her hair stay down, deciding to just keep her hair band in her pocket just in case. As Adora faced her window, she put her golden necklaces on.

A knock emitted from her door. Adora groaned inwardly. "The door is unlocked." She answered. The door opened, revealing a maid, one that was present in Adora's life especially when she was a baby. Her mother trusted this maid, meaning the maid wasn't all trustworthy to Adora.

"Good morning Master Adora. How was your rest?"

"It was *decent*." She commented. "What do you need?"

"Your parents are going to pick you up early. An old relative is coming, your grandmother. Your mother says to not dissappoint." The maid's gaze shifted to Adora's nightstand where her phone

laid. Her messages were open. Her eyes narrowed a bit to focus on the small writing.

Adora was silent, annoyed. "How early?" The maid's gaze directed back to her.

"I haven't been told the detailed information. Your mother also says behave, though I'm sure she will tell you that later today...are you sure you rested well, Master Adora?" She asked in suspicion. Adora didn't look well rested, there were bags under her eyes, her posture was more sluggish than usual, and she seemed more irratable.

"You know, if I'm correct, your job isn't to be concerned about my health. You're my mother's maid, not mine." Adora fixed her posture and turned to her before grabbing her backpack. "You're dismissed." She kindly told her off. "A..as you wish, Master Adora." The maid obliged, bowing before walking away, feeling a bit hurt.

'I gotta get to school so I can study for that test early.' Adora sighed and grabbed her phone off the nightstand. Her frown had turned into a slight smile, seeing the recent messages between her and Catra. *'Goddamn weirdo'* She closed her phone and put it in her pocket.

She went downstairs, and for the first time in what felt like a long time, she spotted her father having a cup coffee at the bar counters. He read a newspaper while the news played loudly on the living room tv. "Forenoon, second born." He greeted formally.

Adora's father's name was Aaron Zus Carerro. His long silky hair was a really light blonde, his eyes a deep sharp blue, he had a scruff beard and mustache. Aaron was a tolerable father to Adora, even though he didn't seem to care as much when she was younger. They've had their moments.

"Dad." Adora said.

"That nearly expired trash is in BrightMoon, said she wanted to see her grandchildren and talk about business." Her father scoffed. This is when Adora remembered that she and her father were pretty alike, especially because she got her height, eyes, laugh, scoff, humor, and sarcasm from him. "Now what would mom say to you talking about her mother like that?"

Aaron rolled his eyes. Adora also rolled her eyes. *'How could I forget about the attitude?'*

"Oh please, everyone hates that goddamn witch. Even your mother. However you still need to behave. Bond with her or..something." He sipped his coffee. "Give this young chit a latte, good sir." Her father told one of the workers behind the counter. "As you wish Master Aaron." The worker bowed.

"I don't want a latte." Adora crossed her arms.

Aaron gave her a doubtful look. "You look like you need some deep grounded coffee. Get your latte so you can stay up atleast, then get to that slave factory they call school."

"Whatever you say, dearest father.." Adora replied, slight annoyance laced in her voice. "You learn from the best." He smiled briefly before going back to reading his newspaper. The man behind the counter slid Adora a latte in a cardboard coffee cup. She took it then went outside so the waiting benz.

Adora into the backseat and slouched, closing her eyes, sitting in her thoughts. "Take me to school, Henness, and take the long route, please." She said, tiredly.

"Of course, Master Adora." The driver in a white suit responded before pulling out of the driveway.

Adora exhaled, her thoughts tracing back to when she was younger.

"One day once she's older, she's going to realize that there's a reason why we act like this. It's the Carrero way, it's how our line

of First Ones ruled! The way Adora acts now, she'll never be fit for the company." Adora's uncle yelled at her father.

"You don't think I know that?! Adora will be a fine leader, I know it, you don't get to talk about my child like yours isn't a ***fucking reject*** *!" Aaron yelled back.*

-
"Adora Adora Adora, when are you going to start acting like a Carrero. You're soft." Her mother complained.
-
"You have no time for friends, Adora!" Her father snapped.
-
"Get back to studying so you can put your knowledge into this company." Adora's mother said with a venomess demand in her voice.
-
'I don't want to take over the company.' Adora begged.

"Well, you weren't made for anything else but that, Adora. You're only here for the sake of the lineage of the First Ones. Nevermore." Her grandmother told her.

"You'll marry a man of a different company and lead the company and family, finally, into some new powerful terittory. "

'But I don't want to do that..' Adora pulled her knees up to her chest.

"No one has ever had a choice in it."
--
"Don't be like your brother. He was a dissapointment, gallavanting off with some carribean boy we know absolutely nothing about. Fucking twinks, you better not become one of those Dykes." Her uncle stumbled about with an empty wine bottle in his hand. Adora stared up at him a frown put upon her face.

Adora opened her eyes and glanced out the window. 'How'd you do it, Jean? How'd you take control of you life the way you

wanted?' She sighed quietly. '..you too Catra. How'd you do it?'

_

Catra yawned before stretching, her tail also stretching out. "Tired?" Lonnie asked. "Does it show?" Catra leaned onto the table and laid her head in her arms. The two were outside on school campus at a table with breakfast. "Well, yeah. You look like you barely got a wink of sleep. Or..nightmare?"

"Not exactly." Catra stared off. "But you could put it under that category."

"Was it about Shadow Weaver?" Lonnie frowned.

"...Yeah." Catra lied. Lonnie noticed this but was quiet about it. She could tell Catra was dishonest about something, she was hiding a secret. "Hey, you had something you needed to tell me? I remember you asking and don't even try and avoid it." Lonnie said, firmly. "Yeah, I know...Lonnie, I got a letter in the mail from both cps and my adoption home. They were quote on quote, checking on me. They also added that they've found a relative of Shadow Weaver to take care of me."

Lonnie flinched. "What?! But I thought they weren't in BrightMoon, and that they would never think that you'd..you know.. Shadow Weaver."

"I know."

"Do you have any guess on who it would be?"

"No, I'm worried, what if I go back?" Catra's eyes dilated in fear, her tail curling around her ankle. "What if they hurt me? What if..--"

"--Catra. Stop with the what ifs, you're just going to stress yourself." Lonnie kicked her chair, to which Catra startled. Catra frowned. "I know I know but I can't just not worry about it. I don't want to go back."

Lonnie exhaled. "This time, you should open up to somebody. Like the counsler."

"I can't do that, cause then I'll have to come out about how I fucking killed Shadow Weaver."

"Quiet--! Don't say that out loud, someone will hear you."

"Nobody would believe me, and there's barely anyone around."

The two stared at each other for a moment, an anxious look on both of their faces. "I'm just gonna go to the club today and rid myself of my worry and pitiful life for a night." Catra drank her orange juice. "Catraaa." Lonnie said, complaining. "You can't get rid of your problems with sex."

"Sure I can. Join me." Catra put her plastic cup up while she stood up, motioning for Lonnie to cheer with her. Lonnie scoffed, rolling her eyes before touching cups with her. She stood up as well.

"Cheers." Catra smirked before finishing her juice. Lonnie finished hers as well. "You know, I'm surprised you didn't kill the boyfriend too." Lonnie said. Catra flinched before smacking her lightly on the arm. "Quit, I'm not a murderer. Plus I figured he'd do the job for me later on. Haven't seen him in years."

Lonnie hummed. She stared at Catra to which Catra caught her gaze. "...There's something missing."

"What is it?"

"Like I'm missing a part of my memory. A good portion." Lonnie explained. Catra's ear twitched, her eyebrows furrowed a bit. "You alright?"

"Yeah..I'm okay." She averted her gaze and crossed her arms.

Catra frowned. *'Lonnie..is this even you? Of course it is, what am I on?'* She put her hand out. Lonnie gave her the cup and Catra put the cups into each other.

The two passed through the cafeteria, making their way to their lockers. Catra noticed that she was about to pass the table Adora and her friends sat at.

Catra smirked, she put the empty cups down in front of Adora. Adora had flinched, not expecting Catra at *all*, who secretly winked at her and continued walking off. Adora huffed. "I'm not your maid, Michalka!"

"After being surrounded by them all your life, I'm surprised, princess!" Catra shouted back. Adora scoffed and backed down. "Fucking brat." She grumbled, feeling her cheeks heat up. Perfuma shook her head, tired of their bantering. Glimmer had an annoyed look on her face while Bow didn't seem to mind the situation. Mermista chuckled. "She got you there, Adora."

Adora rolled her eyes. "Yeah, I know."

Lonnie smirked at Catra, giving her an all knowing look. Catra looked at her before becoming a bit flustered. "What?"

"Stop looking at me like that, I didn't even do anything." She rubbed her forearm.

"I'm sensing chemistry, Catra."

"Chemistry my ass."

Lonnie laughed a bit. "Whatever buddy, you going to that Gunther party?" Catra shrugged. "Are you?"

"Yeah, I wanna go."

"Then I'm going."

---------- Later that day.

The tip of the lead pencil lightly pressed on the tan-ish paper, the drawing being one of a person drowning while white and black roses wrapped around their body in a beautiful death.

The sound of the AC blowing through the ventilation, the low hums of the dryer and the wishing and washing sound emitting from the dishwasher and washing machine, the smallest drops from the tap, the flowing of the plants in her room, all this, Catra could appeal to. These are the types of things that would wake her up so early.

Catra stopped her pencil and put it down on her desk before moving the drawing aside onto a different table full of polaroids, and a two racks of polaroid pictures. She let her head drop onto the desk, a loud thump echoing lightly. Melog trilled, staring sleepily at her. "The polaroids are nearly done, they just need some time...and so do I. I don't wanna wake up in the Limbo." Catra complained as she stood up aggressively.

"This is such bullshit, the shit with Lonnie, cigarettes, Adora, and the fucking cps and adoption home. Why me, god, why me?" She put her hand to her face, covering it as she felt herself begin to tear up. Catra sighed and turned off her desktop, making sure she saved her work then left her office room.

Catra was one for hobbies, going from mechanics, nature and photography. She started them when she was free from her adoptive mother, it wasn't easy leaving the house in the morning she was terrified to see so many people.

A buzz sounded in her pocket. That was when she remembered, she got a buzz earlier, some time ago, but wasn't in the mindset to even touch her phone. Catra took out her phone to see he was texted by Adora and that Lonnie had sent her some video.

She pressed Adora's message first, before being taken aback a little.

Adora: Hey, can I get some advice?

Adora had sent that some time ago, Catra didn't know whether she should respond or leave it on read.

Catra: You're asking me?? Then this must be important

Adora: Just listen, okay?

She had texted back a little quicker than normal, like she was already on Catra's contact.

Catra: I'm listening.

Adora: Soo, you remember that day we talked about me being peer pressured easily?

Catra: What happened?

Adora: I just got pressured by Glimmer into going to a nightclub with her and another friend of hers, AND this guy she wants me to get with.

Catra: Nightclub? You? A nerd at a nightclub, again. How'd you get pressured into that?

Adora: She was begging me and giving me pity remarks and stuff and I just gave in because at least they'd have fun.

Catra stared at the text before huffing and calling Adora. Adora, in her bed while the girls got ready in her bathroom, flinched. She went to her porch and closed the door behind her before leaning on the railing and answering the phone.

"Yeah?"

"But what about you? Sparkles shouldn't be dragging you out of your comfort zone like that. Why does she want you to go anyways?" Catra said as she went to the far back of her office and laid on her bed. The room was dark and red because of the LED lights, she had them on for the polaroids.

"Because she claims I don't get out much and I need to find someone else before I latch onto Caleb or something." Adora answered, frowning. "Also she's trying to get over Bow--"

"--Fuck that! That's not any of your fault nor does it have anything to do with you. Sparkles needs to handle her own problems instead of dragging others into them as an excuse" Catra scoffed, staring at her ceiling. Adora paused for a moment, her mouth slightly opened.

"Yeah, she does. Y-you're right, as much as it feels weird to say."

Catra was quiet as a mouse for a moment, she then chuckled, the alluring raspy sound sending a suggestive feeling to Adora. Adora felt the hairs on her body raise and her body chill. She figured it was because she was outdoors but she knew the actual reason.

"Whats so funny?" Adora smiled slightly but eventually gave in and smiled calmly

"Nothing" Catra hummed. "At the end of the day, it's your decision whether you go or not." She glanced at her plants. "Crazy thing is, I was going to go to a club today as well."

"Well, with any luck, we won't see each other." Adora smiled. Catra laughed. "You know damn well you want to see me, princess. No need to deny it."

Adora rolled her eyes. She opened her mouth to reply but was interrupted by Glimmer opening the sliding door. "Adora, what are you doing out here? You alright?"

"Remember, your decision." Catra said.

"Yeah, I get it, thanks."

"I'm never busy, princess. Call me whenever you need."

"Alright, bye."

"Mhm."

Adora hanged up the phone, staring at Glimmer. "Yep?"

"You alright?" Glimmer asked, leaning on the railing. Adora nodded. "Yeah, I'm fine. Do I really have to go? I don't want to hookup with anyone, I'd rather finish my studying."

"Adora you've been studying since you got home. Who was on the phone?"

Adora perked up. "Oh uh..no one? Just a wrong number." Glimmer cocked an eyebrow. "You guys coming?" Mermista asked. The two looked at the sliding door then at each other.

Glimmer gave her a pleading look to which Adora subdued to. "Finee." She groaned. Glimmer squealed. "Come on then, get ready!"

Catra stood outside the Lorem club with Lonnie. The club was a large building with loud blasting music, it was tall, going up 15 stories. Full of different rooms for hookups, and the strippers in the other sections. Catra had a membership there because a friend of hers worked there.

"I'm ready to get laid." Catra said, fixing her jacket. She wore a dark brown jacket, black croptop, black jean tights, and black and white tennis shoes. Lonnie wore an orange shirt, black jacket, and jean shorts.

"Hey, we could have done it earlier."

Catra chuckled. "Yeah but it's better at a club."

"Yeah, you're right."

The two both had matching jewelry from a necklace, to a ring and earrings. Lonnie had silver while Catra had gold. They walked over to the V.I.P line and went through easily after the bouncers confirmed they had no weapons and had their passes.

Catra and Lonnie went to the bar first, ordering a few drinks to get tipsy near drunk. The music got more upbeat, to this, Lonnie got up from her seat and invited Catra to dance with her.

They got into the crowd and began to dance with each other before eventually breaking off and dancing with others.

As she wasted her night away, Catra suddenly bumped into someone. She turned around, recognizing the coconut with a hint of honey lavender scent.

"S-sorry." She heard.

"Adora?" Catra said, abruptly. Adora flinched and turned around. "Catra?"

'Damn, I don't know if it's just that I had too much to drink but Adora looks really..fuckable right now.' Catra shook her head. "So you decided to go after all." She said loud enough for Adora to hear her.

"Yeah...I don't really want to be here." She shouted back.

"Then why are you on the dance floor, princess?" Catra took her hand and twirled her into a dip. Adora blushed, but she was already blushing from drinking. "Came with Mermista." She answered.

"Wanna get out of here then?" Catra put her hand to Adora's cheek then lets her nail trail down her neck.

"...Yeah"

Catra brought her back up then gestured her towards the elevators. The two walked over to the elevators then went up to the 15th floor.

"You rented a room?"

"The 15th floor, 1503 is my room, always. Come on. There's plenty of stuff to do in it, it's V.I.P."

"You paid for V.I.P??" Adora cocked an eyebrow. "Course I did." Catra shrugged before unlocking her door and letting Adora in.

Adora wolf whistled as she entered the alluring room. "Not bad." She said. Catra chuckled. The room was pretty big, a wide Queen bed big enough for three people with red silk covers. The floor was dark smooth and glossed over wood, there was carpet on the floor around the bed, it was dark red.

Adora walked over to the long black curtains and opened them wide. The bright and night active BrightMoon shone below them while the grey clouds were right above them.

"You have a nice scenery."

"I sure goddamn do." Catra said, suggestively while staring at Adora. Adora perked and glanced at her. She noticed how the other was staring at her. She smirked. "What are you trying to say?"

Catra smirked before grabbing a bottle of wine off a cabinet table. She poured it into two glasses then took the two glasses and went over to the bed.

Catra sat and gestured for Adora to sit with her. Adora walked over and sat next to her. She took a glass and drank some wine.

"Do you feel better now? You're now 14 stories away from the blasting noise." Catra crossed her legs. Adora smiled, her body feeling hot. "Yeah, I actually do. Thanks, hothead." They stared at each other. *'Her freckles have been more noticable lately. I wonder why that is. They are pretty.'*

Adora swallowed the taste of the wine in her mouth. *'I'm horny and this hot and sexy magicat latina is by my side. I'm also getting really tipsy and so is she. No, Adora-- it's just lust, ignore it.'*

She took another sip of the glass. "Glimmer pleaded me and I just gave up. Now I'm here, drinking away whatever the hell I was stressing about."

"I hear that." Catra hummed then groaned. "Damn it's hot." She glanced at the ac monitor. It could only go down and up 3 degrees. She then stripped off her jacket and laid it next to her. Adora couldn't help but wonder what would happen if she gave in to the temptation of intercourse with Catra. Her toned arms and stomach, her short hair, her gaze, her rough scarred hands. Adora just felt like pulling her over.

Catra on the other hand was desperately trying to keep herself under control,and it wasn't exactly working. She wanted her clothes to be pulled off by someone else immediately, the lust was practically uncontrollable. Her tail thrashed around in arousal. "Yeah, it is." The two stared again before slowly getting close to each other.

"This is a..horrible idea." Adora mumbled.

"You're still getting closer.." Catra replied.

They stopped, feeling each other's breath on each other, but didn't move back.

"..So is it still such a bad idea?"

Adora was quiet for a moment, her diamond blue eyes staring down at her, showing lust. "Curse you and your sarcastic--" Adora grabbed her by her collar and kissed her. Catra was taken aback before leaning into it, Adora's left hand slid from her collar to Catra's waist. She pulled her closer towards her body, grinding upon her, then slowly started undressing her.

Catra was in a lustful shock, usually, she was the dominator, but here she was being ravished by someone she knew to only be a jock and a smart nerd. She never knew Adora was capable.

She ended up removing Catra's top and hers and started to nibble at her neck. Catra suppressed a moan, clenching her teeth. "*Fuck*--" She let out, her nails digging into Adora's back.

Adora began removing Catra's pants before she suddenly fell asleep from too much drinking. She fell on Catra, her grip on her loosening, and her head laying right next to hers. Catra stared at the ceiling, her heart pounding a racing in her chest.

"A-Adora?" She shook her. "Adora--" Catra tried again before letting her head rest on the bed. "Fuck."

"Never knew you had it in you, princess. But where does this put us?"

Catra pushed her off to the side. 'How are you gonna get home, I'm definitely not waking you up.' She stared at Adora that wore a peaceful look as she slept. Catra put her clothes back on then put Adora's back on and regained some of her dignity before leaving the room and closing the door.

"Joseph? Josephhh!" Catra whispered aloud, finding a friend of hers.

"Looking for me?" A guy around Catra's age with dark silver hair and green eyes tilted his head, his hands on his hips, while he stood behind Catra. He wore a black suit.

"Joseph, thank god--!" Catra put her hand to her heart and sighed in relief.

Joseph raised an eyebrow. "What'd you do this time, Catra?"

"You think you can bring the girl in my room downstairs, bottom floor, and give her to her friends? She fell asleep and her friends shouldn't see me bringing her downstairs."

"What do her friends look like? And are these people from your school or something?"

"Look for one with sparkly kinda poofy hair and sparkly eyes and another one with long blue hair and brown eyes, you can't miss em. And yes, they are."

"No wonder you look so stressed. Go home, get some rest, I'll get Lonnie for you too, I'm sure you came with her." He said before walking off into Catra's room, his tail swaying.

"Thanks man, you're a life saver." Catra smiled before following him.

"Wow, a blonde this time?"

"Who would have thought it?" Catra smirked. Joseph chuckled. The two have known each other for some time now, Joseph was the one that gave Catra the V.I.P pass since they were friends. They met at an airport dining, surprisingly.

Catra crossed her arms while she stared at Joseph picking up Adora carefully. She trusted him, more than Caleb especially. Her gaze had wandered to the curtains that Adora had drawn earlier before the entire entanglement. Catra blushed profusely, covering her face. "She's such an idiot." She mumbled.

Catra looked through her fingers at the window once more when suddenly her blood ran cold. She froze, and removed her hand from her face. A tall black figure of a different person stood outside in the rain. They were a contrast to the beautiful bright night of BrightMoon. Catra's fur raised in correction to her fear. Her tail puffed slightly, going on the defensive. The shadow's presence was unnerving, the way it stood outside, with not a platform to stand on. The way it stared and stared on.

It was like a ghost. A slim and tall unnerving ghost.

The figure suddenly turned it's head, facing Adora. It then shifted into a younger Catra, specifically 7 year old Catra, only she was a shadow. The shadow Catra tilted her head at her, her tail swaying around in what Catra could only describe as dissociative pain. Catra remembered that feeling, she remembered how she made

signs with her tail to communicate silently with Melog. The shadow was giving her a sign and it was signalling with it's tail.

"We are Death."

Catra was confused. "What? What the hell do you mean by that?" She mumbled.

"Huh?" Joseph asked, putting Adora over his shoulders. "Damn, is she drunk. Catra, my friend, are you alright?" He looked back at Catra, who disappeared. "Catra...?" He spotted her over at the window.

"What do you mean by Death? And us?" Catra's eyes were dull, staring at her younger shadow self, her hand touching the window. "Can you see her too, Joseph?" She looked back.

"Uhh, who? Should I bring you home?"

"..No. I'm okay." Catra sighed and fixed her jacket. She cleared her throat. "Just bring her downstairs, please."

"You got it."

8

"Hello! Let us out of here damn it!" Adora shouted. She heard people outside, but they didn't answer. All she knew was that she and Catra were kidnapped and were tied to some pole inside some room. The floor was cold concrete, and her voice echoed slightly, so Adora guessed it was some kind of basement or locker room.

Her eyes were covered by a cloth, blocking most of her vision. Adora had woke up in the Limbo , maybe an hour after whatever happened in the real world, which she could n't remember. Only that she has seen Catra and had gone to a party with Glimmer and Mermista. She also had a lot to drink.

Adora struggled and strained, trying to escape the tight rope cuffs at her wrists.

"I know you're out there , we don't mean any harm, let's just talk about this! Let us out!" She shouted once more before hearing a slam at the door above her.

"Shut up!" She heard a female voice say.

"Now now , let's not be aggressive . They're guest, not prisoners." She heard another woman's voice. Several steps were followed down the stairs until they reached the door.

The door to Catra and Adora's cell was opened. "Let us out, were not dangerous!" Adora tried again.

"Screaming like that won't help your case, darling. Remove the blindfold."

The cloth, blinding Adora was snatched off and revealed her to the bright imprisoned locker room they were in.

"So it is a locker room." She mumbled.

"You seem like the smart one, or should i wake your friend up and talk to him first?"

"No--! No, just take me. You want to talk, lets talk."

The woman wore a black button down shirt, dark brown, dirtied , pants and had burgandy eyes with black wavy hair. " pretty eyes. My name is Maline, yours?"

"...Adora."

"And your friend?"

"She'll tell you herself, once she wakes up, right?"

"She? My mistake then." Maline chuckled. "What an attitude. Cut her loose and bring her along for the tour."

The soldiers to Maline's side handled Adora roughly as they cut the rope binding her to the pole and pulled her up. They dragged her over to Maline then carefully watched her as they all went upstairs. "You two are guest here, no need to be on guard. Our home isn't a blad place."

"Right. The way your friends here handled me says that clearly . Just..don't touch my partner until she wakes up."

"No one will touch your little girlfriend, don't worry." Maline smirked. Adora cocked an eyebrow. "We're not dating, we're travel partners."

"Uhuh. Then I assure you no harm will come to your travel partner I do not know the name of."

"Great." Adora felt like her mother. Especially with her sarcasm.

"Welcome to Heathen. After the outbreak, me and my family found a group of others and founded Heathen. I am one of the few main leaders. I'm sure they want to see you now, once your

travel friend wakes up we'll bring her to meet them too." Maline explained.

"Outbreak? So you guys don't appear here when you go to sleep?"

Maline's eyebrow cocked in complete confusion. "No, I was born here? The hell are you on about? I'm guessing you haven't been here long. People coming from different worlds is extrememly rare. 1 in a thousand. and there's only a million here maybe." She shrugged.

"The four behind me are Margo, Sherly, Damon, and Gregory." Maline pointed behind her. The four behind her waved slightly. They wore camo soldier clothing and makeshift vests. They held roughed up assault rifles and wore paintball helmets with the visors up.

Adora hummed. Though she was responding, her mind was elsewhere, trying to remember what she was doing before she woke up. "Come on, pick up the pace, our destination is the church."

"A church?" Adora questioned.

"That's where the other leaders are. The main hall."

Catra fell on her bed, face into her pillow, blushing. She couldn't get her mind off of how she nearly fucked Adora and how Adora handled her so easily.

'God..I felt like a bitch, getting dominated like that.' Catra closed her legs tightly, bringing them close to her chest as she laid. 'Fuck.' She brought her covers up over her head, still blushing.

She fell asleep shortly.

Catra opened her eyes just to be met with darkness with the exception of a bit of light seeping through the cloth covering her eyes. Her tail wandered, feeling around. She came to the conclusion that she was tied to a pole by rope.

"Adora?" She called, hearing her voice echo slightly. Now she confirmed her suspicions about being somewhere underground. She didn't hear a response back. Atleast an hour had passed, Catra counted.

She remained counting the time before she heard footsteps and a conversation coming downstairs. She prepared herself.

"Oh, someone's awake." She heard a woman's voice.

Catra growled as she felt hands upon her, she hissed aggressively. "Where's Adora? Swear the god if one of you hurt her, I'll fucking kill you--!" She threatened.

"Woah, fiesty, how would you even do that, you're tied down."

"You don't know me."

The guards attempted to get ahold of her again but Catra kicked at them. "Don't fucking touch me--!"

"--Catra, hey--!" Adora moved the guards aside and, smacked her kicks away. She removed the cloth blocking Catra's eyesight. The two caught each other's gaze, staring, frozen. "This is why I didn't want her to talk to you first. Hothead."

Catra scoffed.

"Didn't know you care about me so much though, threatening to kill them for me? Who's getting soft now?" Adora smirked while cutting the rope binding Catra to the pole.

"You <u>aren't</u> hurt are you?"

"No, they didn't hurt me, I'm fine. Now come on, while you were dozing, I got a tour." Adora took her hands and helped her stand.

Maline stood, crossing her arms. "Woah, heterochromia? That's amazing--!" She smiled. "The names' Maline." She put her hand out to shake. Catra was a bit cautious before shaking her hand. "Catra."

"Catra and Adora, what a pair. Brains and brawn."

"Glad that you know I'm the brains and this one here is the brawn." Catra crossed her arms. Adora pointed at herself. "Me???"

"Adora doesn't seem like she's hurt a fly." Maline said.

"She plays football. Fucking jock." To this, Adora rolled her eyes.

Catra was guided out of the locker room and upstairs.

"Do you want the tour or do you just want to go to our staying quarters? We have a whole guest house." Adora mentioned, excitedly. "The home." Catra answered with a bit of uncertainty in her demeanor. She didn't like places she didn't recognize. New is bad. That's what living has taught Catra.

"I'll bring you two, you'll meet the other leaders later then." Maline nodded.

Catra was guided through the city, it was salvaged and made into a hotspot it seemed. Kind of like an apocalyptic area, one made for a zombie apocalypse. Catra scoped out the place with her sight, figuring they had only taken control of atleast three city blocks. The place was big, tall buildings, fountains, many people doing their day to day things.

"So they're all like us?" Catra asked Adora. Adora turned to her slightly. "No. They were all born here and were here before." She answered lowly. "I'll tell you more about it when we're alone."

Catra frowned. 'I don't want to be alone with you, especially after what happened hours ago.' She put her hands in her pockets and followed anyways. Adora still wore what she had on earlier. A tight white turtle neck with jeans and golden jewelry, her hair up in a pony tail. While Catra had changed when she got home, wearing a dark red shirt under a black sweater, and black cargo pants. She still had her golden ring on with her golden bracelet and golden cross necklace.

They made it to a cozy looking cabin home, to where Maline had dropped them off before stating she'd be out for some time. She then left with her guards by her side.

"I don't trust this place, Adora."

"What do you mean? They're nice."

"Nice people always have a deceiving side, princess."

Adora scoffed. "Come on Catra, let's just enjoy human company just this once." She went into their room and sat on the slightly squeaky, but bouncy bed. It had white sheets.

"Still sharing a bed? Goddd." Catra groaned before sitting as well. "Can't help it at this point." Adora shrugged. "So first things first, Outbreak."

"Outbreak?"

"Yeah, apparently they had this kind of zombie outbreak but instead of zombies, they were the gengars. Speaking of which, gengars are called Daemons, or Barbarians. I even heard some guy call them cacodemons."

"Custom username ass names." Catra rolled her eyes. "What else?"

"Well I also wanted to know if you knew anything about what happened when i fell asleep. The last thing I remember seeing

was you, since you're stalking me now and you're everywhere I go."

"Maybe it's fate." Catra smirked.

"You wish." Adora smiled. "So, what happened?"

Catra flinched before being flustered. She didn't know what to say nor did she know what to do. "Umm...I don't remember? You'll remember it soon."

"Did I do something bad?" Adora frowned.

Catra's gaze averted as she blushed. "Not exactly . Just something, not expected. Out of...lust. And that's all I'm saying." She stood up quickly, nearly falling because of her low iron and stomped off, flustered.

"Wait-- Catra! What do you mean by that??? And where are you going??"

'Anywhere but the bed, especially with you on it.' Catra thought. "I have no idea." She said, her sentence trailing off as she noticed an instrument near a fireplace.

Catra walked over to it and picked it up. It was a guitar, acoustic, light brown and all polished. She sat at the corner of a L shaped burgandy couch.

"Catraaaa come onnn, just tell me..." Adora stopped in her tracks as she spotted Catra tuning the guitar laying comfortable in her hands. She walked over and sat next to her. "You play?"

Catra perked, meeting gaze with Adora. "..Yeah..sometime ago, I'm kind of rusty if you ask me." A smile showed upon her face, a genuine one. "I used to love holding one of these bad boys, taught myself how to play it."

"Used to?"

"Yeah that was until my hands were beaten and burned bad--" Catra immediately stopped herself from finishing. She didn't need Adora knowing that. She sighed and continued tuning the guitar.

Adora watched in curiousity.

Once it was tuned, Catra began to strum it, eventually veering into a song. They way she played had Adora wondering if she had been taught by a professional. She sounded amazing.

"I guess I have to face, that in this awful place, I shouldn't show a trace of doubt." She sung, her eyes focused on her strumming. "But pulled against the grain, I feel a little pain, that I would rather do without."

"I'd rather be, free" She dragged the e a little longer before glancing at Adora. Who in turn smiled warmly. "Free, free, free. I'd rather be free."

She strummed the strings a for some time before finishing. "Free." Catra continued the instrumental while Adora sat in peace of listening. Once she finished, Adora gave a mini applause. "You taught yourself??"

"...Yeah. There was nothing else I could do."

Adora felt a weird urge to jump at Catra and pull her in for a make out session. 'The hell?' She thought.

"I actually came up with that song when I was younger. And now it's just stuck with me like glue. And I guess so have my guitar skills."

"What else do you know how to play?"

"Piano, kind of a trumpet, and viola. Cause of band, I should add, except piano."

"Understandable, I learned piano when I was younger, my dad loved it and tried teaching me but he eventually got too busy for

it."

The two conversed for some time before Adora brought Catra out and showed her around with Maline's help. They agreed to meet the other boss's for lunch which was soon.

Catra felt wary of the whole situation and place. She didn't seem to trust anyone there except Adora, no matter how friendly they were. Something didn't seem right. Didn't feel right. Catra had a significant notice of that, anytime she entered a dangerous area. Her instincts have never failed her. But since Adora seems happy and trusts the people enough, Catra supposed she should behave.

Lunch came and they all sat outside a garden at a table. It was a beautiful garden, it soothed Catra's nerves a warying for a good moment. But not long enough. They sat near Maline.

"Hello friends, my name is Noah." The middle aged man with white hair and light brown eyes smiled. "I'm in charge of the agriculture." He wore a grey shirt and baggy dirty jeans.

"I'm Dr. Darith. In charge of medicine." Another middle aged man with a doctor coat on over red scrubs. He had long burgandy curly hair with white streaks and golden eyes. "Keep this in mind kids, Peach colored eyes are evil people. Don't trust them." He ranted.

"Alright Darith, we get it." A woman this time, younger like Maline, 20 something perhaps, said. "My name is Lejandra, Jandra for short." She had long dark brown hair with light brown eyes. "I'm in charge of Armory." She wore a dark grey shirt and camo cargo pants.

"You two already know me, I'm Maline. In charge of supplies and rations." Maline greeted.

Catra stared at them all, narrowing her eyes as she saw glitches. A glitch such as their eyes changing colors, their body disfiguring. The hairs on her skin raised slightly, her tail puffing a bit as well. 'They're not safe to be around. I need to get Adora and I out of here. But she won't believe me if I were to tell her that...Fuck.'

The eyes of the boss's shifted bright white before turning back to normal.

"Im tripping tremendously." She frowned.

"This is Catra, Catra say hi." Adora turned to her. She noticed how on edge Catra seemed. "I'm not a little girl, princess, I can introduce myself." Catra glanced at her. The two stared at each other, wearing conflicted looks. Catra could tell Adora was still hung on not knowing what happened that night. Adora scoffed. "You're little enough." Catra gave a forced laugh. "I hope the clouds block your airways."

"I hope santa takes you back to the north pole."

"Says bigfoot."

"Fuck you."

"You already did." Catra slipped before clearing her throat. Adora was stunned. "What do you mean--" "--Anyways, I'm Catra. Nice to meet you." She lied. Catra's gaze landed on Adora who was actively blushing, seemingly deep in thought.

'What could she mean by that??? What am I not remembering.' Adora put her hand to her chin then grabbed her drink and put it to her lips.

They all talked, or really, Adora talked the most with the others, it wasn't until when Adora when to take another sip of her drink, she realized and remembered what happened.
Adora choked on her drink and coughed to the side. "I-I'm sorry, I'm feeling tired, you think we can continue this conversation a different day?" Adora asked. "Sure why not." Darith shrugged. "Rest up you'll need it since you two will be heliping around." Jandra said. Catra was a little skeptical to why Adora suddenly needed to leave, that was before she saw how red Adora was. "Thank you, again, for your hospitality." Adora grabbed Catra by her wrist and dragged her to their cabin.

"H-hey-- Dude, what's going on with you, I can walk myself you know?!"

Adora didn't listen, instead, as soon as they got inside the cabin and closed the door, she slammed Catra against the wall. Catra felt cornered. "You-- You could have just told me that we made out!"

Catra flinched, blushing furiously. "Dammit Adora! I was trying to forget that even happened!"

"You can't just keep a secret, you kissed me!"

"What??? You fucking kissed me!"

"No I didn't, I remember it clearly now!"

"Well obviously you're full of shit, because you're the one that topped me!" Catra retorted.

"But it was because you kissed me first!" Adora snapped.

"....Did you..Did you like it?"

Adora paused, her firm expression softening as she realized Catra was asking a genuine question. "...Maybe..but who knows, I barely remember it, right?"

Catra laughed a bit. "Right, and what would you rate it."

"A 6, max."

"A 6?? Okay that's bullshit, the way you were on me, you <u>liked</u> it. I deserve more than a 6." Catra smirked, her tail wagging in arousal. Adora blushed and averted her gaze, her eyes dilated a bit. She saw how Catra stared at her, lust filled in her eyes and her demeanor. She wanted her to make out with her again. And with all honestly, Adora was contemplating on it. She looked back at her, looking her up and down. "Fine, maybe I did. You and your stupid smirk, stop looking me like that. It's pissing me off."

"Yeah? Make me." Catra gave her a provocative look.

Adora scoffed and slammed her on the wall again before kissing her. Catra smirked while kissing her back, she locked her legs around her waist and her arms on Adora's shoulders. Her hands removed Adora's band that held up her hair in a ponytail. Catra felt herself moisten as Adora brought her to the bedroom. They stopped kissing and stared at eachother, being only a few inches away from eachother's face. "Was that a 6?"

Adora smirked. "How about you rate this?" She kissed Catra more passionately, this time with tongue. Catra's tail perked and wagged viciously. She moaned a bit while kissing her. "Fuck" Catra said breathelessly. "Is what I'm about to do to you, cause you keep pissing me off." Adora said. Catra giggled. "Maybe I should piss you off more~" Adora threw her on the bed then climbed onto her and began to slowly remove their clothes.

Adora licked her fingers which had Catra's heart beating rapidly. 'Shit, I'm fucked.' She thought as she watched Adora lowered her fingers between her thighs, she teased her going everywhere around but not in. It wasn't until she saw Adora pause that Catra realized she was about go in. Catra blushed. "H-hey, wait--" She didn't get another word out before Adora injected her fingers into her. Catra moaned, clenching onto the sheets. Adora quieted her by kissing her. Catra locked her legs around her again and held onto her face as they kissed. Adora began biting at her neck while Catra let every noise loose. Her nail clawed to Adora's back as she felt more pleasure. "Fuckkk~" She let out. "K-keep goingg..faster, please.." Adora obliged without a word, she didn't ease into going faster, she immediately went faster, which made Catra scream. Her wetness dripped onto the sheets rapidly, like a waterfall. Catra kissed Adora and began grinding into her touch, she felt like her body was on fire, as electrifying as the intercourse was. She then hugged Adora tightly as she felt like she was about to burst everywhere.

A relief washed over her body as her vagina gave in and let her wetness fall all over. The two breathed heavily, engulfed in

exhaustion. "I rate it a 0/10 fuck me harder next time." Catra joked, her voice slipping into a moan she was out of breath. Adora scoffed and started rubbing her fingers in her to which Catra closed her eyes tightly, and clenched the sheets below her, squirting more. Adora stopped, a smirked upon her face before she put her fingers near her mouth. Catra watched as Adora licked her fingers, and to be honest, she was turned on even more. She effectively made Catra feel like a bitch for the first time.

She wanted Adora to do more, but she knew she wouldn't be able to handle it. Adora laid next to her, feeling relaxed. Catra felt like she had just had the massage of a life time. "Fuck, Adora. You're really good."

"I never knew." Adora hummed. The two laid, facing each other before dozing off underneath the covers.

Suffering

"You got the mail, Melog?" Catra asked as she fixed her hoodie on. She wore a tan hoodie with tan cargo pants, black shoes, and black jewelry. Melog jumped on her bed, paper mail neatly presented in his mouth.

He plopped it down in Catra's hand once offered. Catra flipped through the mail, landing on a message from the adoption home care.

Catra's heart stopped. Her body ran cold as she read the letter, her tail went limp, aiming downwards.

They've put her under the name of the person they found to be Shadow Weaver's trusted family or friend. Meaning, she's newly adopted. Which also means, someone will be arriving at her house soon. Maybe today, maybe tomorrow, maybe this week. But they're on their way.

Catra was veered into feeling immediately anxious, she was scared. Scared for her life, scared for the life she finally got to build.

'Maybe they'll be different? No. Everyone of that whore's family and friends are evil, I have to do something. I-I can't go back.' Catra balled the paper by clenching her fist. She put it in her pocket then grabbed her headphones and went to school.

--

Catra made it shortly before Adora had arrived. Adora arrived in a white stretch limo, seemingly pissed while an older woman in the back seat as well said goodbye.

The two made eye contact and stared before averting their gaze, blushing. They both remembered last night very vividly. Catra kept

her hands in her pockets and walked up the stairs to the entrance of the school.

Lonnie had caught up to her somehow, Catra had no idea where she came from. "Hey, you alright?"

Catra frowned. "Yeah, I don't want to talk about it. Yes, I'm sure and you should get to class before you're late." She answered the questions she knew Lonnie would ask.

Lonnie frowned as well. "Nah, I'll skip with you. You have to tell me what's up."

Catra sighed. "...Fine, come on." Lonnie followed behind.

After explaining everything, the two skipped their classes and decided to have the day together. Just in case anything were to happen. During lunch, the two had eaten then went outside with Robby.

"When are you going to ask out that girl, Robby?" Lonnie crossed her arms. "She likes you." Robbie sighed. "I know." Catra stared at him. "You don't like her?"

"I do--! I do!" He was quiet for a moment. "I'll do it if you hurry up and ask Adora out."

Catra flinched. "What? The hell you'd say that for? Fuck her." A blush appeared on her face, her words awakening her memory to last night. "Well there's obviously something going on between you two." Robby scoffed.

"There's nothing." Catra lied. "Come on, ask her out before I bag her." Her tail flicked. "You got T minus the amount of seconds it takes me to get over there." She smirked before starting to walk over to Adora and her friends at the bleachers. Adora noticed Catra and slowly drifted into staring, her heart pounding in her chest.

Catra's gaze landed on Adora. She secretly winked at her, giggling a bit. Adora blushed and watched as Catra had grabbed Robbie by his ear and dragged him over. "Rebbeca~" Catra called. She winked at her. "My boy Robby wants to talk to you." Robby quickly became nervous and tried to escape Catra's grip. He failed.

Adora glanced over at Rebbeca who was also very nervous. "Oh lord." Glimmer huffed. "Go get em, Rebbeca." SeaHawk encouraged.

"Adora come with me, pleaseeeeeee or Purfuma, someonee." Rebbeca begged.

Adora shrugged. "Okay." Rebbeca grabbed her wrist and dragged her down with her. Adora and Catra watched the two converse, helping them get closer together as well. Meanwhile, The two would exchange glances. Catra smirked at her to which Adora looked down at her with a lustful gaze. Catra's smirk faltered immediately and was replaced by blush. She felt like Adora was dicking her down from where she stood.

Catra averted her gaze and tried to ignore Adora as well as her sudden wants.

Rebbeca and Robby awkwardly spoke with one another, which made the other two feel awkward as well. "Alright, I'm gonna make myself busy, see you two love birds later." Catra smirked before walking off. Adora glanced back at her. "Me too. See ya." She gave Rebbeca a grin and two thumbs up as she also walked away.

"Wait Catra." Adora called after her.

Catra's ears twitched. She turned and stopped. "What?" Adora crossed her arms. "Since you obviously wouldn't say it in the Limbo, maybe you'll say it now. What was up? I remember you fidgeting, you looked..uncertain and nervous."

Catra was quiet for a moment before chuckling. "You stare at me a lot, princess." Adora hummed. "Maybe that's because there's a

lot to look at." She flirted. Catra flinched. "Uh--" She blushed. "I was not expecting that." She cleared her throat. "Adora, I'll put this in the simpliest way ever. I don't trust that camp. We should get information then head out. They're dangerous."

"You don't know that, what are you basing this on?"

"My logic? My reasoning? My goddamn instincts? I know danger when I sense it, Carrero."

"...What would you suppose we do then, they won't let us leave just like that. Plus instincts isn't enough proof, *Michalka*." Adora scoffed.

"Say whatever you say, you'll see I'm right. I'll stay for now, nothing's keeping me from leaving you." Catra stood her ground. Adora walked up closer to her, staring down at her. "Besides the fact that I'm the only one to ever make you scream like that in bed? I think there's plenty reasons keeping you from leaving me." She said lowly.

Catra's tail flicked around in arousal, her heart beating fast and pounding in her chest. She blushed. "Is that a threat or a proposal?"

"What do you want it to be?"

"I want for you to meet me at my house and take all that anger you have for me out on me." Catra admitted

"...I'll do it in the limbo instead, *every night*." Adora smirked. Catra flinched. 'Sex with Adora every night? Will I even be able to walk?'

"You..You're an asshole, Adora." Catra blushed furiously and covered her face. "Says the jackass, I'll talk to you later. Don't want Glimmer being suspicious."

"Y-yeah, get out my face."

Adora laughed a bit then walked away.

---------- 9 = suffering

Catra got home, tired and awaiting the night ahead of her. She hadn't went to work yet and was bound to go in a few hours. She laid on her couch for a moment after taking a shower.

"I'm just gonna get drunk and sleep. Best night." She sighed then went to her kitchen and pulled out some strong alcohol.

She drank a swig of it immediately.

"Fuck life, Melog." She sat at her couch, watching tv. It was a few hours before she was comepletely drunk, passing out

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Catra suddenly woke up to a vision of red and her mouth feeling sticky, slimy, and thick. It tasted like copper and iron. She heard silence around the room.

Catra coughed something out her throat into her hands. First her vision of red vanished then her realization hit. She was bloody. In her other hand she held a heart. A slowly beating one. Catra startled back and kicked away from the scene. In her other hand that she coughed into was a white bloodstained flower.

She looked down and saw a man's bloody lifeless body. Catra stood up and clenched the flower in her hand. She looked up at her audience. Her hood down and her hair stained as well as her clothes.

Catra frantically glanced around, finding that she was in the woods and noticing the shadow from before staring at her in what looked like amusement.

'What are you...?'

"I am you, my child."

She felt disgusted with the amount of blood she was tasting. Catra wiped her mouth just to be met with more blood on her hands. 'Did I bite into him or something? Like an animal?'

"Exactly like an animal. You mauled and bit into his neck then took his heart out."

Catra stared at the daemon longer before sighing and staring at her hands. 'What does that even mean?'

"*Fuck*--! What the fuck did you do to me?! What did you make me do?!" Catra yelled at the Daemon.

"This is your life now. Wether you enjoy it or not, you are Death. Your life purpose is Death, child"

"That again doesn't make any ***fucking*** sense! I'm bloody, there's a goddamn dead guy on the floor. And I ate him!--" Catra suddenly bent over, gagging. *'I **did** eat his insides, his heart.'* She threw up on the dark green grass full of twigs. Blood dripping from her mouth.

She pulled out her phone just to see the screen smeared with blood. "What the fuck have I done." She ran her fingers through her hair. Catra put her house address and found that she was 30 minutes away..by car.

"Fuck!" She snapped. "Why am I an hour away???" She sighed and staggered her way back home through the woods.

Flowers

Catra stared ahead of her, focusing on the rhythm of the clock ticking in her room. "How much longer are you just going to stand there?" She asked the Daemon.

"I am here forever. There is no beginning nor end to my existence." It answered. Catra huffed. "Can't you be more specific. Just why the hell do you follow me everywhere? And why do you keep saying that we're one??"

"Because we are. I am Death. Together we are the...Deathly Zenith of existence. Does that answer your question?"

"No."

Death sighed in annoyance and crossed it's arms, staring out Catra's window. "Are you a Daemon? From the Limbo?"

"Limbo..? You mean the existential fabricated dream reality?"

"Are you being *sarcastic* with me?" Catra said in a accusitory tone.

"Maybe, child."

"Stop calling me that."

"What do you wish for me to call you? You're my vessel and only a child to my knowledge."

"Look- I don't know-!" Catra put her hands to her face as she laid in bed. "Why me and what does this mean?"

"You were always chosen, little one, ever since birth I've watched you grow during my rebirth. You were my only friend that also didn't know I existed." It looked at her. ***"You were bound to find out the Limbo sooner or***

later. I was a bit taken aback once I noticed how quickly you found out about it." It put its hand out as it explained. ***"What this means is, you and I are Death. Meaning you cannot decease."***

"What? I'm Death??" Catra was silent for a moment. *"What??"*

"You were meant to take the lives of others , you can communicate with the 'Daemons' and rise from the dead. Basic things for now."

Catra sat up. "W-what about Lonnie, can you explain what happened to her? Please."

Death started dully at her before speaking in it's rough voice. ***"Your friend is no longer living. Once someone dies in the 'Limbo' they die in the real world and come back as a copied lifeless husk with the same memories except the ones from the 'Limbo'."***

"Wait so, Lonnie was in the Limbo before?? But she didn't tell me...so *she's..dead*? That's not my real *Lonnie*?"

"I am sorry, little one. Your friend is gone. You may communicate with her if you find her Daemon."

"Her Daemon?"

"Precisely. The ones living in the Limbo are unaware of this world. Some atleast. So it's best not to inform them of it , it may drive them mad."

"yeah, sure." Catra sat, head drooped. Her first friend, gone. Just like that. ***"You were right to suspect the town you and your sex partner are currently in."*** It decided to switch the conversation to lighten the mood. Catra blushed. "*Don't*-- call her that!" She hesitated. ***"I'm saying it as it is, little one."***

"Aren't you like millenia year old or something? You don't get to be up in my sex life. And were you watching us!?"

"Perhaps. Nothing else to watch. I am a sin myself but I'm also a needed sin. Because without Death there isn't Life. "

"Just another way of saying you're a pervy weirdo that likes seeing girl on girl action."

"It is not my fault you two did it..or maybe it is..shut up."

"Aw, I can get used to you." Catra smirked before making herself comfy, laying down again. "So what do you mean I was right to suspect? Are they really evil?"

"They killed your friend, Lonnie."

Catra jolted up. "The ***fuck*** do you mean they did?"

"Your friend tried stealing some medicine for a baby in need and was pushed off a ledge, being fed to the Daemons."

'So that's why she was pushed off the building. Because she had died that day'

"...Fu--

"--ck!" Adora yelled in anger. She pushed away from her desk and hot tears started forming. "Why can't i get this right, *goddammit*!" She put her hands to her head and lowered her upper body onto her lap. "I can't take this. I really can't." Adora picked her head up and threw her book, frustration boiling in her blood. The book hit her door as her mother's maid entered. "Master Adora, I'd advise you calm down before you mother become angry with your sudden outburst. Please resume your studies as prompted by your mother." She picked up the book and dusted it off before placing it neatly on her desk.

"I'll be back to dust and broom your room. Please do not hit me with a book." The maid said before leaving.

Adora glared at her as she left. She began grumbling insults as she pushed her books to the side and stood up. She opened her phone and scrolled through her message list. She ended up landing on Catra.

Adora: Hey, can I crash at your place?

Catra: I'm not feeling the best and my place isn't looking too hot right now

Adora frowned. She's not tired enough to enter the Limbo.

Catra: What's wrong?

Adora: I just can't take being in this house anymore or doing this work. It's so stressful, I'm about to break down and it hurts.

Catra: Hey, it's okay, breathe

Catra: Hold on

She paused her typing for a few minutes then came back.

Catra: How about we rent a hotel room and have a mini stay-cation. I got two days and I gotta be back 11pm. We can go around and go out to eat. Maybe even go to the beach.

Adora: That's not a bad idea. Sure. Which hotel?

Catra: There's this decent hotel near Moon Sand beach, we can go there, it's more downtown

Adora: Why not, I trust you.

Catra: We can go today, I'll get a room for us, double right? Two beds or one and couch bed?

Adora: We can share a bed ;)

Catra: Cute, you think you're getting me for two days?

Adora: I don't see why not.

Catra: You're a funny one, Carrero, maybe you'll be lucky

Catra: Pack your stuff, I'll pick you up

Adora: Oh okay, pick me up at the gas station, I don't want my mom's maid seeing you.

Catra: As you wish, princess, can't let the superiors know about our affairs

Adora: Oh be quiet

Adora smiled hard, feeling smitten. She blushed a bit before emptying her backpack and packing clothes. She then left her house and went 15 minutes down the sidewalk till she reached the gas station. Adora walked into the station and got some candy and stuffed the ones she wasn't going to eat in her bag.

She sat on a curb and ate sour skittles as she waited. After a few minutes later, she spotted a black motorcycle speeding over. It stopped right in front of her spraying dust all over.

"Such an entrance dear Catra." Adora coughed and wafted the dust away as she stood up. Catra chuckled, taking off her helmet and shaking her head to shake off the sweat and heat. She wore a dark grey tanktop with black pants. Adora blushed a bit as she noticed Catra's tattoos looked a bit more noticable than before. She wore a blue hoodie with jean shorts and golden earrings. "I know, impressive, right?" Catra smirked. She winked at her. "Come on, lets waste the night away. We can eat out. Then let out all your stress tonight~" Her tail curled and wagged in arousal.

Adora blushed then smiled uncontrollably. "You're annoying, Catra. You know that?"

"I try." Catra passed her the helmet, leaning on the motorcycle. "Yeah? Well you're surely tempting me." Adora took the helmet

and put it on before getting on the motorcycle and wrapping her arms around Catra's waist. "Hold on." She said.

"What about you? You're not gonna wear a helmet?"

"Don't worry about me princess. You don't remember that time you headbutted me? I lasted almost till the end of the day. My head is hard."

"..Yeah, you are hard headed."

Catra scoffed. "Whatever, love. I've been on the motorcycle without a helmet before, alright?" Adora's heart stopped at the nickname. "Okay, if you say so." She managed to say. Catra started up the motorcycle and drove off away from the gas station.

Adora let her head rest on Catra's back. They soon got to a light, where Catra stopped. "Thanks, Catra. You know, for getting me out of there. Being home was starting to piss me off." Adora pulled closer. Catra glanced behind her. "I understand and you're welcome. We have a truce, we look out for each other, right? With Lonnie being dead, you're probably the only one I'm close to right now."

"So stop being sappy and sap the rest of my energy tonight. Or maybe I'll do it to you instead, better way to get rid of the stress." She smirked. Adora giggled a bit, blushing. "Okay dude. Whatever you say."

Catra chuckled before driving off at the green light.

The two had made it to the hotel, they went up to the third floor and happily made out with each other in their room. Once they took a break, they went to the beach first to waste off sunlight.

Once they arrived back, they took individual showers and chilled on their bed.

"Thanks, Catra, for taking me out like this. You didn't have to pay for it, you know." Adora looked over to her as she dried her hair. "Don't worry about it." Catra said, she was currently putting on a dark green hoodie with black sweatpants.

"You're putting on clothes that are going to be taken off shortly?"

"Ha. Ha. Very funny." Catra smirked before climbing into bed and laying down. Adora turned on the TV then went further back onto the bed to lay down next to Catra.

"How did we end up like this?" Adora said.

"What, the frenemies with benefits?"

Adora giggled a bit. "Yeah."

"We can thank this Limbo thing." Catra hummed.

Adora sighed. "You know...I hate you, but you fuck really good. And you're a good partner to have in the Limbo."

"Just admit you like me, Adora. You can't get enough of me." Catra put her hands behind her head.

"Just shut up and fuck me already."

Catra scoffed, her smirk remaining. "Whatever you wish, princess." She slammed Adora onto the bed by her hands.

"I'm the teasing kind, so don't be shy to beg." She warned before picking up Adora's waist and holding her close.

She then began giving her multiple hickeys while removing bits of her clothing.

-- later

Catra and Adora followed a soldier to Maline who actually had a job for them. "We need some extra hands for the job we're doing today. We're clearing the next block over and letting the building

crew put up blockers from the Daemons." Maline said, putting her hands on her hips.

"Don't worry, killing them is easy, aim for the head. Moreover, you two woke up pretty late, you need to wake up early for rations."

Adora and Catra glanced at each other, to which Catra gave her a teasing smirk, her expression hinting at their situation before they appeared in the Limbo. Adora blushed and elbowed her in her stomach. "We're fine, we're not usually hungry in the morning."

Catra held her stomach and winced, her tail twitching around. Her ears fell as she semi glared at Adora.

Adora rolled her eyes. Signaling 'You've had worse.'

"If you say so.." Maline cocked an eyebrow at their interaction but dismissed it for something about their age. "Johnson's squad is down there. Get moving."

The two nodded then walked over to the multi soldier squad getting ready. As they were walking, Catra thought. 'We're killing Daemons, meaning we're purging souls. Poor souls that unfortunately died. And another thing. These people killed Lonnie. I should have asked.'

'Indeed you should have.' *Death spoke. Catra flinched. "Holy fuck-- you have to stop doing that." She mumbled.*

'Apologies. Are a fools game.'

'Whatever dude' Catra rolled her eyes and calmed her nerves. "Huh?" Adora looked back at her. "You say something?"

"No. Nothing." Catra answered. 'I need to find out how Lonnie died. And why she did, but I can't tell Adora about you, can I, Death?'

"No. That wouldn't be the best idea. You might want to refrain from direct interactions with Daemons, because

they will not attack you. Unless their spirit is tainted in anger."

'tainted in anger...I'll find the one that killed her, and I'll kill them.'

"That's your purpose after all. Or mine atleast."

'What do you mean?'

"I am Death. We are the same, Catra. Partners, one in the same. I can take over you, we share the same body. My purpose is Death, I am excited and aroused by death. It is beautiful as it is mournful."

'...I get it.'

"You will find that you have a weird obession with flowers soon. All flowers have a meaning and you'll find that you understand their meaning. The flowers of Death, the appear when you or I kill someone. That is why when you awoke in blood, there was a white flower in your hand."

'Uhuh. Well how about you tell me who killed Lonnie.'

"I cannot. That messes with Time, the other Daemon, not tied with humans but it's own vessle."

'So "Time" is a Daemon too?'

"I suppose, I've only met him thrice in my many lifetimes, he's old, but looks young. And is green. He's also very wise."

'Is there a Life Daemon?'

"Yes. One with Life as their vessel cannot die, but can also heal and revive others. The only person that can kill the vessel of Life is..Death."

"So you two are the newbies. I hope you two have a slightest know how of what we're doing." The captain of the team said. He was middle aged with dark brown hair, beard and mustache, He looked like he was in the Limbo for a longgg time. His eyes were dark blue and dull and his lips looked like they've been a victim to alcohol addiction. His skin was pale, like a vampire.

"We know enough. Aim for the head right? And we're clearing the area." Adora answered. "Yeah. Try not to lag behind, alright? It's too early to be idiots." He said tiredly before walking towards the entrance gates. The others followed closely behind him while he held his gun sloppily. "Joe, wake up and open the damn gates!" He yelled at the gate keeper. He was a big farmer man with a plaid shirt and jeans. "Yeah yeah." Joe scoffed and pressed a button.

The large blackmetal gates opened with ease. Johnson twirled his assault rifle then pointed it at Catra. "You. Walk with me" Catra cocked an eyebrow and glanced at Adora. "Don't look at your friend, I'm talking to you. Come up here." He wagged his gun. Catra smacked the gun away from her face. 'He's trying me. What does he want?'

"To speak with you, little one. You should listen to him."

Catra took a moment before listening to Death. "You should learn some people skills. Pointing a fucking gun at me." She walked up past the other soldiers and stood next to him.

They all continued walking into the outside world.

"Catra, right? Maline told me about you and your friend back there. the way your friend was confused about this world, you two are outworlders, you're not from here." He said lowly.

"That look in your eye, and the Daemon following you, keep it a secret. Last time someone tries using their powers, they were hanged."

Catra flinched. "How...?"

"I've been in this world for a long time, kid. I'm the only one you can trust, forget your friend back there, people get scared from what they can't understand."

"I..but how do you know? Can you see it too?"

"Because I have a Daemon myself, and I have this compelled feeling to you. You have a powerful one on your side, Death maybe. If you're shaped right, you could take over this world. And yes, I can see him. He doesn't look normal."

"The names' Marklin, Mark for short, Father of Maline."

"Does your daughter know?" Death asked.

"No. You know, I guess I should call you master." He chuckled and elbowed her. "Cause you're the vessel of Death." Catra cracked a smile. "Shut up old man. Just call me by my name."

"Old? I'm only 45."

"Damn you're fucking ancient--" Catra choked into short laughter. "You little-- You think you're funny?" Marklin laughed a bit before taking out a cigarette and lighting it. "You're interesting, Catra. Can you shoot?"

"Of course I can, can you shoot?"

"Still think you're bloody funny." He snorted. "What's your favorite, assault, sniper, rifle?"

"Rifle." Catra said.

Mark hummed. "Bonnie, rifle." He put his hand up. The one named Bonnie tossed their rifle to him, to which he handed to Catra. "There show me your skill. Shoot that bird while walking. It's about to fly." He pointed at a grey bird.

"Fine." Catra clicked the rifle then aimed as she walked. The bird, just as he said, flew. Catra took a moment to line up before

shooting. "I think you missed it, buddy."

The bird suddenly fell to the ground. "Take that, buddy." Catra mocked with a smirk. Mark shook his head with a smile. "Good job. Bring your friend up here. And remember what I said."

"Yeah yeah...Adora." She called. Adora perked up from her thoughts. "Yeah?"

Catra gestured for her to come up, Adora listened and caught up with them. "What's up, missed me?" Adora cocked an eyebrow with a smirk. "You wish." Catra smiled.

"Adora, a nice name indeed. What kind of gun do you do good with?" Mark asked. Adora took a moment. "Uhhh, I've never used a gun? I'm a normal human being that has only barely touched a nerf gun."

Catra let out a laugh. "Damn, not even a video game? Fps?"

"Nope."

"It's okay, princess." Catra patted her back. Adora rolled her eyes. "Perhaps you should take a revolver instead." Mark passed her a silver revolver.

Adora took it and showed the bullets, she spun the round then whipped it back into the gun. "Hm." She hummed. Catra stared at her. "And you don't know how to use a gun."

"What?"

"You just popped out the round, spun it, then put it back in."

"I've watched movies, Hot head."

Catra laughed a bit with a taunting look. "Uhuh, says the football jock. Fucking hey mama's lesbian."

"I am not."

"Sure."

"I'm not gay."

"Last night definitely did not confirm that. Weren't you the one screaming for more?" Catra averted her eyes, mumbling, which immediately quieted Adora, who blushed.

"Woah ladies, I don't need to know about your sex life." Mark's right eyebrow twitched.

--

The many soldier plus Catra and Adora walked throughout the city. It was abandoned, stripped of all it's original vibrant color.

Suddenly Mark halted them. "Stop. Prepare yourselves. Go in your group and stay vigilant...stay safe as well." He ordered. "Kill any Daemon you see. Michalka, Carrero, Ferez, Bonnie, with me. Ferez, for once, be serious. You fuck around and find out on this assignment, you're done." Mark poked at another guy's chest. He had wavy short burgandy hair and maroon eyes with a scuffy beard. "I get it senoir, I get it." He chuckled nervously. Adora stared at him in interest before shaking her head.

"Team 1, drug shop, team 2, hotel, team 3, the gym, and my team, the mart. Once your done, switch over. You know the drill." Mark started walking towards the shopping mart, it was pretty big.

"Michalka with me, Carrero and Ferez, and then my friend Bonnie, you keep watch."

"Sir." Bonnie obeyed, standing firm near the entrance. Catra and Adora had one last glance at each other before their sight of each other was blocked by the store shelves.

"He's my favorite, Bonnie. His name is really Amir, good kid." Amir was an albino magicat, white hair and red eyes but a heart of steel because of his loyalty. "Michalka, you must know something."

Catra perked up. "What."

"I'm not sure how you'll explain this to your little girlfriend but when you have a Daemon, your body goes through changes depending on who you are and what kind of Daemon it is."

"Yeah?"

"You might experience changes like..extra strength, existential dread, orr specific gender changes. You might also experience getting taller or shorter, your limbs may become more lankier but I doubt that'll happen to you."

"Are you trying to say I'm going to turn into a man, Johnson?"

"I'm trying to say, one day you may have extreme pains for a few days and that may be because your genitals are being replaced for a male's g enitals." Catra flinched a little too hard. "What--?!"

"Hush, you're being way too loud."

"You just told me I'll be in pain because I'll have a dick."

"Well...Death is a male Daemon. And you're his vessel. This is your life for now."

Catra groaned. Mark suddenly halted her. "Daemon."

"Do we have to kill it? Isn't it a person's soul?"

"Yes if we want to live a normal life. Now prepare your rifle and shoot." The Daemon disappeared into the shelves before appearing once again. It began screeching at Adora and Perez.

"Damn Perez--!" Mark growled. Catra's heart sank. She saw how Perez had pinned Adora to a wall, it seemed he was trying to hook up with her. Adora didn't seem interested but it still made Catra's blood boil. She readied her rifle then shot the Daemon clean through the head. The bullet hit the wall near Adora's ear.

Perez stared at the dead Daemon in fear, holding onto Adora.

"I knew it was a bad idea to have him join." Mark mumbled. Catra lowered the rifle then walked over to Perez, she immdiately poked the rifle under his chin, threatening to shoot. "You fucker, are you trying to get you and Adora killed. The hell do you think you're doing?" She glared. Adora noticed her anger and put her hand on her shoulder. "Hey, it's fine."

Catra glanced at her, her expression softening but not completely. She readied her rifle again, aiming at a Daemon some feet away from Perez. She shot it in the head with a bit of remorse. Perez backed up in clear fear. Catra lowered the rifle. "Aléjate de la chica, ella es mía." (stay away from the girl, she's mine) She threatened before backing off.

"Michalka, good looking out, this way." Mark gestured in front of him to which Catra went back over. Adora blushed. 'Did she just..claim me?'

"Soo, she's not your girlfriend?" Mark hinted. "No."

"That was awfully protective of you."

"We're partners."

"Sure."

"Back on the topic of my goddamn genitals--"

"I'd rather not--"

"How bad is it going to hurt?"

Mark sighed. "Worse than your period. So i'm told."

Catra averted her gaze. "I don't have a period, I have heat. That's a painful experience in and out of itself."

"It'll be worse than heat."

"Fuck." Catra huffed.

"Give it a week or two to form."

Adora woke up early as it may have been because she fell asleep earlier in the Limbo. She wiped her eyes and sat up. The sun was rising slowly, shining at her eyes. She grunted, fixing herself on the bed before looking at the magicat laying besides her.

"How did we end up like this?" She whispered gently as she softly removed Catra's slowly growing ruffled hair from her face. Catra's soft sleeping expression grew a feeling in Adora. Something fluttered in her heart.

Adora smiled sweetly and tucked some of Catra's hair behind her ear. She then kissed her on the cheek and got off the bed. She walked to the bathroom, seeing as she was naked and relaxed. She tiptoed into the shower and turned on the water, letting is rinse her off. Minutes passed and Catra woke up, seeing that Adora had disappeared. She stretched, her tail stretching out as well. She turned on her back and sat up, noticing she had no clothes and that the shower was running.

Catra exhaled and got up from bed. She walked quietly into the bathroom and snuck into the bathtub with Adora. Adora flinched at the feeling of Catra wrapping her arms around her waist and laying her head on her back.

"Goodmorning." Adora said, feeling a bit nervous. Catra groaned in response to which Adora chuckled. "Yeah...is it too hot?"

"No." Catra mumbled as she let her fingers trail down Adora's waist. Adora blushed and took her hand swiftly. "Hey--I feel what you're doing." Catra laughed a bit before hugging her tightly. "Yeah, I know. Look at you, all flustered~" She nuzzled her neck.

Adora rolled her eyes. "Come over here so I can wash your hair"

"Yes ma'am." Catra smirked tiredly before getting in front of Adora. They faced each other, not sure what kind of relationship they have. Adora pet Catra, scratching behind her ears. Catra purred, something Adora has never heard from her. This made her blush and smile.

Adora put shampoo on Catra's head and began scratching and washing the soap into her hair. She scratched under Catra's chin which made Catra purr louder. Catra didn't feel embarrassed, instead, she began making soft biscuits at Adora's upper chest, careful not to hurt her.

The two stared at each other, lost in the other's eyes. They slowly got closer to each other till their lips touched, the two kissed passionately.

Catra wrapped and hanged her arms around Adora's neck while Adora held her close by her waist. Their hearts raced while their bodies felt like they were electrified.

"Fuck, Adora--" Catra stopped. "We can't keep doing this. You're you, I'm me, we're two people living very different lives and---"

"Hey, Catra listen to me." Adora frowned. "I know that. But it doesn't mean there isn't something here, something between us. Do you..want to make it official. It's not a shameful thing, you know." She took her hands.

Catra scoffed. "A Carrero for fucks sake fucking with a low life Michalka. Who would have guessed?"

"Catra..I like you, alright? And I don't want to see you upset like this. If you're not ready, then neither am I, I'll wait for you."

Catra flinched then averted her gaze, smiling. "You dork, finish washing my hair so we can bathe and get out of here."

Adora chuckled. "You got it."

They kissed again, feeling the lives they live fade away as they both wished to run away together.

After showering, they got dressed. Catra wore a white hoodie and black and red long shorts while Adora wore jean shorts, a white turtleneck and Catra's black denim jacket.

The jacket had different flags and charms knitted in. Catra wore a gold necklace and her black ring on her left hand. While Adora wore a gold cross necklace as well, her hair down, and a few gold bracelets.

She grabbed her reading glasses and put them in her mini bag. "Ready?"

"...You're turning me on, I hope you know that." Catra looked at her phone, checking the time. Adora blushed and moved some of her hair out of her way. "--How?" She asked, flustered.

"You look very pretty right now, nah, beautiful." Catra walked up to her, putting her phone in her pocket, then pulling Adora into a kiss. Adora kissed her back with the same amount of passion, smiling. "Well you turn me on no matter what you wear." She said quietly to her. "Oh yeah?" Catra smirked, feeling Adora kiss down to her neck. "Alright, down tiger." She paused Adora, giggling. "Come on, let's go get the hotel breakfast." She said before separating and going to the door.

"So what was all that about in the Limbo? You and that Mark guy. And how you almost shot that Perez's head off. I wonder, were you jealous?" Adora smirked, teasingly.

"...Yeah. I was. Because you're--" Catra got close to her and grabbed her by her collar. She kissed her lustfully with full tongue then separated after at least a minute, leaving Adora a blushing lustful mess, she nearly let out a moan. "--Mine." She tapped Adora on the cheek twice. "Got that?" She smirked, her tail wrapping around her leg.

Catra smoothly separated herself from Adora and opened the door. "Now come on." She smiled innocently like she hadn't passionately french kissed Adora a moment ago. Adora felt like Catra had her wrapped around her finger, or was being dragged by a red string.

And she definitely wasn't complaining. Adora wiped her mouth slightly, her heart beating rapidly.

She could barely muster a word. "Y-yeah." Adora did as Catra said and walked out before her. Catra smacked her thigh with her tail, she saw how Adora blushed harder, and let out a laugh. "I'll stop." She smiled.

Adora's heart was bursting out of chest. She took a bold step however and took Catra's hand into her own. Catra perked up but accepted it. They intertwined fingers.

The two went to the elevator and went downstairs. Once they arrived downstairs they went to the dining area. "I'll get coffee, but you're not drinking black."

"How do you know I like pure black?" Adora raised an eyebrow. Catra flinched then averted her gaze.

"I'm taking a wild guess."

"Uhuh." The blonde said in doubt. "Why can't I have black?"

"Because black coffee is bad for you. Drink black tea instead."

Adora sighed. "I'll get our breakfast then."

Catra elbowed her. "I'll be back."

They seperated. Adora noticed some guys around her age coming down the elevator and crowding the dining hall. They sat at a large dining table. Her guess was that they were here on a workout vacation or for a sport.

She averted her gaze and got food for both her and her..fling.

After eating, the two went out downtown and decided to visit the arcade first. They got coins and started with a fps first. "Come on, Adora. You can do better than that."

"Shuddup."

"You wanna practice shooting for the Limbo, here's your training." Catra joked, which received an eyeroll from the other. After that game, they played air hockey. They never knew how competitive they'd feel against another but they were. After a few hard blows, Adora won. She smiled like an idiot and laughed. "Who has the better aim now?"

"Let's play pool when we get back to the hotel and I'll show you who has better aim." Catra challenged. "Sure, why not." The blonde shrugged. Near the end of their trip, they went and watched the sunset at the beach, ice creams and fast food in hand. It was an ideal trip.

Adora glanced at Catra who's eyes glowed at the setting sun, her face looked more define and warm, her hair full of its hazelnut color. The wind blew her hair back slightly. Catra caught her staring then chuckled. Adora smiled, slightly embarrassed that she was caught but felt bold otherwise. She kissed Catra, letting her heart tell Catra what it desired.

They nearly made out on the beach before they both began being swarmed by mosquitos. They went back to the hotel, changed then went down to the pool room. It had poker in the room beside it and other card games.

The room color was off-white, the pool table right in the middle with it's green and brown, assorted colored ball goodness. There was a lightly tinted window that was between the poker room and pool room, meaning anyone could see what the two were doing.

There were already a couple of middle aged men and probably a wife playing pokers.

"You know how to play, right?" Adora asked.

"Why would I ask you to play if I didn't know how to, princess?"

"I-- shut up."

"Slow." Catra taunted. *'But I love you anyways.'*

Adora rolled her eyes. "I wasn't slow last night."

Catra smiled, uncontrollably. "You sure weren't. Round 6 tonight?" Adora perked. "Why not, let's see if you can handle me being in control this time again."

Death's Pet

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Death glanced down thoughtfully at Catra. He watched her sleep, his eyes glowing with his pupils resembling the shape of a satanic summoning circle. He touched her forehead, moving her hair back.

"Poor child. Your life will be full of Despair. However you'll turn into the ideal vessel of Death. The art of Death will be your skill." He continued staring before glancing at Melog, his pupils spiraling in place as he analyzed the tiny cat

"Zenith, I don't see the purpose of any of this..."

Adora sat soundly at her desk, her belonging organized and her notes already finished. She wasn't sure what to do now since she finished all her work. Although she was speaking with Glimmer, something was compelling her to text Catra sometime today.

"Hey, you seem distracted, you alright?" Glimmer asked.

"Yeahh, just tired.." Adora sighed.

'Make our neighbors wish they were you, scream my name.' Catra whispered lowly into her ear, trailing her nails down from Adora's neck to her waist.

Adora immediately closed her legs tightly. *'Why did I have to be reminded of last nighhtt??'* She felt wetness slowly dripping out of her, her heart pounding and racing. *'Why does she make me so--'*

"Ugh--" Adora groaned, frowning. She covered her face. *'She's supposed to be in this class, she's probably skipping.'*

Adora opened up her phone and went to her messages.

"You got Catra's number? New friends now? I thought you didn't like her." Glimmer said, suspicious. "Uh she fixed my car and we've been keeping in touch, she's not that bad?"

Glimmer stared at her, gauging her excuse. "Whatever you say. Just don't let her hurt you." She went back to taking her notes. Adora was surprised on how lenient Glimmer was with the subject.

Adora: Hey, can we meet up in the bathroom, I know you're skipping.

Catra took a moment before reading the message and smirking.

Catra: Adora G Carrero, the world's, if not the beautiful-ist, woman ever, daughter to Elise and Aaron Carrero, rummaging around with a delinquent

Catra: Skipping class is so unscholar like, princess

Adora: I finished all my work

Catra: Hmmm, fine, I'm feeling generous.

Catra: Come on, I'll wait for you ;)

Adora smiled, then raised her hand, putting her phone back in her pocket. The teacher called on her and she asked to be excused to the bathroom. Because of her reputation in the school, she was, of course, allowed to go.

Adora walked relaxed into the bathroom when suddenly she was pulled by her collar into a kiss. Adora panicked before realizing it

was just the handsome magicat from last night, Catra. Adora took her face and kissed more passionately. "This is a bit unsanitary." Adora said, seperating. "You taste like candy."

Catra revealed a lollipop in her hand. "I wonder why."

"Ha. Ha." Adora shook her head, smiling. They kissed again, Adora pinning Catra to the wall.

After having a session, the two decided to chill for a few minutes before Adora had to go back. Catra bit into her lollipop as she walked off from the bathroom.

--- lunch

"Catraa!" Lonnie called.

Catra stared at Lonnie with a conflicted expression.

'She's fake. She's not even the real Lonnie. Would that happen to me too, I die and become a hollow being.' She thought, her eyes dulling. *'Lonnie...I'm sorry.'*

"Yeah?" Catra said. "You done? Come over here!" Lonnie challenged her to a soccer game. They played, Catra tried forgetting how her friend was really gone and decided to live the moment. She desperately tried keeping back her true anger and feelings away. She, Lonnie, and Robbie went into a tackle group hug, Catra fell to the ground hard, laughing.

---- days later

1 am

A knock sounded at Catra's door. Catra walked over to the door just to be met by Robbie's parents. "Uh. Hey, what's wrong? It's pretty late."

His mom was a curly haired woman with sweet cinnamon eyes. Those bright eyes were mournful now, tired and teary. The poor

woman bursted into hot tears. "Oh my...dear Catra, Robbie is in the hospital after a car accident and he's asked for you and Lonnie. I'm so sorry for waking you."

"Nono--! it's alright, one moment, let me change, which hospital?"

"The Angel Cross Hospital."

"Alright, I'm so sorry, I'll go get Lonnie, thank you for telling me."

"You're welcome. We'll see you there." The mother frowned.

Catra nodded before closing the door and going upstairs. She rushed upstairs and put a brown hoodie with black sweats on, she rushingly pulled her shoes on with a bit of struggle and decided to tie them at Lonnie's house. Catra then snatched her phone off it's charger and grabbed her pocket wallet.

She also took her helmet and scrolled through her phone. Catra was a bit disappointed that Adora hadn't contacted her but she had more to worry about right now.

Catra spam called Lonnie before Lonnie tiredly answered. She groaned. "Whatttt? Catra it's like-"

"Lonnie, Robby got in a car crash."

'Fuck fuck fuck. That idiot, how did he get in a car accident??' She worried, grabbing her keys and going downstairs.

"What--!" Lonnie said, tiredly. Catra heard Lonnie's shuffling through the phone. "I'm coming to pick you up, try putting on some clothes, It's indecent to go naked."

"Har. Har." Lonnie got out of bed and hurriedly put clothes on. "How did he get in the car accident??"

"They didn't really specify how, I don't see why he'd be driving so late at night."

"Damn it--" Lonnie's voice still sounded tired, you could tell this was a wild shock factor for her. "I'm getting on the motorcycle now, give me 10 minutes, I'll be over."

"Alright."

They hanged up.

"Melog, you comin?"

Melog meowed. He was unusually big for a regular cat, he was a magicat, or that's what Catra presumed. The more he grew, Catra began to think he was a panther.

Melog gave a small nod and climbed his way into the backpack of the motorcycle. He was heavy but not too heavy for it.

"Make sure you stay camouflaged until we're out of the hospital."

"Meorw." He meowed.

Catra slid her helmet on before speeding out of her driveway.
--

After picking up Lonnie, they rushed up to the room Robby's parents had told them. Once they made it they hugged Robby who was laying in bed, tiredly. He hugged them back. "Hey guys, I'm surprised you showed."

"What do you mean, you idiot, you're our friend." Lonnie lightly hit him.

Moments passed and soon other people came through the door. "Hey, came as soon as possible." Rebecca came through the door. "Robby." She walked over to him and caressed his face. "Adora's downstairs, we're swapping in an hour." She frowned.

Catra perked then looked at Lonnie. "I'll go say hello then." She walked out the room, Melog following close behind even though he was camouflaged.

Catra went downstairs and found a tired Adora sitting at a chair, holding her head while dozing off, stressed. Her foot was tapping repeatedly on the ground. Catra frowned seeing as Adora most likely didn't get any sleep today.

"Hey, Adora..."

Adora stayed in her restless mood, her foot still tapping away, she hadn't heard Catra. "Adora."

Catra sighed and caresses Adora's cheek where Adora's hand was holding up her head. Adora perked away. "....Catra, hey. You called me? Right?"

"Yeah, I called for you. You alright?"

Adora leaned into her touch just a bit before sighing. "Just tired. I was already up studying, and for this to happen...Robby could have died, Catra. I mean, getting hit like that?? That would kill anyone."

"I-I know. How about you crash at my place, do your work in the morning, get some rest?"

"I can't, there's too much to do, and then I have this party coming up where I have to dress up and mingle for my mom to find a suitable partner for me. Then my grandmother is coming and my mom just loves her approval--"

"Hey." Catra put both her hands up to her cheeks and kissed her softly. "Calm down. One thing at a time. Bring your stuff over. Have you eaten anything?"

"...No, I skipped breakfast and lunch...and dinner..." Adora averted her gaze. "Adora." Catra furrowed her eyebrows. "Yeah, no. Pack your bags when you get home, I'm picking you up. I'll get you some food and I'll help you with your work."

Adora groaned. "Catra, please--"

"No."

They stared at each other, both not giving up. Adora sighed, in a defeated tone then grabbed Catra's waist, pulled her closer and kissed her. Catra stopped her after a moment. "Hey, down. This is a hospital."

Adora rolled her eyes and let go. "Thanks"

Catra smiled.

The two eventually sat on a longer couch and Adora laid in Catra's lap.

-

Catra woke up in immediate shock, all she saw was black, even though her eyes were wide open. She felt and smelt dirt. The aroma of nature. Once she realized she could move, she tried breaking free, digging her way out of her grave. As she reached the top, she was amazed by the setting. It was a Wheat field, the sun in it's arising state while she sat soullessly under a large and tall oak tree.

It's bark was dark, it's leaves were a beautiful deep and dark green, while it's smell gave a smokey but also fresh scent. The air was humid but also free. The light of the sun rising, shined on Catra's bright eyes as she stared at it.

"Beautiful is it not." *Death appeared next to her. Catra did not flinch, nor was she scared. She was mesmerized by the sun.*
"Yeah."

"This is the Limbo, isn't it?"

"Yes."

"Why am I here instead of the camp?"

"Because your conscious decided to bring you here. Remember child, you are Death...ruler of "Daemons". And of the Limbo."

"Sure." Catra ran her hands through the wheat after standing up and walking. "This is the same setting I went to when I was younger." Her tail flicked around. A black crow came towards her and perched on her arm. It screeched and spoke.

However when Catra went to pet it, it suddenly went limp and fell off her shoulder. it fell to the ground with a soft thump. Catra tried to pick it up, but a black cat had ran up to it and hissed at her.

The cat ripped up the crow, eating through it for its nutrients. And all Catra could do is watch. Moments later after the cat ran off, The crow rose, it's intestines hanging out from it's body. Catra kneeled and stared into it's eyes. "How are you still alive?"

The crow cawed a croaky caw, as it's throat was also eaten. It surprisingly spoke, tilting it's head. The crow cawed once more then flew away, it's intestines still hanging.

'The hell?' Catra grunted and stared back at the sunrise. "Is the Limbo really this beautiful and weird...Death?"

"This is your playing field, my child."
She put her finger out to catch a beautiful brown orange butterfly. However when it touched her finger, it died.

Once it died, Catra felt a pain in her chest, strong enough to make her fall back onto the ground. She grabbed her chest and hyperventilated before suddenly falling back into the dirt. As she went back , she suddenly woke up into the real world.

Catra's eyes frantically scanned the room, noticing paramedics rushing down the hall.

"Your friend. Catra."

Catra flinched then woke up the beautiful blonde laying on her. Adora startled awake. "Y-yeah?" She said tiredly.

"Robby, Adora. Robby. What if those guys are for him? We gotta check on him." Catra said quickly. Adora got up. "What? Come on then." She stretched, following behind a rushful Catra.

Catra repeatedly tapped the floor level in the elevator to which Adora grabbed her hand. "Catra, hey, calm down alright? I'm sure he's fine."

"No, Adora you don't understand. I-I I can't lose another friend."

Adora took her hand softly and held it.

"Lonnie's up there along with Robert's parents--"

"I don't care Catra, let them know that we're close, there's more important things they should be focused on."

Catra stared at her then sighed. "You're an idiot."

"your idiot." Adora corrected, gaining an exhaled laugh out of Catra. "I know."

They arrived to Robby's room shortly, just to see paramedics surrounding him. A continuous beeping noise clouded Catra's brain as the worried voices around her blurred.

'Robby.'

The two had ran further into the room, Lonnie had put her hand on Catra's shoulder.

"Is gone, little Catra. Death, as I, has taken him, you've killed him."

'*What?*' Catra said out loud, glancing at Death who stood next to Robby's slowly dying corpse. *'**YOU** killed Robby? Why the **FUCK** would you do that? What did the poor kid even do?'*

"He got too close to Death." It walked up to Catra staring down at her. Catra glanced at Robby, seeing him choke out a widely bloomed blood stained rose before the beeping suddenly flatlined. "*Robby!*" Catra and Rebecca tried to run to his side but Adora pulled Catra back, covering her own mouth. Lonnie pulled back Rebecca, trying to resist herself.

They cried in shock. "How--Robby--How could this happen?!" The mother screamed. She cried heartfully, breaking the hearts of everyone in the room.

*'Got too close to Death....*it's my fault." Catra mumbled. Adora turned to her and grabbed her shoulders. "Don't you dare say that you idiot, this wasn't your fault..he-- It was his time to go." She frowned while tears streamed down her face. Catra wiped them and touched foreheads with her. "I can't take this right now, I need fresh air." Catra pushed past Adora and made her way out of the hospital. Lonnie had called after her.

"I don't understand...is it for amusement? Why the fuck would you kill Robby?!"

"I hate repeating myself, little one."

"Don't fucking call me that!"

"I'm the only one on your side and the only one who will stay by your side, Catra. Understand that. Adora will leave you, Lonnie will die once more, your life was ruined the day you were developed in the womb!"

Catra flinched. "You know what? Fuck you, if I'm your 'vessel' aren't I supposed to be in control of these so called powers?"

"You are, that's why you killed your friend, Catra."

"No, I would never hurt Robby, you fucking killed him."

"I am you as you are me. Test your invincibility tonight, feel Death. If you grasps it enough, you will learn it's

ways."

"Now this asshole is telling me to kill myself. It just gets *fucking* better. Lonnie's dead, Robby's dead. Adora's next...isn't she." Catra began to chuckle in unbelief while sitting at a curb.

"Fucking answer me, damn it! Is Adora next?"

"No. Adora cannot be killed. Unless you kill her."

"What does that even fucking mean? Lemme guess, you won't explain."

"No."

"Go suck a dick and get out my face."

Death did as told and disappeared from Catra's view. Melog had followed her and comforted her outside. Catra began to cry hot tears. *'What is this? Am I crying? How long has it been?'*

"Fuck." She cried and held onto her hair. "Catra" Adora called. "Catra?" She ran up to her and kneeled in front of her. Catra began to hyperventilate as she cried. Adora comforted her. "Hey...come on, I'll bring you home. I'll stay over." She helped her up and brought her to her car. "We'll get your motorcycle later, alright."

Catra coughed up blood, still crying.

"Hey--! Catra, do we have to go back in there, you're coughing up blood." Adora hovered around Catra, not sure what to do. She guided her to the front seat and closed the door for her.

She then texted Rebecca and Lonnie before pulling out of the parking lot.

Chapter End Notes

Comment or kudos so I can know if you guys really like the story :)

Despair's Lineage

Adora was a bit out of the loop, Catra looked so dissociated from her surroundings. She was focused but so disoriented at the same time.

The two were on forced patrol. Even though Maline was kind, as well as her father, the others were more strict. Catra had barely even glanced Adora's way. They only spoke and joked a few times.

They observed Daemons, watching their patterns and migration in groups. Catra found it beautiful how they moved in unison.

The two were also in a squad with Margo and a guy named John. Margo was a quiet one while John was very talkative and cocky. He kept picking on Adora on her skills and all Adora could do is sigh and roll her eyes.

"Are we going to go already?" John asked.

"No, the Daemons will hear us. We can't risk it."

John scoffed in annoyance. "So we're looting the Museum?"

"Yeah...there might be water or weapons for Maline." Catra spoke for the first time in an hour. Adora glanced at her, frowning. She was hoping they could be alone for a moment but Catra seemed to be buried in her thoughts. Her eyes were dull and she seemed distant.

"Fuck." Catra readied her rifle from their spot in the lower level of a motel window. "What?" Adora asked. Catra put her hand out. "Give me your silencer." Adora perked up then took off the makeshift silencer on her gun. "Right cause she wouldn't have any use for it anyways."

"Fuck you, bitch." Adora growled.

"Fuck you too, the only thing I've seen you do since you've came here is get close to the bosses. You have no outside skills."

Catra glared as she aimed at a close Daemon nearby. John kept arguing with Adora which distracted and made Catra annoyed.

"John, could you please shut the fuck up." She looked back at him, glaring. "Stop riding Adora and focus on your own shit, alright? Do you like her or something??"

"No--!"

"Good cause she's fucking mine, now shut up." Catra growled before readying her rifle again. Adora blushed, she didn't say a thing to object, knowing that Catra had already labeled her when they had sex the 5th time.

She was glad Catra had acknowledged her, however, she still wasn't exactly talking to her. Catra shot the Daemon with precision.

"Fucking faggots." He mumbled.

Adora glared at him, ready to punch his teeth in.

"John..call me that again." Catra took Adora's revolver and emptied the round in Adora's hands. She put one in and twirled the round.

"Say it again, John. Come on, don't mumble underneath your breath. You nearly made me fuck up my shot by pissing me off." She aimed the revolver at him. Dead at his head. "Let's see if you can make me fuck up this shot." She growled.

John glared, though his heart was racing. Catra glared at him for another moment before rolling her eyes and smacking him with the revolver. She passed the revolver back to Adora then scoffed. "Fucking idiot. I wasn't really going to shoot, I'm not insane. But fuck around and find out next time, John."

John huffed. "I wasn't scared."

"Sure, bud." Catra fixed her collar and climbed through the motel window. "Margo, Adora, check the right of the motel."

"Actually..we need to talk." Adora spoke. Catra stared at her, her interest suddenly peaking. She realized she hasn't really had a conversation with Adora in a while. Nor have they done anything.. physically.

"Margo, John, right side. Adora...we'll take the left side." She said before walking out the room with Adora.

"What is it?" Catra asked.

"Are you alright?"

"Yeah..why?"

"You're distant, Catra. You don't talk to me, we haven't really..you know, and you look dull."

"I'm fine, Adora."

Adora furrowed her eyebrows and pushed Catra against the wall, she pinned her. "Prove it. I know you're not okay, Catra."

"Fuck off, Adora. I'm fine."

"Catra Elizabeth Weaver Michalka."

"Adora Gray Carrero." Catra replied with an annoyed tone. Adora scoffed and kissed her. Catra embraced it and kissed her back, clenching onto her hair. They made out in the hall, disregarding their work.

"Fuck, Adora. Don't start here.". She pushed her away. "I missed it, but not now, we have work to do."

"Sorry, I couldn't help myself."

"It's fine." Catra kissed her shortly then sighed as they began walking again. "Fine, I'm not okay. Robby died, Adora. How am I supposed to continue?"

"You still have Lonnie, don't give up."

"Do I? Lonnie's dead. A little birdie told me that if you die in the Limbo, you die in real life and are brought back as a soulless husk of your original body."

"What? So Lonnie's really dead? Does that mean..?"

"She was in the Limbo before us. And she was killed.. here. Haven killed her/."

"How would you even know it was Haven? These people are nice."

"Apparently not, Adora." Catra replied. Adora was silent. She didn't exactly know what to say. "I'm going to find out what exactly happened. And if it's true that these people killed Lonnie...Adora.." Catra clenched her fist.

She sighed and calmed herself. "Don't do anything rash, Catra. These people took us in even though they dropped a tree on us. They've fed us, we're in a decent house, and all we have to do in return in help them gather supplies."

"So what if they betray us like they did Lonnie?"

"Catra..I don't believe they'd betray anyone that hasn't betrayed them or their rules."

Catra was silent. "You saying Lonnie would go low for no reason? You think Lonnie is just some thug? Lonnie has a reason for everything!" She poked Adora's chest in anger. Adora immediately regretted what she said. "No, Catra! I didn't mean it that way!"

"Then what way did you mean it, Adora?" Catra glared. Adora could tell Catra would act impulsively if she said anything, resulting in her getting hurt. She frowned, tears formed. "Catra..."

Catra's glare had faltered, all her anger just fell for a moment, seeing at how she made Adora cry. Catra ripped her glare away from Adora and stomped off, not wanting to hurt her anymore.

"Catra-! Please, don't leave!" Adora called after her. Catra turned back at her and stood in silence. "Adora...I don't want to hurt you more, alright? Let's just do this parole and get it over with." She said.

Adora sulked, walking over.

"Princess, I'm sorry..."

Adora flinched. "What?"

"I said-- I'm sorry, alright? I'm just stressed and tired and confused--" Adora abruptly took her hand. "Catra..it's okay, we're in this together, alright? I'll find out the truth and if it checks out, we'll leave and be on the road again, okay?" She cupped her face.

Catra's mixed emotion face softened. She breathed deeply. "Alright." The two stared at each other, lost in the other's gaze.

They kissed softly, not wanting the moment to end. However, it was ceased, letting go of each other once they heard steps running towards them.

" I'm guessing you switched with team guerilla." Maline's Father lit a cigarette and walked up to the two.

"Hey, old man. Yeah, we did." Catra replied. Adora nodded and waved a bit.

"Hey." He nodded at the two of them. "I'm here to relieve you two. The bosses want a word with you." He replied to their confused faces.

"Okay?" Adora said.

"This seems a bit unprofessional to take us from a dangerous mission to preparing for a public execution." Adora mentioned. Which in fact was a plausible concern. Maline smiled. "You wouldn't be back to see it happen. This man has robbed from us and has broken far too many rules and refuses to amend. So, we punish."

"With death?" Catra asked.

"Well..yes. that's the only way we've been able to run. When people become desperate, not even starvation will stop them."

Adora and Catra glanced at each other. "That's a big punishment though, why not just send them off on their own? Kick them out?"

"Kick them out? What will that show everyone? Absolutely nothing."

"So what about innocent people." Catra said.

"Nobody is innocent in this hell. There is not a single pure soul in here." Catra didn't remember the name of this man, all she remembered was that he was in charge of the agriculture.

- later, during a Friday night

Catra stared at her hands, her vision faltering and glitching back and forth from the night she ripped that poor person apart. Her hands trembled. The taste of iron boiled up from her throat.

Catra quickly sprung up and ran to her bathtub. She threw up dark blood, falling to her knees afterwards. "*Why me.*" She muttered, her body feeling like it wasn't hers anymore, as if she weren't real. "*Why me.*" She muttered once more, her eyes becoming teary. Catra cried her heart out, choking on the blood still dripping from her mouth.

"***WHY ME!?***"

"You are of Despair's lineage. Death's lineage. You don't know your birth father do you? Yet you you have your mother's features, you have part of his essence."

"What the fuck are you even talking about right now?!" She spat out blood and glared at Death.

Death stared at her, it's pupils going as far as into her soul. ***"You will only know once you've accepted your fate."***

Catra glared more, her eyes hot and watery. "Fuck you." She hiccuped, walking back to her bed and curling underneath her covers.

"...you see me as your enemy.." Death fell to the ground, sitting down criss crossed. It shifted into a caramel skinned man with golden eyes, long black curly hair, with elf ears. It wore a black button up with black pants, it's tail laying motionless on the floor.

"But really, I'm the only one you have..brat." It said, sounding more human. Catra slowly removed the sheets off of her head and looked down at it.

"Do you know why that is?"

Catra remained silent, while Death faced opposite of her. ***"Because we are eternal, you and I. Our family lineage will forever be cursed with the power or essence of Death."***

"...our..?" She asked, nearly silent.

"Yes, our. Catra, I am your Father. Or better yet..the essence of your father passed down the generation. Before, when I was alive, my father was my pain in my side."

Catra flinched, she shot up. "Don't fucking try to manipulate me with that shit." She growled.

"I'm the one that gave you your last name." He huffed. ***"As I was saying. You need to understand what you are. And to do that, you must experience..Death."*** He said.

"Death? You want me to kill myself? Wow, how loving of you." Catra scoffed.

"You're lucky I'm not your grandfather, Daris Michalka. Or I would have said "Kill yourself, pussy. Then you'll get all your powers." That's idiotic." Death exhaled.

"What the hell kind of last name even is Michalka?"

"You could have taken your mothers. Would you have prefer Kaluth?" He gave attitude, crossing his arms.

"Fuck no."

"That's what I thought. You're more connected to my side anyways."

"..Can we start now then?" Catra asked.

"You want to kill yourself now?"

"Yes."

Death was silent for a moment. *"Hm. Okay."* He stood, dusting his clothes off, then swiped his palm in the air in front of Catra's head.

"What'd you do--" Catra felt a burn that went around her head before she blacked out immediately.

Catra gasped for air. She rose out of the dirt, raising her hands out of the ground. " I'm in the Limbo again? What the fuck did you do?" She coughed.

"I killed you. Or specifically, I sliced your head in two."

"What?!" Catra flinched. "Why am I back in the Limbo then?"

"This is a Limbo , but it is not the Limbo you are familiar with...this is your mindscape. This is where you go when you " die" . " *Death replied.* ***"However, you're not really..dead. Your body is healing itself right now."***

Catra stood up and felt her body. It felt like real life , however she felt so much power flowing throughout her body.

"You'll wake up in 30 minutes. In the meantime. I'll inform you."

"First. I'm sure you can feel some type of energy flowing throughout your body. This is because we are the god of the Limbo. Death."

"Walk with me." *He turned around and began walking. Catra followed close behind.* ***"The Limbo you're familiar with is our playground. It's there for Death's entertainment is what you fail to see. We made the Limbo."*** *Death glanced back at her. His sharp golden eyes reflecting the forever setting sun.*

"Daemons, as you call them, are souls that were killed and put to rot and feast on others in the Limbo. They evolve quickly because of the amount of souls they consume."

"There's also something I should mention. The Limbo may be your playground, but that does not mean there's nothing that can prevent it. This is where I mention our other half. Life."

"Life?"

"Yes, but let's focus on Limbo manipulation. You feel the ground beneath you, don't you?"

"Yeah." Catra replied.

"Let's take a trip to the cosmos. All you must do is disconnect yourself from the ground but not lose your

connection to the world."

Catra tilted her head. "What?"

"Detach your body from this earth, but keep your spiritual connection to it so that you may still manipulate it and you still feel the essence thriving in it..As so." *Death breathed in deeply and let it out softly. His body began to levitate above the ground.* ***"If you want to walk, use the pressure below your feet in the air. This will get you used to flying if you don't yet have a type of palisman."***

"I don't know if I can fly." She said still confused.

"...Perhaps I'm going too fast. Let's find you a sky animal then." *He came back down to the ground.* ***"In order to do these things, you must find the value in life and death to see the beauty of death."***

The two continued walking again until the land became barren, they came across vultures eating away at a dead hyena. ***"Perfect."*** *Death hummed.* ***"Your first task is to tame one of those vultures. If they fly away, you must find another vulture."***

"You're kidding."

"No. You have all the time in the world because time moves way slower here than it does on Earth."

Catra sighed then prepared herself.

Catra breathed in and out rapidly, she could barely catch her breath. "I think I lost them." She said to her father. Her father, who laid on a couch, glanced at her from his book. ***"Find a new group of them."*** *He said.*

Catra scoffed. She had been chasing the Vultures after her several failed attempts to get at least one. One of them cut her arm to which she scratched it's left eye, and that one also escaped. She had been looking for them for the past hour. "Are you seriously laying your lazy ass down right now? What kind of teaching is this?"

"It's been a while since I've read this book, I'd like to read it without my one and only offspring chewing at my ear." *He said reluctantly. Catra scoffed. "Fuck you."*

"You got this!" *He cheered boringly as she stomped off.*

Catra grumbled following her steps back to where she had last seen the vultures. She sat on the bare dirt in annoyance. Death's words flowed through her head. She was slowly adapting. As she stared at the forever setting sun, a vulture circled above her. Catra looked up and recognized it as the one she shared scars with.

Catra scoffed. "Here to add salt to the wound?...I'll call you jackass. Jack and your last name will be Ass." She smirked.

Jackass screeched letting loose of his waste that dropped on Catra's face.

Death's focus on his book shifted as he flinched, hearing a scream.

Catra frantically wiped the shit from her face and out her mouth. "You fucking bitch!" She spat before glaring deeply at it. Her eyes shone gold as she threw her hand into the air then pulled it down. The vulture froze in time then fell to the ground. "Piece of shit." Catra mumbled while walking up to it.

The vulture's eyes dilated in fear. Catra could feel the fear resonating from it. Fear of..death. She calmed herself, her glare faltering. She then sighed and sat down next to it. "Am I..a bad person?"

The vulture cawed, slowly getting back up to it's feet. It curiously poked at Catra, who just stared at it. She pet the vulture, it's eye turning half red and half gold. "Did..I do it? I connected to you?"

The vulture cawed again. This time, Catra could hear human speech from it. It had a scarce voice. ***"If you can understand me, yes."***

Catra flinched. "You fucking talk? Meaning you did purposely shit on my face, you little shit." She growled. The vulture cackled, beginning flight again. Catra scoffed and walked back over to Death.

"Hey, I connected to Jackass." Catra stuffed her hands in her pockets and kicked the couch her father was laying on. ***"Jackass? You named your arial companion, Jackass? How amusing."*** *He stood up, throwing his book.* ***"Bring him here."***

Catra tilted her head then stuck out her arm. She whistled. "Jackass~ Here boy." Jackass circled them from above, not even paying Catra a second mind. That wasn't until she saw another piece of shit darting her way from above. She jumped out the way then growled.

Death chuckled.

"Come here." *He demanded as he stuck out his arm, almost immediately, Jackass had perched on his arm.*

"That's why your name is Jackass." Catra muttered.

Death hummed. ***"Your first teaching, is bonding with Jackass, and Melog."***

"Melog?"

"Yes Melog, he's here, he's connected to you. You just have to find him, in that forest. However, with the help of Jackass. You must connect with both. Daemons and Stalkers. They'll target you until you figure out how to use

your power." *He smirked as he continued.* ***"You won't die, but you will be killed and will restart from the beginning, where you will be forced to find your familiars once more."***

Death let his arm down, Jackass moving perches to Catra's head.

Catra turned behind her where the land used to be bare, now filled with life. Large and tall trees, the leaves blocking out most light. Catra looked back at Death to which he had disappeared.

"Are you serious?" She furrowed her eyebrows, looking back at the forest. "...Fine. Bring it on."

Survival Instincts

" Fuck fuck fuck fuck!' Catra raced through the forest, her pupils had widened, she was somewhat able to see her way through the endless thick grass, vines, and trees. Behind her trailed Jackass. He flew close, the two seemingly closer than before.

Her heart ran faster than her feet, her hard breaths becoming more noticeable than before. She took a quick swerve, hiding behind a large tree. She breathed softly, trying to lessen her possibility of being caught. Jackass perched on a branch.

As she slowed her breathing, she began stopping it as well so she can hear better. 'That wasn't a Daemon..was it? It's skinnier, more viney.'

The being chasing her was know as a Stalker. It was a tall and muscular shadow being wearing an animal's skull, it's blind, it's eyes wide and big, but can hear and smell like a dog. It ran on all four viney limbs. It was also very fast, seemingly faster than a cheetah. It's eyes were lifeless white, it's pupils a light grey.

The viney parts all around it's thin body were sharp and thick, like re-enforced roots. It also made a light clicking sound, followed by a hum. It's known to be able to mimic, however it's not like a real Mimic.

Catra's thoughts traced back to an earlier time where she had stopped a Daemon from chasing her by simply demanding it to stop. She walked away far from it and didn't visit that spot again.

She figured she could try and do the same with the Stalker, but such a risky move. A stalker kills by entering it's roots through your body in opening. It numbs your motor functions in your brain however not your pain receptors, leaving you in agonizing pain without being able to move.

Catra looked up at Jackass.

'Jackass. Where is it? Give me your eyes.' She thought. Jackass stared down at her before closing it's eye.

Catra closed her eyes as well, catching her breath. Once she opened her eyes, she was given a bird's eye view it seemed. She could feel her body, but she could see the sight of Jackass.

'Holy shit...no, no time to be impressed. Where is that Damn thing?'

In the blink of an eye, Catra saw the Stalker dashing through the forest. Once Catra stopped her connection with Jackass's eyes, she saw the wide white eyes of the Stalker.

It stared and stood still, its long gaping toothy smile not moving a muscle.

Catra didn't move. She knew if she did, she would be dead. It was waiting for her to run, waiting for her to try an escape again. It was toying with her.

She could hear her own heart beat in her ears and feel the adrenaline pumping throughout her body. She felt that her soul had left her body, unable to move.

In mere seconds the Stalker lunged at her, however only being able to tear off her arm before it was pounced at.

The animal that had attacked it was a large feline, it's fur being a dark maroon. The Lion looking animal turned around. Catra immediately recognized it as Melog, but couldn't even work a word out because of the pain of her arm being torn.

She cried and freaked out.

Melog walked over to the panicking magicat then laid in her lap. He purred, the sound sending vibration through Catra's body, it

was like he was healing her. Catra looked at her missing arm, the bleeding had stopped.

"Why are you freaking out, just heal yourself already" *Jackass cawed.*

Catra cocked an eyebrow, looking up at him in confusion. She calmed down a bit and watched as her arm was healing itself. She could see her bone being rematerialized. 'So fucking weird.' She thought before petting Melog with her other hand.

"Hey buddy." She said quietly. She felt an immense wave of tire before passing out.

"You've finally awakened" Death glanced at Catra, who laid on the ground. Catra growled at him. "What kind of lesson was that?! I lost my arm!" Death closed his book. ***"It healed, didn't it?"***

"That doesn't excuse the fact that I lost it!"

Death sighed and turned around, his eyes black while his pupils gold. ***"You know what's funny about you Etherians?"***

He stared down at Catra.

"You speak so much, when you know so..so..little."

Death touched her head. ***"That's enough training in the Limbo. Let's go back to Etheria."***

--

Catra jolted awake, cold sweat dripping down her body. It was night time. She glanced at her phone, then grabbed it.

Lonnie, Adora, and others had texted her.

Lonnie: morning

Lonnie: Wya?

Lonnie: Catraaa, don't tell me you're still sleeping 😩

Catra went to Adora's messages.

Adora: Hey you still sleeping? I didn't see you in the Limbo.

Adora: You alright? I haven't heard from you all day.

The magicat sighed and put her phone down.

"We are not finished yet. I may be the essence of your father, but at the end of time, I'm still Death and you are my predecessor. You must learn what it means to die, what it means to be reborn. Capture an animal, test your abilities." He said. Catra ignored him, or tried at least.

Catra took a cold shower then put on a black hoodie with black pants. She trudged slowly out of her house and into the woods. ***"What do you expect to find out here?"***

"You've been watching me all my life right? You should know me better than I know myself." Catra responded sarcastically.

"...To kill one and take their essence you must either give them a type a trauma and feed on it..or kill it with no remorse and consume its heart. Try either one of your choosing."

Catra seemingly ignored him, but he knew she was listening. She was her father's child after all.

"How about I kill you and consume ***your*** *heart, bastard."*

Death hummed. ***"Try your hardest."***

Catra climbed a tree and stealthly crossed over tree from tree until she found a good enough prey.

She spotted a native fox, It wore a nice dark sky grey coat of fur, blending in with the darkness around it. Once it stopped in its tracks, seemingly finding itself its own prey, Catra darted from her spot and grabbed ahold of the fox.

It squirmed, making noise.

"Kill it."

Catra stared at it, so many thoughts swirling upon her mind. She unscheathed her claws and stabbed it right through its heart before pulling it out. It was a tad difficult. Catra watched as its eyes lost its life.

She smelled the heart, eventually licking it. She immediately gagged.

"Tastes really iron-y doesn't it." Death commented.

Catra sighed. Its not that shes never tried blood before, she has. She closed her eyes and consumed the heart. Once she finished somehow stomaching it down she felt like she was reborn. It was a weird feeling, a refreshing one. She sat then laid carelessly on the ground, staring at the moon. "Is that what death feels like? Isn't that bad? Why does death feel so freeing?" She said breathlessly. She grunted softly. *'What if I just..kill myself then? Instead of Death doing it. Will it feel freeing too?'*

After a good moment, Catra stood up, feeling like she was a cloud, empty. She was too much in thought to see Death anymore, she walked home and went to knock on her door. There was people at her door, but she didnt notice them, she just knocked on it.

"Now who's this? Is this Weaver's kid?" She heard mumbled. Catra opened her door then began to walk in. "How disrespectful, not even going to welcome us in." She was suddenly kicked to the floor. Her view was finally clear. A man with white hair and royal peach colored eyes, he wore a dark grey button up with black pants. "Its been a while since I've seen you little girl. Elizabeth,

wasn't it? Or you've made a new name for yourself, Catra, right?" He smirked.

"You think just because you killed my sister, I'll let your valuable little ass go? You belong to the Weavers." He stood, two other men, one tall with long dark brown hair and tired dull green eyes, another with dark black hair in a ponytail with tired yellow eyes.

Catra's heart dropped. "Who the hell are you?"

"Manners, bitch." The man kicked her in her mouth. "I'll put a goddamn muzzle on you like the good ol days." He smirked. "My name is Lazarus Nolan Weaver. The step brother of Shawna Weaver, the bitch you killed."

"I--I" Catra tried to speak, but it was like everything had her shaken. ***'No. Not again. Run. Run.'***

'RUN.'

Catra turned and began to run, she ran out her backdoor and into the woods once more. She ran like her life had depended on it.

Lazarus sighed. "Catch her, Joseph. She shouldn't be much of a problem. She gets away I'll give you time just hurry up, I've used my power too much today." He pulled out a smoke and sat on the couch, twirling a revolver in her other hand. Joseph, being the tall man with long dark brown hair and dull green eyes obliged to the demand and walked out through the backdoor.

He unsheathed a black katana hiding under his black coat, before tracking Catra down.

"What a pest, you'd think she'd stand down and take her punishment." The black haired said. He was a magicat with a fluffy dog tail. He was a mix. "Joseph's showing off as usual, where'd you say you got him again?"

"... that wild beast had blood on her hands and her mouth, either she's crazy or she's what I thought she was." Lazarus blew out

smoke. "You're not talking about your Death and Time thing are you?" Judah scoffed.

Lazarus suddenly laughed sadistically after a moment of silence. "Of course the descendant is a beast such as herself. I'll break her then finally will the betwixt and between be saved!" He laughed more. ***"Oh the heavens and the hell! Finally am I amused!"***

Judah stared at him with unease.

"Find her, Dáinn!" He stood abruptly. "You too Hazarmaveth, find her!"

Judah nodded. Lazarus had found Judah and Joseph when they were younger and named them Dáinn and Hazarmaveth, meaning Dead/Died and Dwelling of Death. The two have stuck by his side since, twisted by his cruel teachings and views of the world. The two went under different names when they reached BrightMoon, names they chose themselves.

Hazar ran through the back door, also chasing the tracks of his brother.

Catra never imagined..no she did, she did imagine she'd be back in the basement. Her arms chained up and her stomach to the wall while she was down on her knees. She was going through how she took her life for granted. She should have been more careful, should have kept her life closed instead of being out and about. She shouldn't have killed Shadow Weaver. Maybe this was her fate even in the beginning, she was just denying it. Death was silent ever since she had eaten the heart, at this point she had forgot about him.

Days had passed, the only way Catra could talk to Adora was when they met in the Limbo. She was allowed to speak to her friends, but one day she was forced to tell them a lie, that she'd only be coming to school once every two months. Somehow, the principal didn't think a thing about it.

She was only allowed to hang out a few times a month, lazarus said it was because she had ran away, that her punishment would get lighter once he trusts her enough.

Catra cried silently in the dark. Melog were left with Adora. Adora was filled in with the situation and once she knew she tried to help Catra but Catra refused. Catra just told her to get her cats and leave it at that. Adora was upset of course, but agreed.

"How's Melog?" Catra asked Adora.

Adora frowned. "Catra....he's fine.."

Catra stared below them, Daemons walking and crawling about. The two were at a high vantage point, waiting for two others to relieve them. They stared at the barren land, cars, destroyed streets and more, including nature filled below.

Jackass had flown around them. Adora was filled in about him and Melog, though confused, she didn't really judge. "Come on Catra. I can go in there with a swat team and deal with them easily. I'm a Carrero, remember? My dad can fuck them up quickly."

"Don't...They'll figure out I killed Shadow Weaver and once on is gone, another will come, that's my fate." Catra replied. Adora frowned and softly grabbed her chin. "Hey."

"hey." Catra frowned as well.

"I love you, no matter what, alright?"

"...I love you too."

The two kissed passionately, like it was the last time they'd see each other. The two had embraced each other, still kissing. It wasn't until the duo that was supposed to be relieving them came. They had looked at the two woman in slight disgust.

Catra and Adora looked at each other smiling a bit. "Fuck them." Adora scoffed and kissed her again. "Let's go." Catra smiled.

"Yeah." They held each other's hand and got off of the ledge.

The two made their way back to camp, caring for the other and helping the other, they were falling in love, and they knew it, no matter how stubborn the other was. They eventually made it and reported in. After that, they went to their cabin and cuddled.

"So...does this mean we're dating now?" Adora asked awkwardly.

Catra was silent for a moment before chuckling. "Sure Carrero. I'll be yours and you'll be mine."

Adora blushed before smiling ear to ear. She hugged the magicat tighter as the two fell asleep. Catra had fell asleep very earlier than Adora due to the fact that she was violently awakened.

Catra woke up cold and tired, blood soaked her hair from when she tried to run again a few hours ago. Dáinn had hunted her down again, beating her ruthlessly without letting giving her an ounce of support in healing once she was brought back down to the basement. She looked up to see Lazarus, dressed in dark grey pajamas. He seemed to be a lunatic.

"Goodmorning, Elizabeth. I think I've chosen the right punishment. I didn't want to do this because I didn't know whether you were or not, but now I'm completely sure of it, 94 percent!" He twirled his revolver in his hand and emptied the round. "I want you to choose which one. Say something once I stop at the right one!" He grinned sadistically while spreading the bullets evenly.

Nolan began pointing at each bullet, leaving Catra to just choose one to make it stop.

"T-that one." She struggled to say. She missed the warmth of Adora. Nolan stopped then smiled and put it in the round without looking. He flicked the round, letting it twirl around before eventually stopping.

"Russian roulette." Nolan said calmly before putting the gun to his head and pulling the trigger without a second thought.

It clicked.

He then pointed it at Catra.

So many thoughts flew through Catra's head. But the main one was, she won't die. Maybe she could put this to her advantage.

Nolan pulled the trigger.

It clicked.

He sighed. "That isn't fair!" He growled before repeatedly pulling the trigger at Catra.

It clicked. And clicked. And clicked.

BANG.

Catra's eyes lost all life. Her body went limp. She didn't even get to rethink life, her life had not flashed through her eyes, it only vanished.

Nolan sighed again. "It'd be a shame if I was incorrect...Clean up my bullets, Dáinn. If she isn't up in two days, bury her." He went upstairs, leaving the dead magicat and a dull Dáinn.

"So many lives lost. All because of you ***Θάνατος***. A direct relative, how unfortunate, why bring a child into this world if you know the pain it will endure." Dáinn said before getting down on his knees and touching a drop of Catra's blood. He licked the dark red liquid off of his finger then waited patiently.

"You have no idea what it's like. No idea what it feels to be the demise of all life. To be the slaughter of mankind from birth." Catra suddenly said. No. Not Catra.

Death, **Θάνατος**, The Lord of all demise.

"To go through life without any family or friends because those you touched would shrink to bone marrow. My mother brought me to life, she was but a weak feeble human, but my father knew his job and took pity on her. As soon as I laid my tiny little fingers on her, she lost her life."

"So what do you know?"

"Why bring a child if that is how you feel."

"I must continue the line, without it, Death will cease to exist. And if that is so, Universe will not be pleased."

Dáinn sighed. "Why must life be so upsetting."

"Do not spare my daughter because of your pity, I'll make sure to it that you are erased . And next time, you will bow in my presence."

Dáinn was quiet. He knew that the Lord of Death was finished speaking. And to that, he bowed his head, collected the bullets and went upstairs.

Catra woke up out of the dirt again.

Her landscape.

She looked around, spotting her Father sitting down on the short wheat grass. She groaned. "Not this shit again. I don't want to go back in that damned forest." Catra rose out of the grave and began walking towards him. As she took her first step, suddenly everything warped around her, and just as fast as it begun, it stopped.

"I see you're awake." *He said, flipping to the next page of the book he held.*

"..Did you do that?"

"What. You mean teleport you? If so, no. You teleported yourself. Seems your powers are growing rapidly." *He replied.*

"I teleported? How did I do that?"

"...The Limbo is your play area, imagine being in a place, and you'll be there."

"Yeah like that is anonymous at all." Catra huffed. Death put his book down and stood up. ***"Try it. Teleport--"*** *He began, before teleporting 10 feet away from her.* ***"--Here."***

Catra growled. "This is not the time for a goddamn training session. I just fucking died and you did nothing! You just let them put a bullet through my skull!"

"How many times do you think I've died from anyone else other than Life? How many times do you think I've taken my own life? If anything, the more you die, the stronger you get."

"Why do you think I care about getting stronger?"

"You will care about it. Until you're strong enough to just not care. Then you will finally treat the World as it should be treated. Nothing more than a playground full of utterless pointless toys"

Catra snarled, she took a step as if she were about to run at him and threw her fist back.

She had teleported besides him, her punch even having more force built up. Death stared at her. ***"Pointless behavior."*** *He caught her fist.* ***"The more you attach yourself to the world the more it will pain you to realize the truth. Shall I beat it into you? Or do you want to figure it out the hard way?"*** *He said.*

Catra glared at him tiredly.

"Shut up already."

Solace

Chapter Notes

This one's short

"Hi grandma Razz." Adora smiled softly as she sat on the grass next to her grandmother's grave. "I...I haven't told mom yet but guess what, I have a girlfriend now, I guess. It feels like a dream, you know? I wish you could be here to meet her." Adora glanced at the flowers she had put a week ago, they are close to death.

The blonde frowned and took the flowers, holding in gently in her hand. As she stared at it, she watched as they suddenly began to grow, it's dark dampy color turning into a beautiful green. It's petals grew back. Adora cocked an eyebrow. "..Oh..Now how did that happen?"

"Beautiful aren't they?"

Adora looked up, she saw a being that looked like an angel. Long white hair, long white robe,golden eyes. It's whole body was white. Adora jumped a bit. "Who the hell are you?"

"Life." The angel smiled sweetly. It turned into a tall woman with long white hair and beautiful golden eyes with white eyelashes and a long white dress robe. ***"Well, we are Life. You are my predecessor, or my descendant."***

"Life? Is this the Limbo playing tricks on me?"

"Limbo? You mean Death's playground? It's a shame you are forced to go there. But it is our duty to bring peace."

"Peace?"

Life sat down, the grass around her becoming greener and healthier. ***"Yes. Our duty is to bring Peace. The people living in the Limbo are victims to Death, our direct opposite...the***

only way to get rid of Death before he awakens his descendant, is if we kill the descendant. Then Death will be halted for hundreds of generations."

"If Death successfully completes his goal, there will be a human that will not fear anything , they will think of peace as Death and kill thousands. We cannot let that happen."

"Why me?"

"You're a First One, sweet Adora. You have the spirit of She-Ra , you were meant to bring peace from the beginning."

Adora hummed. "So I can save people, by learning how to become..Peace? Or Life?"

"Precisely. I will train you and show you the beauty of life. Soon you will gain the power of the mighty She-Ra to protect lives."

"Interesting...Can I bring people back alive?"

"Yes..but you must know..sometimes it's needed to just let someone go." She said before standing. Adora stared at her grandmother's grave. "Right..." She stood up as well. "What are you?"

"Life. In this world there are several beings. A god, Death, Life, Time, Nature, World, and Universe. We represent the different powers of these amalgamation of planets."

"..soo they all have powers?"

"Prepare yourself for a lengthy explanation."

Adora glanced at her then nodded. She walked over to her car and got in, Life phasing into the passenger seat.

"I don't know much of the Creator. Death was close, a fallen angel, to the powerful being before being sentenced to being Death. Death is the opposite of Life. He is a monster only finding the beauty in death. He thinks of life like its his playground."

"Life, is, well, the beauty of life, the one that cares for all living. Time is selfish, they do their job and keep the world from paradoxes however, he does find fun in messing with the time. Such as if a person were to unfortunately get hit by a car, he'd rewind time to rewatch it in amusement."

"Mother Nature is similar to Life, however she only cares for the planets and their animals, not so much for the humans...World and Universe..they exclude themselves from us, no one knows if they have any descendants. But they are very powerful. World keeps the supernatural in check, like Time. Universe, keeps the two in check. Each work in harmony."

"..So Death already has a descendant here then? Is what I'm getting."

"Indeed. Once you are more intuned with your power, perhaps we'll get to training..although..I have one more thing to add."

"Be careful who you trust in the Limbo. It's filled with sad souls haunted by the trauma Death feeds on."

"Like Haven...?"

"...Yes, like the place you've seeked refuge in. You don't seem the least bit of concerned or scared of my existence."

"I mean..I am, but what haven't I seen at this point? The Limbo, my friend dying, a universal dream, after all that, I have to expect the unexpected..right?"

"I suppose, maybe that's best. This way you'll be ready faster. I can already feel the power of Death when we enter the Limbo. His descendant is beginning to fall off the deep end. Soon once they lose care, the Limbo and all those poor lives will be doomed."

Adora hummed behind the wheel. "Can I tell friends about this?"

"Be careful who you tell. If information gets into the wrong hands, Life will not be seen to keep harmony for hundreds of generations."

"Then how does this work? I have to kill Death?"

"You can or you can make a truce, either way should bring harmony. However, Death is manipulative, and sneaky. Death is the Devil, and the devil is real..and he is not a little red guy with a horns and a tail."

Adora glanced at her once they reached a red light.

"He can be beautiful, because he's a fallen angel, and he used to be the creator's favorite."

"You should know your "Daemons"."

"My Daemons? I've only seen a regular Daemon, some animal ones and a Stalker. There's more?"

"Indeed. For example, a Mimic, it steals the body and manipulates others around them to get their food. One way to tell if they are a mimic is if they do not get chased by Daemons."

Catra looked at the human like shadow, it resembled the Daemon that chased Catra and Adora in the beginning. It wasn't able to kill her though, she wonders where it went.

She sighed. "Then what's that?" Catra pointed at the strange looking shadow that stood tamely. It wore a animal skull as a face, roots coming out of different parts of it's body, it's claws were long and sharp, it's body was thin and skeletal. It looked way different than a Stalker, though they both wore a skull and were viney.

"That is a Reaper. Possibly a best friend when it comes to Death, it is very obedient only to you, unlike the other Daemons ."

Catra stared at it. "Oh yeah?"

"Let us find a survivor camp. We will watch and observe it."

"Are you going to kill the people inside?"

"No. Not now, it's too early. You will just observe it and tell me what you think of them."

"What am I, your journalist?"

"Hey, you're finally getting the hang of this." He said sarcastically.

Catra scoffed. "Whatever."

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Life had brought Adora to a park, then to different parts of Etheria, showing life flourishing.

"Do you see how everyone cares for each other, Adora? Even those in the "FrightZone"."

"...Yeah. The beauty of love and care." She mumbled, her thoughts going back to Catra.

Mangled Hearts

Muffled.

They all were.

Their screams.

Their cheers.

Their angered yells.

All were muffled.

Catra breathed heavily and slowly. She thought she'd pass out. Her heart was racing but it felt like time had slowed. The man that stood before her was barely able to move a muscle.

He was too beaten. His blood all over Catra's fist. Catra stumbled, nearly falling to the ground before catching herself.

'N..no. I can't..I can't pass out here.' She thought, slowly trudging her way, step by step towards her opponent.

Her opponent fell to the ground, scared for his life. Catra still trudged her way towards him like an undeterred predator.

Once she made it over to him, she stabbed her claws through his chest and pulled out his heart.

Blood spilled all over the dirt ground and trailed down Catra's arm as she raised it in the air.

The crowd was finally quiet. They were finally shut. Nobody spoke, nobody applauded, they just stared in fear.

Catra kept it in the air for a good moment before taking a bite into the heart. As she ate it, she felt like all her energy was coming

back. Her body was injured but she felt completely fine. As if she could go another round.

"Bastards.." She mumbled.

"...*Bastards*!" She yelled and threw the heart into the crowd above her. ***"All of you!"***

Catra spat blood at the floor then left the sandbox floor. She had been unwillingly doing these fight rings for a few weeks now. When she lost, she was beaten. When she won, she was left in the basement without bother.

The other opponents in the locker room stared at her bloody body. They were afraid of her.

Catra was afraid of herself as well.

"Poor child. It wasn't his fault he was fighting in the ring..yet you killed him."

"Who fucking cares." Catra said. *"Isn't this what you wanted? Me to be a heartless killer?"*

Death was silent for a moment. ***"Not exactly."***

*"**...**Everyone is full of shit."* She replied. *"Including you."*

Death stared as she walked off, feeling conflicted.

Catra went home with Lazarus and was left alone in the basement, only her wrist being locked up. She was left with books and board games. Dáinn played with her before late night came and he saw that she was still not asleep.

"Do you want outside time." He asked.

Catra stared at him, her eyes tired and dull. So is his.

"Yeah." She mumbled.

Dáinn stood up and took an metal pen out his pocket, one that was a electrifying tazer in disguise. It was connected to her collar. If she were getting out of hand they'd set it off and she'd be shocked with thousands of electricity.

Catra stood once her chains were taken off of her and was given a hoodie.

"Lazarus says if you behave enough, he'll let you have your room and that office of yours. He took a liking to it."

The magicat didn't seem to have an ounce of care. She just followed Dáinn as he went upstairs. She trudged her way outside, followed by Dáinn. He had followed her to a park.

Catra had climbed to the highest peak on the playground and sat, staring at the stars.

"Mister Dáinn."

Dáinn glanced up at her from his seat at a bench.

"Why are you kinder to me than the others?" Catra looked down at him. Dáinn was quiet for a moment before speaking. "My nature isn't violent. But my life is. I was forced into a life of violence even though my nature was never to be violent. Take that as you will."

Catra grunted as she looked back at the sky. *'What a joke.'*

"...Make sure you come back, I don't want to have to come get you." Dáinn said. He could tell that Catra was interested in testing if she could jump high enough into the sky. Catra heeded his warning and put all her force into jumping from her spot on the playground.

She flew into the sky, feeling all the cold wind fly behind her. As she felt herself about to fall, she focused on keeping herself afloat like Death had taught her...it worked. Catra laid far into the sky,

staring at the bright moon. It was freezing, but refreshing. Like a glass of ice cold water.

"Lonnie would never believe me if I told her....the air is so thin up here." Catra exhaled softly. *"I want to see you..Adora. I want you to kiss me and tell me everything will be alright.."* She mumbled.

"Give me a lie to believe in, something..anything." Catra raised her hand above her.

"A happy life will be the future." Death chimed in. Catra let her gaze lie on him. *"Look who's finally come out of hiding."*

"I was never hiding. Just observing."

"Like a damned coward." Catra scoffed. *"I'm going to the Limbo.*" She said. *"I need to see someone."*

Catra let go of her hold on the air and began falling from the sky at an alarming rate. ***"You and that human girl. What could she possibly mean to you? One day she'll die like the rest of those close to you."***

"...What could my mother had possibly mean to you?"

Death quieted. ***"She was my everything..and that ended up getting her killed. I'm trying to keep you from repeating generations of mistakes."***

"I'm sure your father did too, look where it's gotten you." Catra argued. Again, Death was silenced.

Before Catra reached the ground, she grabbed ahold of her weight in the air and began afloat again, softly landing onto the mulch.

"We can go back now..I'm tired." She told Dáinn. Dáinn nodded and stood from his spot. The two went back to the house and Catra was left back into the basement.

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"Catra--! You're up!" Adora jumped onto the bed and hugged her tightly. Catra hugged her back tiredly before pushing her off. "Did you just come back from patrol? And you came on the bed with your dirty clothes?" She scolded her a bit.

Adora got off the bed and scratched her head, flustered. "My bad. It's just been a while since I've seen you. I've been missing you all day. When are you coming to school this month?"

"..I'll probably be allowed in a week or two."

Adora frowned and began to take off her patrol clothes and change into something more comfortable. "I still don't like this."

"...I know you don't. Me neither."

"I hate--" Adora got back onto the bed, sitting next to Catra. "--that you're being treated that way."

"I hate seeing you so defeated and hurt. I hate seeing you like this, Catra. I wish I could do more to help."

"You're doing more than enough. I'm glad that you're staying with me through this...I love that you care for me and you want to help me." Catra began.

"Adora..at this point, you're the only one I'm living for. My freedom was never real, Lonnie's already dead , you 're all I have."

Adora perked then blushed. "I love you too, Catra." She smiled softly. Catra let her head rest in her lap.

"Hey..Maline wanted us to go and supervise a trip. These four are going to clear the streets a continent away. It's so they can expand Heathen. And their outpost."

" Next state over? ?" Catra stared up at Adora.

"Yeah. Apparently they had sent some officers down there and they were kidnapped by a neighboring survivor camp. Call themselves the Desmondos Heathen." Adora answered.

"Sounds boring as hell."

The blonde chuckled. "Hey but we get to meet new people, maybe we can fire up some type of truce."

"I'll go..but for you, not Heathen."

"Good enough for me, I was hoping you'd join me." She smiled.

"When do we depart?" Catra asked. "5 weeks, we spend these 5 weeks scouting for more supplies and really understanding our route." Adora replied.

Catra grunted. "If they so much as touch a hair on your head, I'll kill all of them, you won't be able to change my mind."

Adora hummed. "Then I'll try not to get touched." She smiled still.

A knock sounded at their front door. Catra went to open the door and was met by Markline, Maline's Father.

"Ah, look who's awake. You look more tired than I am. May I come in?"

Catra backed away from the door and let Mark in. He walking in and sat at the kitchen table. "I need to talk to you two..separately and privately." He said.

Catra stared at him before sighing. "Guess I should make some tea then?"

"I prefer black if you were supplied any."

"It seems like you prefer black in both drinks." Catra replied.

"Who was at the door?" Adora came out the room before flinching. "Oh, Mark. What brings you here?" She sat at a chair

and glanced over at Catra. " Don't tell me it's for tea?"

"Unfortunately..no. I need to talk to you two. Privately..and separately. I would appreciate if you were to not discuss what I tell you to the other. " He answered. "I need to talk to you first, Catra. After you're done, would you care for a game of chess?"

"I guess I don't see why not." Catra heated up some water.

Adora hummed. "Then I'll go out, When should I come back?"

"An hour, don't worry, I won't keep you two from each other. You can be lovey dovey later." He smirked.

Adora rolled her eyes, smiling. "Whatever." She got up and walked over to Catra before kissing her on the cheek. " Don't burn down the house."

Catra blushed a bit and scoffed, smirking. "I won't."

Adora left the house, leaving Mark and Catra to speak.

"You're stronger than before but you look tired as hell." Mark said.

Catra cocked an eyebrow, shoving her hands in her pockets.

"Your hand are stained in blood but washed. Your throat is tainted in blood. I see you're finally becoming the demon Death wants you to."

"... I've been through a lot since I first dropped into this world. But there is something I want to know."

Mark glanced up at her.

"Which Daemon are you?"

*".. I'm simply an observer. **World**. I make sure things go as they are supposed to. Because i f fate does not go as supposed, a*

paradox happens and universe will wipe us all. I know your future, your ending, but I am restricted in telling you so."

"Is that so." Catra glared before shaking her anger off. "I understand.

"You have a landscape don't you, you're own little playground?" Catra asked.

Mark nodded. "Space. A beautiful planet full of greenery that when you look up you can see the millions of planets whether close or far. They're the stars in the sky."

He was quiet for a moment.

"..Don't get attached to normal people, Catra. It hinders your judgement and leaves you hurt. I disregarded my attachment to my daughter. While still, yes, she's my daughter, I love her. But if something happens to her I will not be upset to the point where my judgement will be clouded."

"You sound like my dad." Catra mumbled.

"Listen." She slammed her hands onto the table and stood up. "I don't care how much you two try and keep me from having some kind of humanity. I will leave Heathen and the entire Limbo in shambles, if you so much as touch her." Catra growled before exhaling and calming down. "You can show yourself out."

"...It's not me you have to worry about. I'm the one rooting for you..Catra. Break the paradox. Usually Death's future is either they'll be insane or they'll be curious. The interesting thing about this timeline is that you'll...be both." Mark stood, smirking. "You're gonna be a fun one, Michalka. Oh and, take a guess who Life is." He began to walk to the door, Catra cocking an eyebrow, before Adora had opened it.

"Oh-- You guys already done?"

Catra and Mark met glances before looking back at her. "Yes." Mark chuckled. "She has such a hot temper. I think it'll be more calming talking to you, Adora."

Catra scoffed. "You're the one that ticked my buttons, asshole."

Adora smiled before walking in. She went over to Catra, who had turned around to put the glasses in the sink. She wrapped her hands around Catra's waist and hugged her. "Yeah, why do you think I call her hot head?"

"Maybe because I'm hot?" Catra smirked.

Adora chuckled. "You are, but maybe that's why you have such a hot head." She kissed her on the cheek then let go. "A hottie with a temper."

Catra scoffed once more as she washed the cups. "Alright." As soon as she finished and wiped her hands, Catra nodded at Mark. "I'm going to find a tree to nap in, I can feel myself about to pass out."

"Be careful." Adora said, Catra walking towards the door. "When am I not?" She left. "I can name thousands of times." Adora mumbled.

Mark hummed. "Take a seat, Life." He sat at his same seat. Adora flinched but sat. "Life..you know about her?"

"I'm sitting across from her aren't I? Life herself, It's nice to see the generations of First Ones." Mark hummed. "I'm sure Life told you about me, she doesn't like to waste time."

"She told me about the several types of..Daemons? What are you?"

"You got it right, we're Daemon gods. Demi-gods. I'm World. I can see the future and the past. So can Time and Universe. You can tell if you're in the room with another Demi-God. The essence, the aura in the room tells everything. "

Mark sighed. "Adora..you being Life, you have a lot of potential. You bring peace and tranquility to the Limbo and Earth. And it's a great thing you have such a kind character. It's your First One genes."

"Lazarus Nolan is currently Time, I'm World, I cannot tell you the identity of Universe, not yet anyways, Death...take a guess."

"A guess?" Adora cocked an eyebrow.

"Yes. You and Death are the only two keeping me entertained for the future. I already know how it plays out, but it's like watching a movie you were already spoiled of before you watched it. But it's still interesting." He smirked. "Every moment, the future changes. Because human beings can be unpredictable sometimes, especially Demigods. Seeing how you two grow is making me excited." He suddenly laughed. "Find the sword of She-Ra, Adora. They'll kill a loved one and that's when the war will start, you should hurry and train before then. Death is already getting ahead of you."

Mark stood. "I will take my leave now. Marinate on what I've told you. What comes out my mouth always has a deeper meaning...and is important. Especially when I'm serious." He left.

"World is right. You're lucky he told you anything Adora. It seems he's taken liking to this generation."

Adora flinched and turned behind her. "Oh..Life. Where were you all this time?"

"I am always here."

"War..this sword of She-ra thing, will you take me to it?"

"I cannot, the sword is drawn to you as you are to it. You will have to find it during your journeys. It will tug at your heart once it deems you are blood related enough to wield it."

Adora grunted. "Did you have a life..Life?"

Life was quiet for a moment before it spoke. ***"I was your mother..Adora."*** *Adora froze and stared in a bit of anger, her eyebrows furrowing. "What?"*

"Catra!"

Catra slowly opened her eyes, glancing at the direction of the stairs. There was barely any light in the basement, however Catra's night sight makes it easier to see.

"I know you're up! Get up here and get the front door!" Lazarus yelled from the bathroom. Catra rolled her eyes and stood up.

It had been a while since Catra had the chains linked to her wrist. Though she was still forced to sleep in the basement. Lazarus trusted her enough to be free, only in the basement.

Catra wore a dark maroon hoodie and black baggy pants with no shoes. She walked upstairs went to the front door. She opened the door and was met by a sprinter. Someone that delivers food.

"Uh..order for Nolan?"

Catra cocked an eyebrow. "From where?"

"China Monastery?" He said. Catra scoffed. "Chinese, you fucking kidding me?" She mumbled before grabbing the food. "Yeah, Nolan's here."

The sprinter tilted their head a bit before taking a picture of the food then left.

"Who was it." Lazarus came out the bathroom.

"Food." Catra put the food down on the counter and went back downstairs. Lazarus watched as she left then looked through the

bag.

Moments passed before Catra heard the basement door opened.

" your food." Hazar said, putting her food down. "Eat up. You got a match today, *Death*." He smirked.

Catra waited till he was upstairs before speaking. ***"Childish."***

She ate the Chinese food silently, After finishing, she sighed and stared at the ceiling.

"You seem conflicted."

"How much longer." Catra spoke.

"Life is awakened. You must find the sword of peace before she does." Death ignored her question.

"Why." Catra stared at him.

"So taking over can be much easier. The sword of peace will hinder our goals."

"Your goals...why take an advantage of a player when it's meant for them. It may be unfair, but if you can't beat them even with the advantage, you're only trash." Catra told him.

"Life and Death are <u>not</u> a game." He growled.

Catra growled as well. "Yeah, it's a ***joke***. You're just a asshole that wants to make the game unfair. If you really want to have fun, you have to have fair grounds. Then maybe slip some tricks in."

"You, *Death*, don't know how to enjoy your life in living and dying. *Bastard*."

Death glared before calming down. ***"...let's get you started on your next batch of training. Using me as your double wielded sword."***

Catra gave him a confused look.

"***You can use my Daemon spirit as an extended body of your own."*** He briefed. ***"Join me in the Limbo."***

"I just came from there dammit." She groaned.

"Time...he waits for no one."

Catra sighed and frowned. She put a finger gun up to her head.

"Bang."

Catra woke up, sighing. "...Is the descendant of Life, Adora?"

Death was quiet for a moment. ***"Do not let outside--"***

"Just answer the damn question." Catra demanded, dusting dirt off her clothes as she stood out of her grave. Death hadn't answered her. "So I'm guessing yes. ***Awesome****."*

"I want to know more about Life. Tell me some history. Anything. I can't speak if I know nothing, right?"

Death exhaled. ***"I'll inform you as we train your abilities, Catra."***

"How demanding. Do you know who I am?"

"A dead bastard that happens to be the spirit of my father." Catra answered.

Death scoffed and warped to a vast land with short grass. Catra warped with him, taking a step forward.

"You've mentioned a sword of light before. Where is it. And is there a sword or dark or some shit?"

"It's in the Limbo, you can find it once you feel the power of Life surrounding the Limbo. That means Life had found the sword."

"Dark sword..I suppose there is, besides the Life sword, if you've formed enough a connection, you can shape it however you want." *Death said, turning into his human form.* ***"What would you shape your sword into?"***

"Whatever fits my mood." Catra shrugged.

Death crossed his arms. ***"In order to find it, you must venture on your own and find the ring of devastation. You have a connection, so once it gets stronger, you'll find it."*** *He pointed at her heart.*

"It's powered by the power of Death and First One's blood."

"Now, let's not get off topic of training. Focus--"

--

"--on the core of the animal. The heart, feel the course of its veins and bones and muscle." *Life said softly.*

Adora had been sitting with Life in front of a dead elk. Life had her meditate and suddenly she was in a temple, a very advanced one. They had walked into a forest and found a killed elk. It looked sad, its body limp. Adora frowned. "How did it die?"

"Every being has a beginning and an ending, that is life and death. Without it, the universe would cease to be balanced." *Life answered.* ***"That is why one needs the other."***

*She was in her beautiful human form. After letting out a thoughtful exhale, she spoke again.****"Heal it."***

Adora stared at her confused. ***"As I was saying before, connection your core to its core and bring it back to***

life." *Life commented.*

"Bring it back to life..? Okay..I can try." She touched the elk, feeling its coarse but soft rotting fur. 'It died a few days ago.' Adora noted. She could feel the faint feeling of its veins flowing through every ounce of its body. She grunted, furrowing her eyebrows. It was putting a strain on her.

The elk had claw marks and bite injuries, that were slowly healing. Life watched as Adora was learning. She also put her hand upon the elk and suddenly Adora could feel its heart beating. She let go of the elk, shocked. Sweat beaded upon her face. She glanced at Life, watching as she brought the elk back to life.

"Holy shit." She said breathlessly. "I didn't think it'd be so hard. Or that it was possible."

The two watched at the elk slowly stood up, it ran before looking back at them. It stared at Adora for a good moment before skipping off. "Aw."

"Perhaps that was too big of an assignment." *Life smiled. Adora chuckled nervously. "I tried."*

"You did good. Try getting plants, mistreated goldfish perhaps."

"Plants...Catra has plants. But I can't go over there."

"Catra...she is your..is the right word spouse?"

Adora flinched and blushed. "No--! We're not married."

"But you seem to like her very much. I believe her situation is heartbreaking?"

"She's being abused again by a parental figure. Being forced into fights and what not. I hate that she has to go through that."

*"**Trauma such as that could give Death all the power he needs."** Life frowned. **"I see now. This is a upsetting story indeed. Its interesting that World isn't stopping anything."** She mumbled.*

'Perhaps Universe and the creator also find interest in this situation…I do as well. Never in 100 years has this occurred. Sure they were in love, but they ended up killing each other anyways.'** Life glanced at Adora. **'Maybe their story will be different.'

"What was that?" Adora asked.

Life perked. "Nothing, child." She smiled softly.

Trauma Filled Strings

"Catra?"

"Catraa." a 6 year old Lonnie called. Catra trudged through the snow, covered in bruises and blood and dried tears. She perked once she heard her new friend calling for her in the woods. Catra had told Lonnie that she liked to go into these woods but she didn't expect for Lonnie to be looking for her in them.

She made her way to Lonnie and tiredly tapped on her shoulder. "Lonnie, what are you doing here?" Lonnie jumped, she looked at Catra, who only wore a white shirt and black shorts, no shoes. She had cuts all over her legs and arms and back, blood on her shirt, and a new long cut on her jaw.

Lonnie was dressed in a big orange and black jacket and big black pants with boots to keep her warm. She also had gloves and a beanie on. "Catra! I was looking for you!" She grinned before looking at her confused. "Aren't you cold?"

"..A little." Catra shrugged, her long and wild hazelnut hair shuffling. Lonnie took off her beanie and jacket and put it on Catra then smiled. "Here you go. Now tell me what happened, you're all bloody!" She frowned.

Catra was quiet, she didn't want to say a thing. But she wanted it to be off her chest. The two walked over to Catra's favorite tree and sat at it on the snow. Lonnie opened a bowl full of hot cookies that she brought over. "I had my mom cook these for you, you like chocolate chip, right?"

Catra nodded. "...Shadow Weaver was angry, angrier than before..she hit me on my face this time and it burns.." Lonnie frowned. "I'm so tired...She hit my legs, my back, saying something about hating me, and that I ruined her life." Catra bit into a cookie before sighing. "So..so..tired."

Lonnie watched as Catra passed out. She flinched. "Catra--! Uh oh..." She strugglingly picked her up and the cookies and made her way back home to the warmth.

----- Present

"You think you're all special because Lazarus has taken a liking to you?" Hazar kicked Catra. "Pathetic! You disappointed all of us during that match. It's purely agonizing to see you live, you roach." He growled. He grabbed the whip off of a hanger and slashed it across her. The whip reached her face, fortunately only reaching her eyebrow.

It slit, blood dripping from the wound. Catra stared at the ground, seemingly lifeless, her eyes were dull.

Blood slid into her eyes, however she didn't seem to care. This was the 14th time Hazar had taken his anger out on her. Other times it was Lazarus killing her, or breaking her arm.

Hazar used his foot to keep her head down while he whipped against her back. "Piece of shit." He kicked her in her stomach.

He scoffed then grabbed her hair and slammed her head on the floor several times.

Once he got his fill, he left, leaving Catra to choke on her blood. Catra coughed and spat out her blood. She breathed in and out then sighed.

Weeks had passed, Catra's hair grew longer, she was starved for a few days and hadn't gotten enough sleep.

Soon Dainn had came downstairs. To which Catra had stood up. "I wish to go outside." She managed to say. Dainn had stared at her.

"Be back before midnight, Lazarus is coming back from his trip by then. Don't do anything stupid. Or he may do something worse than breaking your limbs." He took off the chains holding Catra back.

Catra went upstairs to her room and took a shower before changing into a dark red hoodie and black pants. She thought of Adora as she left the house.

--

Adora closed her computer. "I'm tired of all this goddamn work." She sighed, putting her hands to her face. She was so close to breaking down.

It wasn't until she got a knock at her door.

"Master Adora, Master Jean is here with Sir Kervens." The maid said, opening the door.

"Let them in, I guess." Adora replied.

"As you wish. Remember that you must finish those books and their reports by midnight before your mother arrives."

Adora glared at her desk, clenching her fist. "..yeah."

The maid left, closing her door. Adora wore a white tank top with black baggy shorts. She pushed away from her desk and grabbed her phone. She went over to her door to open it before the door slammed into her face.

"Adora!" Jean opened the door before her. Adora held her nose, groaning. "Fuck--! Jeann!" Jean flinched. "Shit! Adora, are you alright?"

Adora huffed. "Yeah..what's up?"

Kervens also came through the door. "Jean, what did you do?"

Jean scratched behind her neck. "Uhmm..."

"He slammed the door on my face. What brings you two here?" Adora shook her head.

"We were going to invite you to come with us to the mall outlet." Kervens glanced at Jean.

"Oh, sure, I'll come. I need new shoes anyways. And I need to get away from here." She shrugged. "I'll get ready."

"Alright." Jean gave her a thumbs up. Kervens left the room.

Jean closed the door and sat on her bed. "What's on your mind? Is it your school work? That girl you told me about?"

Adora went into her walk in closet. "..now that you mention it, I really do miss her." She sighed, putting a white shirt and thinking about putting on different pants. "You haven't talked to her?"

Adora opened her mouth to speak before frowning. "Her situation is kind of..complicated."

"She isn't playing you is she?"

"No." Adora came out with her favorite white turtleneck with Catra's denim jacket and black pants. "Come on. I don't want to think about her right now or I'll be upset the whole day."

Jean glanced at her in confusion. "Okay?"

- At the outdoor mall

Adora walked behind Jean, Kerverns next to her. The two were window shopping while Jean had them carry bags.

"Adora. There is something off about this place. Something is here." Life warned her. Adora glanced at her and cocked an eyebrow. "Keep a lookout. a Demi-god may be present."

Adora took it into consideration that maybe Mark was in town, but she would never know. Maybe Nolan. Or Death, or even Universe. Adora became quickly nervous. Just a bit.

"Come on you two, you're slowing behind!" Jean grinned. Kervens shook his head and smiled.

Adora huffed. "I wanna go to the shoe stores."

"You want us to come with you?" Jean asked. Kervens also looked at her.

"Uhh...No I'm okay. I'll take your bags with me." Adora said.

Jean cocked an eyebrow. "You sure?"

"Yeah, I can grab them." Kervens suggested.

"Are *you* sure?" Adora asked him.

"Yeah of course." Jean replied, softly.

Adora contemplated before going ahead and leaving the bags with Jean. She went off to a shoe store, looking through the aisles.

After finding a couple of shoes she wanted, she paid then looked around the place. She saw a tattoo shop and was curious.

Adora went into the tattoo shop and looked at the different tattoos and their prices. She also looked at the people getting their tattoos done.

She saw someone, someone recognizable. They had short, but long-ish hazelnut hair, scars all over their back and arms, they were also a magicat.

Adora didn't want to believe it, she hoped, but she didn't want to be wrong. The person was getting white roses that were stained with maroon and black connected to the scars and lashes on their left arm. The person that was getting the tattoo was finished after seconds and stood up. They had a black tank top on with their hoodie in their hand.

As they walk to the counter, Adors backed up and put her hand out.

"C-Catra..?" She called.

Catra glanced at her. Teal and gold meeting sky blue. Tears were forming as Adora stared at her. Catra handed the cashier cash then fell into a hug with Adora. The two hugged tightly, not intending on letting go.

Catra felt so nice to be in her arms. They took their business outside and sat together near a tree in the park nearby.

They held eachother again. "Damn it Catra, I missed you. What are you doing out here?" Adora tried to control her breathing and tears. "I..I was allowed to be out until midnight today. Though I'll get in trouble if caught." Catra said. She was cut off from saying another word because Adora kissed her. Catra kissed her back, the two kissing passionately.

Catra put her hand to Adora's cheek and gently pushed back her hair. "...I missed you too, princess."

Adora smiled and laughed a bit. "You got a new tattoo, how does it feel?" Catra smiled as well. "Hurts like shit but I've had worse."

Adora frowned. "I hate that I can't help, Catra." Catra shook her head and chuckled a bit. "Adora, it's fine. I'll live."

"But you shouldn't have to live like that."

"...you know, I love how caring you are. You care so much, why are you so kind to me?" Catra asked. Adora perked. "I love you, Catra Elizabeth Weaver Michalka. That's why."

Catra scoffed. "Not a good enough reason." She smirked.

Adora huffed. "Are you hungry, when's the last time you ate?"

"If I tell you, you'll get upset."

"Just tell me."

"...I think like...the last time I had a full meal was like 5 months ago, and actually having food, I had a bit of Chinese food yesterday."

Adora stared at her in anger and worry. She sighed and stood up. "Come on, let's find a restaurant. We're going to have to walk." Catra stood up as well. "Am I about to get spoiled? Maybe I should starve more often."

Adora gave her an sharp and annoyed look to which Catra sighed and frowned. "Nevermind, my bad."

Adora took her hand and brought Catra with her to a restaurant that she knew to have good sweets, which Catra loves.

"Order whatever you want, eat as much as you can." She said. Catra listened to her intently as they went in to soon be seated.

As soon as they were seated. The conversation of Lonnie was brought up.

"Lonnie...she was the type to pull her teeth out purposely for cash, she was very curious,..violent. But she was all I had and I was all she had."

"Have..have you talked to her since this whole thing happened?" Adora asked.

"Yeah." Catra said. 'And I think I should kill her.' She frowned. "She wasn't pleased, even threatened to fight them. Just like the actual Lonnie would."

"..You're still stuck on that too, huh."

Catra sighed. "Who wouldn't. It's her, but it's not. And you know, I think...I think I should kill her."

Adora flinched. "What? Why in the world would you even think about that?" She panicked.

"Adora, that isn't Lonnie. She's just a hollow replacement. We already talked about this. I think it'd do me and everyone some good if she's just gone for real. You can't cheat death. So why do we get to be lucky enough to keep her? It doesn't feel right." Catra replied.

"Catra...this is a really selfish thing you're talking about. We can't disrupt whatever the gods have going on. There's a reason she was brought back right? We can't just take that into our own hands, we have to just deal with it--"

"*I. I* have to deal with it. We're pawns, Adora. Pawns in a larger game than we realize. There's things that have to be done and this is one of them." Catra furrowed her eyebrows. "Lonnie deserves a proper death and a vengeance on both ends."

Adora was quiet. She agreed. But she didn't think this should be the way to handle it. "Catra..--"

"Either you stand by me or stand in my way, Adora." Catra finished. Adora flinched. *What. 'Why does she seem so different? A different feeling than before. I still love her...but why does her aura feel so different?'*

The blonde kept quiet for a moment. "I know you feel like this is the right way to go but Catra..do you really--"

"What, want to be a murderer? Hundreds have already *died* by ***my*** hands, Adora. I'm *already* a murderer. And that isn't Lonnie. Lonnie has passed. It's a husk filling in as her. There's no reason to feel so bothered by it." Catra explained.

"Catra this isn't the way to do this. You can't just *kill* Lonnie."

"Stop calling it Lonnie, it isn't her. At this point it might as well be a Daemon." Catra growled. Adora frowned. "Fine. You can't just kill it."

"Why not."

"Catra. How can you talk about killing so easily? How will anyone explain to Lonnie's mom or her friends? It's best to leave things as they are and pay them no mind--"

"I'm not letting Lonnie's death go. *Fuck* Haven."

Adora sighed. "We can leave Haven. Okay? Don't do anything so soon. Let's just learn all we need to."

Catra stared at her. "I told you, Adora. Stand by me or in my way. I'm still killing it..but I won't do anything in Haven yet. Get your information, I'll wait."

Adora gave her a worried look. "...okay."

"Hii, can I get you drinks?" A women came to their table. "Yeah. I want a Dr.Pepper." Adora said.

Catra hummed. "I want a freezie and a milkshake." She smiled a bit. "Not a drink." Adora commented as the lady walked away after taking their order.

Catra scoffed. "What, should I have taken the water?"

"It's more healthier." Adora replied. Catra huffed. "I can drink water later, I've been starved of my sweet tooth for like months. I've been tasting very..irony things."

"What does the even mean?"

"...blood."

"Blood? Why would you drink--? Nevermind. That can't be good for you."

Catra shrugged. "Replenishes me enough especially if the person is well hydrated."

"It gets better ladies and gentlemen, human blood." Adora scoffed. "You're sick."

"Butttt you love me." Catra smirked. "Not if I'm going to be tasting human blood everytime I kiss you." Adora smirked as well. Catra rolled her eyes. "Mix a little wine in and you'll be fine."

"I can't believe you just said that." Adora chuckled.

"What? I'm being serious." Catra huffed.

"Life...was that normal..? I didn't know Catra could think like that." Adora whispered.

"Adora..your friend..I believe she's Death. She may be whom World tried to mention."

Adora froze, stopping in her tracks. She stared ahead at her, watching Catra walk off. Catra noticed she wasn't walking once she turned around. She stood and stared at her as well.

"Catra--"

"Adora is Life. Things were bound to end up like this..right?" Catra said.

"Perhaps she has realized that you are Death. I felt such a strong aura coming from her. Such a powerful strength."

Catra exhaled, shoving her hands in her pockets. *"I know. We both felt it, dumbass. It's obvious, and World told us. I'll behave...I guess."* She walked over to Adora. "What are you lagging behind for? I have 6 hours left to spend." Catra smirked, lightly punching her. "Come on, princess."

Adora snapped out of whatever she was.in and gave a smile. "Y-yeah, coming." The two began to walk once more.

Time passed like nothing to the two and soon Catra had to part ways. She left early, as early as 10 just to make sure she had time to get home. Catra knew she didn't need all that time, she could be home in 15 minutes tops if she ran. She put her hood up and left to Lonnie's house.

She knew the replica wouldn't be sleeping at this time, it copied Lonnie after all. Catra made it to her house in seconds, realizing she could warp her way around on Earth as well. She made sure she was in a secluded place before warping at Lonnie's door.

"This..needs to be done." Catra repeated before seemingly glitching into her old friend's room. It was dark but cozy. Catra wanted to cry, being reminded of how much Lonnie has done for her. Now, it's her duty to do one last thing for her.

Catra waited, hearing footsteps coming up to the room. The replica, Lonnie jumped at the sight of Catra. "Fuck--! Catra, how the hell did you get in here? How are you even here?" She asked, turning off her phone. She wore comfortable black shorts and a grey shirt. "Catra?"

"You sound just like her..." Catra frowned. *"Its a fucking shame she had to go and die. What's the point in life anymore if she's gone? Adora will leave me, everyone will, Lonnie was the only one that stood by my side no matter what and she was killed off."* She growled. *"Now I have to fucking kill her replica, to let her rest in peace in both worlds."*

"What are you talking about?"

"Fucking think, you know those memories aren't yours." Catra clenched her fist. *"You feel hollow because you're just a clone. Something copied off of an original. And even though you are, I'll still give you peace as Lonnie deserved."* Catra walked up to her. Lonnie stared at her in worry, fear, and confusion. "Catra, slow down, explain it to me, we can talk about it. You always--"

"You don't know shit!" Catra refrained from inflicting any harm to her. She sighed. *"It doesn't matter "Lonnie". "* She put her hand on Lonnie's shoulder. *"I love you, you were my first and only best friend. Someone I cared for deeply. And they took you away from me.."* Catra frowned and touched Lonnie on the head. *"Sleep in peace...Lonnie."*

Lonnie suddenly lost conscious and life, falling to the ground. *"I'll avenge you."* Catra snarled, teleporting out of the house. She felt a wave of fatigue. The teleporting was knocking the wind out of her.

She walked home, and Dainn put her back.

Catra immediately fell asleep.

Loose Reality

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Lejandra, the boss of Armory, handed Adora an apple, as it was her that welcomed the blonde into her home. "What is it that you wanted to talk about?"

"Do you know anything about Lonnie Smith?"

Jandra stared at her. "What do you know of that name?"

Adora stayed quiet to which Jandra huffed. "She was a helpful bastard alright. Saved Maline and Noah from nearly being eaten, shit like that. Wasn't until she was executed publicly because she had killed a boss." She said.

"A boss?"

"The last boss of Armory. I was the chief. The boss had to make a hard decision and abandon one of their companions and a child. However, Lonnie had gone back for both, and in the end, the boss had elevated her over a bit of Daemons, but she had changed the positions and pushed him off." Jandra informed. "I was there."

The armory commander sighed. "We had a different type of execution system some years ago, only just been changed. But the murderer would be pushed off a building and left for the Daemons."

"Now, as if for a more peaceful approach, we've all agreed on keeping it to hanging."

Adora stared, conflicted. She looked scared and concerned. 'Fuck.' Her thoughts raced back to Catra. "Thank you, Jandra."

"No problem kid. Just don't poke your nose is businesses that don't belong to you. Or you might end up just like her." She warned as Adora left.

'So Lonnie really was killed by Haven. And then Catra killed the other Lonnie. Fuck--! If Catra finds out, Haven won't last long.' Adora walked down the dirt-pathed cement. "Fuck." She repeated. 'When Catra's angry, she can do the most insane things. She nearly killed four idiots during transition because they pissed her off on the wrong day.'

Adora made her way back to the cabin, going to check on Catra. But she wasn't there. The blonde found Maline and asked for Catra. Maline had given her a strange look after hearing that name. "Catra..? She gave me some attitude earlier but she's at the training academy. She said something about observing." She crossed her arms and huffed. "I don't know what going on with her, or why you're so worried, but you guys need to get it together. Everyone here has a purpose and has a job to do, if you can't abide by it..well..you die either way."

Adora remained quiet before cocking an eyebrow in annoyance. "Catra and I are doing our jobs just fine. Don't threaten me." She glared, before walking over to the training academy. It was a school building that was full of children learning and training outside to deal with Daemons.

Catra was allowed to visit and help the teachers, as was Adora, however, Adora didn't believe Catra was there to help. The way she acted before, makes Adora feel like she'll give an excuse to kill the children.

She reached the building soon, entering and asking a nearby teacher for Catra. The teacher guided her to the outside where she saw Catra standing and staring at the children with her arms crossed. "Catra," Adora called, jogging up to her. Catra glanced at her, silent and observant. "What are you doing here?" She asked. Catra glanced back at the training kids. "Watching. Thinking."

"..Are you okay?"

"Yes. Are you?" The two stared at each other. "You look nervous."

"I'm fine." Adora lied. "How are your injuries?" Catra shrugged. "I don't feel anything. That expedition is coming up, are you ready for it?" Adora scratched behind her neck. "Not really, but I think we can do it. We won't die right, 'cause we're not like them."

"Yeah we're from a different world, we don't know what death feels like...the advantage of that could be exposed. So if we're in a situation where we die, once we come back, we can't go back to Haven." Catra frowned. 'Or at least you don't. I've died 45 times in the span of two months. So if I die, I won't come back until my wounds are healed

"What? So we'll be on our own again? What if one of us dies and we're forced to be separated?"

"We'll try to meet up at the bridge," Catra said. "Did you ever learn whether they killed Lonnie or not?"

"No." Adora lied. "Jandra doesn't seem to recall the name. Neither does Maline."

Catra grunted in response. "Right..okay." She seemed conflicted, Adora couldn't read her at all.

Suddenly, their radios went off.

"Michalka, Carrero, we need you at the agriculture building." It said. They both sighed, then glanced at each other and laughed a bit. "What would they do without us?" Adora joked.

Catra scoffed. "I wonder."

Noah glanced at the two. " You kids just love taking your time. " He huffed . "Catra, Mark is over there, Adora help me with the

plants. We're packing for the trip. Make sure you grab the ripest ones." Adora nodded. Catra went over to Mark. "Are you ready for the expedition?"

"Who exactly is going?" Catra asked.

"You, Adora, Me, John, Jesus, Jandra, Lilith, and Henry." He said. Catra grunted in response. Mark spoke more, asking her questions. But..she wasn't present in the moment, only tired and thinking of the past. Lonnie, her mother, her life. And now. Catra wanted to get away from Haven and go back to somewhere she finds peace. She wanted to find a purpose again with something she's good at, instead of the sorrow awaiting for her.

Catra even entertained the thought of killing more people, perhaps Mark, or Maline. Or maybe the doctor, Darith. She pushed away the thoughts for the moment as she heard others calling for her.

She helped with what she could before going back to the cabin with Adora. They fell asleep.

Later at school.

"Catra and Lonnie have been missing for days, well Catra for months, where are they?" Bow pointed out. "I've been wondering the same thing, maybe they ran away together." Glimmer shrugged. Adora frowned and kept quiet, not really wanting to speak on the matter.

"They're gonna miss their exams at this rate, and won't pass this year. College is right around the corner. One more grade level and we're out of here." Bow also frowned. The blonde sighed. "Basically."

"You look really tired, Adora. Are you sure you're okay?" Glimmer furrowed her eyebrows in worry. Adora nodded. "I'm fine, just stressed."

"Understandable." Bow hummed.

"How's volleyball?" Adora asked her. "It's fine, we're having a game coming up soon, three more before the season ends, can you believe it?" Glimmer picked at her food.

"Yeah, we're getting old." Adora snorted. Glimmer and Bow chuckled.

Catra stared at her arms. Scars were wrapped around them like a second coat. She touched some of them, memories of Shadow Weaver and now Lazarus. Lazarus was a psychotic man. He was sadistic and got angry at random things and happy at stupid things. Catra thought he was insane. He would beat her worse than Shadow Weaver when he was upset. He didn't care if they were seen or not.

Catra gave a shaky exhale, wanting to cry..but she couldn't. It was like something was stopping her. She was beginning to feel nothing, numbness. She would look at her hands and not find them being hers. It was as if it were not her in her own body. She began to wonder what life really meant, what was the point of it all? What made the world tick? Are the Daemons really worshipping a god or are they worshipping something that doesn't exist? Does this mean that everyone..like Christians; those who don't know about the Limbo are just filled in the head with lies?

"Should I go to church..Death?"

"...What raises this question? Do you question your god?"

"I question <u>a</u> god. Not mine...Have you ever seen him?"

Death was silent for a moment. ***"I myself haven't. But the one way before me, the first of Death. He saw him. I'm only left with distant memories, I only see his ethereal hands...barely."***

Catra grunted. *"Lazarus wouldn't let me out the house, especially since he found out that I left and killed...you know."* She let her head droop. His words played through her head like a record player.

"You can't hide shit from me" *Lazarus slammed her against the cold and bare basement wall, the rusted nails grinding and hitting Catra's back scars, while he held her by her neck.* ***"I am above you, I know all and I see all. "*** *He glared, his royal peach-colored eyes glowing a sharp reddish hue.* ***"Don't you ever forget that, shall I ever have to put you in your place again, ill make sure you never see anyone again. I've been being too kind to you, Michalka ."*** *He let go before punching her, his large fist along with his several rings, bruising her face. Catra fell to the ground, holding her cheek that was throbbing with pain.*

Lazarus scoffed and walked back upstairs. ***"Don't expect any food this week."***

Catra wanted to kill herself...*so desperately*, but she knew she wouldn't die. The closest she felt to death was when she would lose her fights. It felt so freeing, as if she finally found peace. That relief of not having to deal with anything anymore, not feeling a single thing, only for it to be ruined when she wakes up back in chains and beaten half to death again.

A loop. It was all a loop. And Catra was beginning to feel tired of it.

Even Adora began to notice the change in her behavior. Catra was more irritable, angry, aggressive, and violent. She wanted to hurt others as much as she's been hurt. She felt the need to kill. The need to bash someone's head into the pavement, crush someone's limbs, stab them, rip them apart, anything. She *knew* it was wrong but it *felt* like it'd *feel* so right.

Her stomach was clawing at her body as if it were eating her insides. She felt so empty and frail. Everything felt so meaningless

and senseless. Nothing in this world meant nothing. Nothing in this world felt ***real***.

If nobody felt real, ***why should she treat them as such?***

Why should she treat them as if they're meaningful? What was the meaning of human life? What's the end goal? Why do we fight so hard to fit into a world that never needed us to evolve anyway? What is so important about this world?

So many existential questions ran through Catra's mind. It scared her, but it also made so much sense to her. Because..why? Why any of this--

The sound of Hazar's snapping cut her out of her thoughts. "Hey, can't you hear your goddamn name being called? Fuckward." He growled. "Get out there and make Lazarus some change instead of pissing him off." Catra glanced up at him before standing from her place on the bench. The locker room was damp and upsetting to even be in, its colors consisting of green, dark brown, and black. It wasn't clean at all, letting out putrid scents.

Catra walked to the double doors, seeing as Hazar was still waiting. He had his arms crossed, pissed.

She passed by him, onto the hard dirt-coated floor. Catra clenched her fist, enough for blood to drip from her palms.

"what's the point in this." She mumbled as she got to her place, across from the other fighter. He was muscular, with brown buzz-cut hair, and tired dark brown eyes, but a good form. Catra learned forms but she never really thought of them as she fought, she focused on instincts more than anything.

"Speak up. You're a Weaver right?" He said, glaring. Catra didn't know his real name, but his fighter name was Beast. He was cocky at times, but he knew what he was doing, Catra could give him that.

"We missed hearing your name around here. Hearing you win made me want to bring you down, even more, champion." Beast disgustingly licked his teeth and his lips. "I've been waiting for a rematch--"

Catra exhaled through her nose, unsheathing her nails. *"**I'm going to kill you**..and it's not because you're my opponent or for the theatrics. It's because I'm trying to think straight and **you're speaking**."* She said simply, her hands trembling. Beast snickered. "Are you trying to intimidate me?"

As he spoke, the announcer started the fight.

"Do you believe in god?"

"Not at all. Nothing will save you, Weaver."

Catra sighed and stopped talking. She didn't want to talk to someone like him anymore.

"Kervens! Hey!" Adora flinched, seeing as he was at her front door. He wore a black short-sleeved button-up with black jeans, and of course, his golden jewelry. "Jean with you?" She wore a white tank top with grey sweatpants. Kervens nodded. "Yes. He's in the car, wanted to stop by again as a surprise to get you away from your work again." He flashed uno cards out of his coat as if he were selling something.

Adora was silent for a moment, processing what was happening. "The kids too?"

"The more the merrier."

Henry rushed past them, giving Adora a quick hello before jumping on the couch. Adora moved a bit so Kenith, who was a little more reserved, could go through. Kervens smiled at her, sympathetic, as he also walked in. "Jesus--!" Jean said, nearly dropping the boy's bookbags in his hands. "Hi, Adora!" He smiled brightly. "Sleep over time!"

Jean wore a white shirt with a dark blue denim jacket and black pants. His light blonde curly hair bounced lightly as he walked over to his dear sister.

Adora scoffed, seemingly annoyed but she wore a smile on her face. "You can't just stop by as you please for a sleepover without contacting anyone or anything."

"Of course I can, I'm your brother, your favorite sibling, mom's favorite child." He said. "I used to live here, you used to sleep in my room cause *Dad* used yours as an *alcohol cellar*, you should be grateful I'm in your life." He scoffed as well.

Adora rolled her eyes. "How could I forget?"

The two huffed then chuckled. "Love you. <3" Jean commented as he waltzed right in.

"Uhuh." Adora closed the door. She checked her watch, seeing that it was nearly 10. Ultimately, family bonding time won over her work. Suprisingly. So she went upstairs to charge her computer and then went back downstairs. Kervens was trying to get Kenith to join them while Jean was fixing Henry's hair.

Kenith was a beautiful brown-skinned boy with dark semi-curly hair, he had golden brown eyes and some vitiligo on his arm and a bit on his face. He wore a black Haitian hoodie with black sweatpants. Henry was a warm white-skinned boy with longish blonde hair and deep blue eyes just like Jean. He wore a Batman shirt with Batman pajama pants.

The reason Henry is the actual biological kid of Jean was that when Jean was still in search of validation from his parents, he

got in a 2-year relationship and had Henry. Though the relationship isn't his favorite memory, Henry is his favorite one.

Kenith is Kerven's biological son because Kervens is Bisexual and was also in a relationship before eventually finding love with Jean.

The two boys got along well, but Kenith was more distant.

Adora sat on the floor. "So a sleepover? Which game is first?"

"Uno No Mercy of course." Jean scoffed. Adora smirked. "You think you can beat me in Uno?"

"I *know* I can."

"Fine, $35 + delivered lunch for 2 weeks." Adora replied.

"Deal, 15 cards."

"Awesome." Adora hummed.

"Outstanding." Jean crossed his arms. Adora also did. "Amazing."

"You see how competitive your dad is with your aunt?" Kervens whispered to the kids. "He's not even like this with me." Kenith snickered a bit, continuing to scroll through his phone. Jean pulled the Uno out of Kervens' jacket pocket and took out the cards.

He passed half to Adora, and, both knowing what to do, they shuffled the cards as if they were gambling. "How talented." Kenith commented.

"It's a Carrero family specialty, got it from your grandpa's card handler. Watch and learn boys." Jean smirked. "Nobody can do it better than me."

Adora rolled her eyes. "This is why I call you old."

"Whatever." Jean huffed.

Adora suddenly got a text message. It was from her group chat with her friends. They were probably talking about the football game happening. Hearing her phone vibrate so much reminded her and made her miss Catra. After they got used to each other, they texted a lot. Adora even changed her notification sound, so she knew when it was her.

Adora couldn't let her mood change though, her family came over to be with her and keep her company. She could think about Catra later...she could try. Once she's reminded of her, it's hard to get the magicat out of her head.

Jean suddenly snapped. "Hey--, don't zone out when I'm telling you about how I'm plotting your downfall, that's rude."

Adora scoffed and chuckled. "Shut up."

Chapter End Notes

Short chapter for right now

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